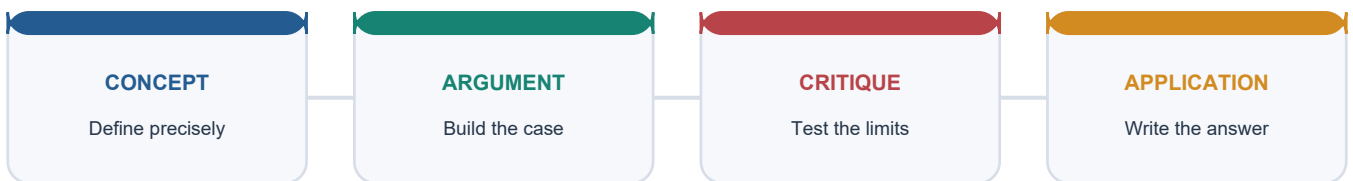


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Philosophy Paper II - Philosophy of Religion 02 - Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper II, Section B | 13 teaching sessions, 32 diagnostics, 12 solved PYQs, 6 original Mains models, 13 register cards and a 22-panel ASCII master flow

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Philosophy Paper II - Philosophy of Religion 02 - Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique

Uncompressed complete learning session | Approval: pending explicit user approval

Syllabus owner: "Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)." **Learning rule:** simple explanation first, technical doctrine second; no artificial speed target and no skipped doctrine. **Evidence order:** canonical Markdown -> OCR-searchable John Hick, the *Oxford Handbook of Philosophy of Religion* and Chatterjee-Datta -> bounded official live anchor. Qdrant was not required. **PYQ control:** all 12 primary-owner Philosophy Optional question-parts from 2018-2025 are reproduced from the audited ledger, out of 112 Paper II parts. The corpus is continuous across all eight years. **Objective-question status:** Philosophy Optional is Mains-only. Every MCQ in this package is original UPSC-style practice, never a claimed Prelims previous-year question. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads and the technical term follows immediately in parentheses - *inference to the Lord (Īśvara-anumāna)*, *effect (kārya)*, *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *unseen moral potency (adr̥ṣṭa)*, *karma-superintendent (karmādhyaṁṣa)*, *authorless scripture (apauruṣeya)*, *unseen ritual potency (apūrvā)*, *causal efficacy (arthakriyā-kāritva)*, *successive-or-simultaneous dilemma (krama-akrama-virodha)*, *conditioned co-arising (pratītyasamutpāda)*, *undeclared questions (avyākāta)*, *ford-maker (tīrthāṅkara)*, *liberated soul (siddha)*, *omniscient embodied victor (ārihanta/kevalin)*, *four infinitudes (ananta-catuṣṭaya)*, *passion-free (vītarāga)*, *own-nature (svabhāva)*, *parsimony (lāghava)*, *self-existence (aseity)*.

Package counts

Component	Count
Verified owner PYQs with full model answers	12
Original core diagnostic MCQs	24
Original remedial MCQs	8
Question-specific option explanations	128
Unique examiner traps	32
Original solved Mains questions	6 (2 x 10m, 2 x 15m, 2 x 20m)
Correct-option placement	Independently randomised, balanced and unpatterned
Topic approval	false

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

Exact printed ownership and cross-topic firewall

The printed clause owns **arguments for God's existence and their criticism in Indian and Western philosophy**. It owns a proof's premises, inferential force, standard objections, replies and the gap between its immediate conclusion and the God of religion.

Owned here	Boundary
ontological, cosmological, design and moral arguments	the attributes and God-world relation presupposed by an argument remain with Notions of God
Nyāya-Udayana arguments and Indian anti-creator objections	the full positive case for religious life without a creator remains with Religion without God
suffering only when it is counter-evidence to a proof's conclusion	the full logical, evidential and theodicy debate remains with Problem of Evil
religious experience only as one bounded strand in a cumulative case	its phenomenology, object and veridicality remain with Religious Experience

Owned here	Boundary
rational warrant and burden attached to an argument	revelation, faith and properly basic belief remain with Reason, Revelation and Faith
pragmatic proposals only to classify their force	Pascal's wager and Jamesian permission are not existence-proofs and cannot substitute for argument

ANALYSIS: An argument may be valid without being sound, sound without reaching a personal or perfect God, or rationally suggestive without being demonstrative. The word "proof" in the syllabus therefore does not guarantee mathematical certainty.

BASIC / MUST KNOW - independently complete for UPSC Philosophy Optional

This section contains every argument, premise chain, objection, reply and verdict needed for the twelve verified owner PYQs and for a complete core answer. No Advanced section is required to repair a missing proof, critic, school or PYQ concept. In particular, cumulative-case logic - the standing verdict of the whole clause - is taught here in Session 11 and is **not** deferred to the optional block.

0A. PROOF-FORCE, BURDEN AND EXPLANATORY TERMINATION ANALYSIS:

Test	Question	Typical result
Validity	If the premises are granted, does the conclusion follow?	Ontological forms claim deduction; many world-based arguments require defeasible inference
Soundness	Are the premises true-possibility of maximal greatness, causal principle, sufficient reason or design-likeness?	This is where most canonical critics attack
Divine adequacy	Does the conclusion establish one necessary, personal, perfectly good and worship-worthy God?	Most single arguments underdetermine the rich God of religion
Deductive force	Is denial of the conclusion inconsistent with the premises?	Claimed by Anselm and some cosmological reconstructions
Inductive/abductive force	Does the evidence raise probability or make God the best explanation?	Design, fine-tuning and cumulative cases normally claim this weaker force
Practical force	Is belief required for coherent moral commitment rather than theoretical knowledge?	Kant's postulate of practical reason

Burden-of-proof rule: the proponent must defend the starting premise, the inference and the theological identification separately. Merely naming a "necessary being" does not show why explanatory demand terminates there rather than in an infinite regress, a brute contingent totality or another ultimate principle. Conversely, allowing the universe to be a brute fact is a rejection of the principle of sufficient reason, not a demonstration that every cosmological argument is invalid.

ANALYSIS: A finite explanatory gap is not itself evidence for God. A responsible argument identifies a positive explanatory feature and compares live rivals; it does not infer "science has not explained X, therefore God."

Local source and factual control

- John Hick's local searchable PDF, print pp. 15-29 (PDF pp. 26-40), controls the Western argument taxonomy and the standard criticisms.
- The local *Oxford Handbook of Philosophy of Religion* controls the ontological, cosmological/design, sufficient-reason and moral-argument distinctions.
- Chatterjee-Datta's local searchable PDF, PDF pp. 259-266, controls Nyāya's causal, unseen-merit, scriptural-authority and testimony arguments and the anti-theistic objections.
- No contemporary scientific result is used as proof; fine-tuning, multiverse and anthropic reasoning remain contested, model-dependent arguments and appear only as an objection-space.

Origin and chronology of the proof-tradition

ANALYSIS: A chronology is examinable here because the objections are historically ordered: each critic answers a specific earlier formulation, and scripts that float free of the sequence misattribute arguments.

Stage	Date	Development
Nyāya-Sūtra tradition begins the inference to the Lord	early centuries CE	Vātsyāyana, later Uddyotakara and Jayanta, argue from the world as an effect to an intelligent maker
Anselm's <i>Proslogion</i>	1077-1078	the a priori argument from "that than which nothing greater can be conceived"; Gaunilo replies in the same period
Udayana's <i>Nyāyakusumāñjali</i> , fifth section (<i>stabaka</i>)	11th century	the systematic Indian natural theology, collecting grounds (<i>hetus</i>) into a single cumulative case
Aquinas' <i>Summa Theologiae</i> I q.2 a.3	c. 1265-1274	the Five Ways, arguing from present dependence rather than from a temporal origin
Buddhist logicians' anti-creator case	6th-8th centuries	Dharmakīrti, then Śāntarakṣita's <i>Tattvasaṃgraha</i> with Kamalaśīla's commentary
Descartes' <i>Meditations</i> V	1641	existence recast as a perfection contained in the essence of a supremely perfect being
Hume's <i>Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion</i>	published 1779	Philo's five-front critique of the design inference
Kant's first and second <i>Critiques</i>	1781/1787 and 1788	existence denied the status of a real predicate; God reinstated as a postulate of practical reason
Paley's <i>Natural Theology</i>	1802	the watch-and-watchmaker analogy, later the direct target of Darwinian explanation
Darwin's <i>On the Origin of Species</i>	1859	non-intentional explanation of biological adaptation
Cumulative-case programme	20th century	Flew's leaky-buckets objection; Mitchell's and Swinburne's confirmation-theoretic replies

ANALYSIS: Two anachronisms are penalised every year: treating Kant as replying to Gaunilo, and treating Aquinas as replying to Darwin.

Source-complete coverage ledger and learning labels

[FACT] marks retained repository doctrine and question data. [INFERENCE] marks the learner-facing organisation and graded verdict. This ledger maps source units to their final location rather than merely asserting reconciliation.

Source corpus and unit	Final location	Retention decision
Canonical 0-4: proof map; Western and Indian proofs; a priori/a posteriori; statement bank	Basic Sessions 1-10	Full doctrine and terminology retained in visual-first sequence
Canonical 5-5A: applied drills and the India-West parity bench	Basic Session 12	Preserved once in full comparative form rather than duplicated as skeleton and model
Canonical 6: PYQ-mapped skeletons	Practice	Absorbed into the twelve complete model answers so that no answer exists twice
Canonical 8.1-8.7: ontological, cosmological, design, Nyāya-Udayana, moral, Jaina and Buddhist dossiers	Basic Sessions 2-10	Core doctrine taught in Basic; only second-order refinements deferred
Canonical 8.8: cumulative-case logic	Basic Session 11	Moved out of the optional block, because the standing verdict of the clause and the 2018 Aquinas-Nyāya comparison both depend on it

Source corpus and unit	Final location	Retention decision
Canonical 9-13: inter-school debates, criticisms and replies, traps, keyword bank and PYQ routing	Basic Sessions 12-13 and final register	Preserved in the section where each performs a distinct learning role
Canonical 14-17: answer architecture, directive decoder, graded verdict ladder, quotation discipline	Basic Session 13	Taught as an answer-construction session rather than listed as reference tables
Premium workbook practice apparatus	MCQs and Practice	Rebuilt as 32 original diagnostics with 128 option explanations, 12 solved PYQs and 6 original models
Philosophy of Religion dossier, Topic 2	Optional Advanced	Retained in full after core practice

Visible answer-worthiness labels. Proof structures, named proponents, school-specific arguments and core critiques are **CORE PAPER II**. Premise testing, objection and reply, comparison and directive-specific judgment are **CORE ANSWER**. Historical supplements and extra illustrations are **SUPPORTING**. Modal, sufficient-reason, Bayesian, anthropic and meta-epistemic depth beyond the taught level is **OPTIONAL ADVANCED**.

What to do with the material. Memorise each proof's shortest premise chain and its named critic. Understand what the proof does - and does not - establish. Use one carefully chosen comparison or reply selectively. Reserve modal, probabilistic and specialist meta-level debates for a high-value 15- or 20-marker.

Learning route

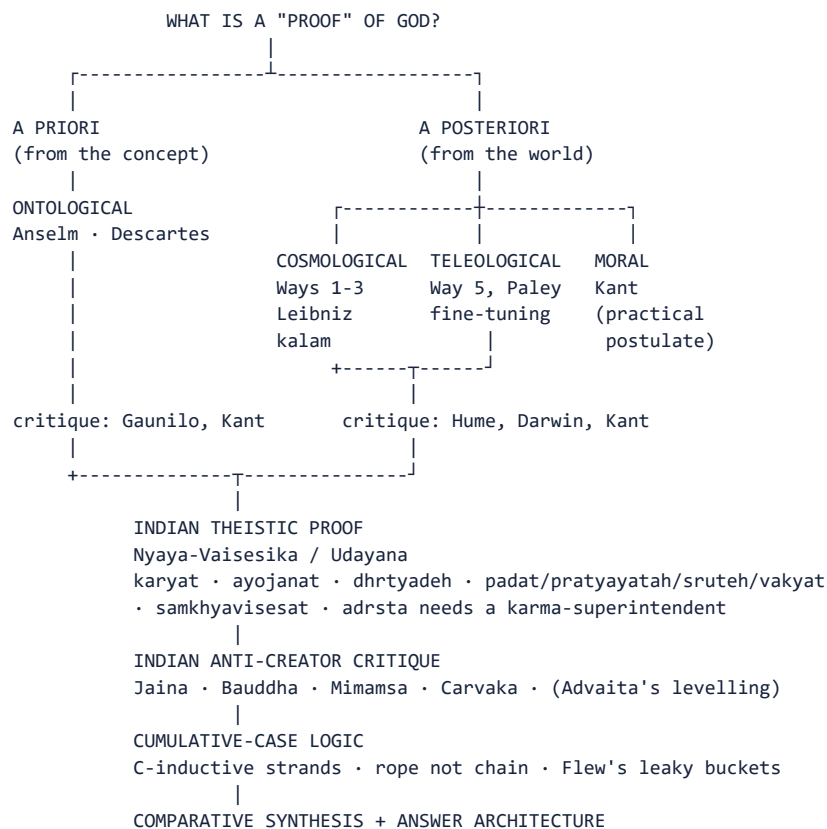
The retained source sequence moves from what counts as a proof, through the Western and Indian argument families, to aggregation, comparison and answer construction. Notions of God, evil, experience, faith and language appear only as bounded links or as the target of a premise; they are not silently absorbed into this topic.

UPSC Philosophy Optional · Paper II · Section B · Philosophy of Religion · Syllabus item 2

Evidence key used throughout: FACT: canonical doctrine directly grounded in the authored knowledge file or a local source text · ANALYSIS: analytical synthesis or inference for exam use · CAUTION: contested or textually variable · CURRENT: dated contemporary anchor only, never authority.

Roadmap

EXAM ROUTE High-value transition: the topic moves from classifying proof-families to reconstructing their premises, testing objections, aggregating what survives, and grading what concept of God - if any - the inference establishes.



Session	Subtopic	Core focus
1	Architecture of theistic proof	Demonstration, probable inference and postulate; a priori/a posteriori; validity-soundness-adequacy
2	Ontological argument	Anselm's two forms, Descartes, Gaunilo, Kant, the modal repair
3	Cosmological argument	Aquinas' Ways 1-3, essentially ordered series, Leibniz, kalām, Hume and Kant
4	Teleological argument	Way 5 against Paley, Hume's five-front critique, Darwin, fine-tuning
5	Moral argument	Kant's demolition and reinstatement; the three routes; Newman; Euthyphro
6	Nyāya-Udayana theism	Grounds (<i>hetus</i>), efficient causation, the karma-superintendent
7	Two senses of "God" in the Indian debate	World-maker versus perfected being; why the schools are not one position
8	Indian anti-creator critique I	Jainism: motive, regress, instrument, moral, redundancy and own-nature arguments
9	Indian anti-creator critique II	Buddhism: canonical, causal-metaphysical and moral strata
10	Indian anti-creator critique III	Mīmāṃsā's authorless Veda and self-fructifying ritual potency; Cārvāka on inference
11	Cumulative-case logic	C- and P-inductive force, rope not chain, Flew's leaky buckets, Udayana's parallel
12	Comparative synthesis	India-West parity bench, criticisms grid, defensible verdicts
13	Answer architecture	Directive decoder, graded verdict ladder, 10/15/20-mark construction, quotation discipline

PYQ priority: FACT: Very high - **12 topic-owned question-parts across 2018-2025**, spanning ontological (2018, 2020, 2024), Aquinas (2018, 2022), Nyāya (2018, 2023, 2025), design and Hume (2025), moral (2021), Jaina (2019), Buddhist (2018) and the a priori/a posteriori distinction (2022).

MEMORY: Master mnemonic - "O-C-T-M + N, then J-B-M-C": Ontological, Cosmological, Teleological, Moral, plus Nyāya; critiqued by Jaina, Bauddha, Mīmāṃsā and Cārvāka.

--- PRE-TEACH CHECKLIST -----

BOOK: Book context: Authored Markdown paper-2/philosophy-of-religion/Proofs-for-God.md read in full, sections 0 through 18; local OCR-searchable John Hick, *Philosophy of Religion*, Chapter 2 ("Arguments for the Existence of God", print pp. 15-29) confirmed searchable and consulted; Chatterjee-Datta, PDF pp. 259-266, consulted for the Nyāya arguments and their critics.

SEARCH: CA Search: "cosmological, teleological and fine-tuning arguments for God's existence - scholarly debate 2025-2026"

CURRENT: CA Found: None used as evidence. Contemporary cosmology is retained only as a contested objection-space, never as proof.

SESSION 1 - THE THREE QUESTIONS EVERY PROOF MUST SURVIVE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The three-question proof test asks whether an argument has validity, soundness and divine adequacy: whether it follows, starts truly and reaches a religiously adequate God.

Technical definition: Arguments for God differ in force: some claim demonstration, others probability or practical necessity, so validity, soundness and divine adequacy must be assessed separately.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Every proof must be tested for validity, soundness and adequacy: whether the conclusion follows, the premises are true and the being reached is genuinely God.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- validity
- soundness
- divine adequacy
- demonstration
- probabilistic inference
- practical postulate

How to use them: Use validity, soundness and divine adequacy as the answer spine: classify the claimed force, reconstruct the premises, test the disputed premise and state what God-concept the conclusion actually establishes.

EXAM-READY LINE: Every proof must be tested for validity, soundness and adequacy: whether the conclusion follows, the premises are true and the being reached is genuinely God.

PROOF FOR GOD

(1) VALIDITY	Does the conclusion follow from the premises as stated?
(2) SOUNDNESS	Are the premises actually true (causal principle, PSR, analogy)?
(3) ADEQUACY	Is the being reached actually GOD - infinite, one, personal, good?

A proof can be VALID, yet UNSOUND;
valid AND sound, yet still INADEQUATE to classical theism.

ANALYSIS: This three-tier grid is the single most examiner-pleasing device in the whole topic. Almost every UPSC critique question ("critically examine", "along with its criticism") is answered by locating the objection on one of these three tiers instead of shouting a general "the proof fails".

1. What counts as a "proof" here?

FACT: Three logically different things are all loosely called "proofs" in this syllabus item:

Type	Claim made	Standard example	If it fails, it fails as...
Demonstration	The conclusion follows necessarily; denial is contradictory	Anselm's ontological argument	invalid or question-begging
Probable / explanatory inference	God is the best or a required explanation of some feature of the world	Aquinas' Ways, Paley, Nyāya <i>kāryāt</i>	weak analogy, available rival explanation
Practical postulate	Belief is rationally required by the moral standpoint, not by theoretical proof	Kant's moral argument	a projection, or not binding on the sceptic

ANALYSIS: Never write "Kant proves God through morality." Kant explicitly *denies* theoretical proof; he postulates. This single sentence has sunk many otherwise good scripts.

2. A priori and a posteriori - the 2022 distinction

Axis	A priori	A posteriori
Starting point	FACT: The concept of God alone	FACT: Some fact of the world (motion, causation, contingency, order, moral experience)
Method	Conceptual analysis; denial produces contradiction	Inference from effect to cause; inference to best explanation
Standard instance	Ontological (Anselm, Descartes)	Cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya <i>Īśvara-anumāna</i>
Modality of conclusion	FACT: Necessary being, if it works at all	ANALYSIS: At best a probable, and often finite, cause
Independence from science	Total - no empirical premise	ANALYSIS: Exposed to Darwin, Big-Bang cosmology, multiverse models
Characteristic defeat	FACT: Kant: "existence is not a real predicate"	FACT: Hume: analogy is weak; effect underdetermines cause
Religious payoff	Reaches necessity but not obviously a personal God	Reaches an agent-like cause but not obviously an infinite one

MEMORY: Mnemonic - "CONCEPT versus COSMOS": a priori argues from the *concept*, a posteriori from the *cosmos*.

ANALYSIS: The 2022 examiner asks which should be preferred. The strongest answer is a graded one: a posteriori arguments are epistemically more respectable because they begin from something granted by the

opponent, but they pay for it by reaching only a finite, probable cause; the a priori argument alone promises necessity, but it purchases that necessity by an inference that Kant showed to be illegitimate. Preference therefore depends on the criterion - **evidential contact** favours a posteriori, **modal strength** favours a priori, and **religious adequacy** is achieved by neither alone.

3. The five families in one frame

Family	Premise drawn from	Terminus reached	Chief critic
Ontological	FACT: Concept of a maximally great being	Necessarily existing being	Gaunilo; Kant
Cosmological	FACT: Motion, efficient causation, contingency	Unmoved mover / first cause / necessary being	Hume; Kant
Teleological	FACT: Order, adaptation, fine order	Intelligent designer	Hume; Darwin
Moral	FACT: The moral law and the highest good	God as practical postulate	Naturalist axiology; Euthyphro
Nyāya inference	FACT: The world as <i>kārya</i> (composite effect)	Omniscient intelligent efficient cause (Īśvara)	Mīmāṃsā; Buddhism; Jainism; Cārvāka

4. Why UPSC cares

FACT: The syllabus phrase is "*Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)*". The examiner is therefore testing four capacities at once:

RECONSTRUCT -> the argument as numbered premises, not as a slogan
 EXPOSE -> the hidden presupposition that carries the weight
 OBJECT/REPLY -> the strongest critic, and the proponent's best answer
 GRADE -> how far it succeeds, and what kind of God it delivers

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not treat "proof" univocally: demonstration, probable inference and practical postulate have different success conditions.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not say the ontological argument is a posteriori because Anselm "observes" that people have the idea of God - the *premise* is conceptual.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not equate "a priori" with "certain" and "a posteriori" with "uncertain"; a priori reasoning can be invalid, and a posteriori reasoning can be strong.
4. ANALYSIS: Distinguish **validity** from **soundness** from **adequacy of the God established**. Most critiques attack the second and third, not the first.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not present the Indian material as a decorative appendix; Nyāya is a fully-formed *a posteriori* natural theology and belongs inside the taxonomy.
6. ANALYSIS: A proof's failure does not establish atheism; it establishes only that *that route* does not compel.

Revision notes

- Theistic proofs divide into a priori (conceptual) and a posteriori (world-based) routes.
- Ontological is the only classical a priori proof; cosmological, teleological, moral and Nyāya are a posteriori.
- Assess every proof on three tiers: validity, soundness, adequacy of the God reached.
- Demonstration claims necessity; explanatory inference claims probability; postulation claims practical rationality.
- Kant's moral argument is a postulate, never a theoretical demonstration.
- A posteriori proofs begin from conceded facts but reach only a finite, probable cause.
- The a priori proof promises necessity but is charged with the existence-predicate fallacy.
- 2022 asked exactly this distinction plus a reasoned preference - answer with a criterion-based, graded verdict.
- Nyāya's *Īśvara-anumāna* is a cosmological-teleological hybrid, not a separate exotic species.
- No single proof reaches the full God of developed religion; cumulative-case strategies attempt to repair this.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE THREE QUESTIONS EVERY PROOF MUST SURVIVE

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | THE THREE QUESTIONS EVERY PROOF MUST SURVIVE

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

validity · soundness · divine adequacy
· demonstration · probabilistic
inference · practical postulate

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Classify the argument as
demonstrative, probabilistic or
practical, then separate validity,
premise truth and theological
adequacy.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

A valid inference may remain unsound,
and a sound inference may still
underdetermine the God of religion.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not call every argument a
mathematical proof or use one critic
against a different claim of force.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Every proof must be tested for validity, soundness and adequacy: whether the conclusion follows, the premises are true and the being reached is genuinely God.

SESSION 2 - THE ONTOLOGICAL ARGUMENT AS A REDUCTIO

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The ontological argument is an a priori attempt to derive God's necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable being.

Technical definition: ANALYSIS: Distinction to state in the answer: Anselm argues by reductio from a comparative ("greater than"); Descartes argues from essence containment ("existence is a perfection").

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The ontological argument is an a priori attempt to derive God's necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable being.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- ontological argument
- necessary existence
- conceivability
- Anselm
- Gaunilo
- Kant

How to use them: Build the ontological argument through Anselm and necessary existence, then use Gaunilo and Kant to test parody, predication and whether conceivability secures instantiation.

```
ASSUME (for reductio): God exists in the understanding ALONE
|
| Premise A: God =def "that than which nothing greater
|               can be conceived" (aliquid quo nihil maius cogitari possit)
|
| Premise B: To exist in reality is greater than
|               to exist in the understanding alone
|
▼
THEN a greater than God can be conceived
(namely, the same being existing in reality too)
▼
BUT that contradicts Premise A - "the greatest conceivable"
cannot be exceeded by anything conceivable
▼
THE ASSUMPTION IS FALSE. God exists in reality. [Proslogion 2]
▼
SECOND FORM: a being that CANNOT be thought not to exist
is greater than one that can.
God exists NECESSARILY (aseity, self-existence). [Proslogion 3]
```

ANALYSIS: The second form is the philosophically serious one. It shifts the claim from *existence* to *necessary existence*, and it is the form Anselm uses to answer Gaunilo.

1. Anselm's definition - and why its wording matters

FACT: Anselm compresses the monotheistic concept of God into the formula "**a being than which nothing greater can be conceived.**" "Greater" here means **more perfect**, not spatially larger.

FACT: **Crucial textual point:** Anselm deliberately does *not* say "the most perfect being that there is". That description would be trivially satisfied by whatever happens to be the best existing thing, with no guarantee that it is God. He says "so perfect that no more perfect can even be *conceived*". The argument is built on the second, stronger notion.

FACT: Anselm addresses the Psalmist's "fool" who says in his heart, "There is no God." Even the fool, says Anselm, possesses the concept; and when the concept is unpacked, the fool is refuted out of his own understanding.

2. The two forms, side by side

	First form - Proslogion 2	Second form - Proslogion 3
Conclusion	God exists in reality as well as in the mind	God exists <i>necessarily</i> ; God's non-existence is inconceivable
Key comparative	Existing in reality > existing in the mind alone	Being unable to be thought not to exist > being able to be so thought
Core notion	Existence	FACT: Necessary being / aseity (self-existence)
Vulnerable to	Gaunilo's island parody; Kant's predicate objection	ANALYSIS: The charge that "necessary existence" is itself an incoherent or unestablished notion
Modern descendants	-	FACT: Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga's modal versions

FACT: Because God as infinitely perfect is not limited in or by time, the two possibilities of God's ever *coming to be* or ever *ceasing to be* are alike excluded; God's non-existence is thereby rendered impossible.

3. Descartes' reformulation

FACT: Descartes (*Meditations* V) recasts the argument through his doctrine of clear and distinct ideas: existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as necessarily as having three angles summing to two right angles belongs to the essence of a triangle, or as a valley belongs to the idea of a mountain. A supremely perfect being that lacked existence would lack a perfection, which is a contradiction in terms.

ANALYSIS: **Distinction to state in the answer:** Anselm argues by *reductio* from a comparative ("greater than"); Descartes argues from *essence containment* ("existence is a perfection"). Both are a priori, but their machinery differs, and Kant's objection strikes Descartes' version most directly.

ANALYSIS: Descartes elsewhere offers a *different*, causal proof of God (from the idea of the infinite in a finite mind, *Meditations* III). Do not fuse the two; the causal one is not ontological.

4. Objection 1 - Gaunilo's lost island

FACT: **Gaunilo**, a monk of Marmoutiers and Anselm's contemporary, replied in a tract titled *In Behalf of the Fool*. He argued that Anselm's reasoning would generate absurd conclusions elsewhere, and constructed a parallel argument for the most perfect island: given the idea of such an island, Anselm's principle would force us to conclude that it exists, since otherwise it would not be the most perfect conceivable island.

ANALYSIS: **Precision point rarely made in scripts:** Gaunilo actually spoke of the most perfect *of* islands rather than, as he should have, the most perfect *conceivable* island. Making that correction strengthens the parody, and stating the correction shows the examiner that you have read the debate rather than a summary of it.

FACT: **Anselm's reply** rests on the second form. The element present in the concept of God and absent from the concept of any island is **necessary existence**. An island - "a piece of land surrounded by water" - is by definition part of the contingent physical world, a dependent reality that can without contradiction be thought not to exist. Anselm's principle therefore does not apply to it. It applies only to a being defined as having eternal and independent existence.

ANALYSIS: **Residual pressure:** the reply protects the second form but leaves the first form exposed, and it transfers the entire burden to a further question - *is the idea of a maximally great being coherent at all?* If "most perfect conceivable island" is incoherent (because island-perfections have no intrinsic maximum), the parody fails; but the theist must then show that maximal greatness *does* have an intrinsic maximum.

5. Objection 2 - Kant: existence is not a real predicate

FACT: **Kant's objection** is the decisive one in the tradition: "**existence is not a real predicate.**" A real (determining) predicate adds something to the concept of a subject. Existence adds nothing to a concept; it *posits* the concept's object. Kant's illustration: a hundred real thalers contain not one coin more than a hundred possible thalers; the concept is identical, only my financial position differs.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta make the same point in the Indian textbook tradition, and put it in an idiom worth borrowing: *the idea of one hundred rupees in my pocket involves the image or the idea of their existence, but not their real physical existence.* To think of the existence of something is not to prove its existence.

ANALYSIS: **Therefore:** you cannot define anything into existence. From an analysis of a concept only conditional propositions follow - *if* such a being exists, it exists necessarily - and the antecedent is exactly what was to be proved.

6. Objection 3 - the modern logical objection

ANALYSIS: On the standard post-Fregean analysis, "exists" is not a first-order property of individuals but a second-order quantificational notion: to say tigers exist is to say the concept *tiger* is instantiated. If that is right, "existence" cannot appear in the list of perfections at all, and the argument cannot even be stated in its classical form.

7. The reply - modal ontological arguments

ANALYSIS: Twentieth-century defenders (Malcolm, Hartshorne, and in the most discussed form Plantinga) work exclusively with Anselm's second form and with *necessary* existence, which they claim is not vulnerable to Kant's objection because it is a modal status rather than a bare existence-predicate. The skeleton is:

1. It is POSSIBLE that a maximally great being exists.
2. A maximally great being is one that exists necessarily and is maximally excellent in every possible world.
3. If it is possible that such a being exists, then it exists in some possible world.
4. Whatever exists necessarily in some possible world exists in every possible world.
5. A maximally great being exists - in the actual world.

ANALYSIS: **The burden simply migrates.** The whole weight now rests on premise 1 - the **possibility premise**. A parallel "it is possible that no maximally great being exists" yields, by the same modal logic, the opposite conclusion. So the modal version does not prove God; it converts the dispute into a dispute about whether maximal greatness is genuinely possible, i.e. coherent. FACT: This is precisely the point the authored knowledge file records: "*Possibility premise bears the burden.*"

8. Does the concept of God entail the existence of God? - the 2018 formulation

FACT: **2018, Q6(c), 15 marks:** "*Does the concept of God entail the existence of God? Examine from the perspective of ontological argument.*"

ANALYSIS: **Model verdict:** the concept of God **entails** existence conceptually - i.e. it is analytic that God, if God exists, exists necessarily and not contingently - but conceptual entailment does not deliver **instantiation**. The argument proves at most a conditional: if the concept of a maximally great being is coherent and instantiable, then it is instantiated necessarily. What it cannot do is establish the antecedent by conceptual means alone. Hence: **entailment within the concept, yes; entailment to reality, no.**

9. Is there an Indian ontological argument?

ANALYSIS: There is **no exact classical Indian analogue** of the ontological argument. This is itself an examinable observation, and the reason is structural:

Feature of Indian epistemology	Consequence for an a priori proof
FACT: Nyāya recognises <i>pratyakṣa</i> , <i>anumāna</i> , <i>upamāna</i> , <i>śabda</i> - all of which are contentful, world-involving <i>pramāṇas</i>	An argument with no empirical premise has no recognised evidential source
FACT: Nyāya inference requires <i>vyāpti</i> (invariable concomitance) established by observed co-presence	Pure conceptual analysis cannot generate <i>vyāpti</i>
FACT: Advaita reaches Brahman through <i>śruti</i> plus <i>anubhava</i> , not through concept-analysis	Brahman is not established by definition but disclosed

Feature of Indian epistemology	Consequence for an a priori proof
ANALYSIS: Mīmāṃsā treats the Veda as intrinsically valid and authorless	No conceptual route to a divine being is needed or offered

ANALYSIS: **Safe comparative sentence:** "Indian natural theology is overwhelmingly a posteriori and inferential; the ontological route has no classical Indian counterpart because Indian epistemology grounds existence-claims in *pramāṇas* that are world-involving."

India-West comparison

	Ontological (West)	Nyāya inference (India)
Type	FACT: A priori, conceptual	FACT: A posteriori, inferential
Starting point	Concept of maximal greatness	The world as composite effect (<i>kārya</i>)
Conclusion's modality	Necessary existence	ANALYSIS: Probable existence of an intelligent agent
Characteristic objection	Existence is not a real predicate	Weak world-artefact analogy; karma may suffice
Divine attributes reached	Maximal perfection by definition	Omniscience, eternality, agency - argued for stepwise

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not present only *Proslogion* 2 and omit the second form; Anselm's reply to Gaunilo *requires* the second form.
2. ANALYSIS: Gaunilo is not Kant. Gaunilo offers a **parody** (the form proves too much); Kant offers a **diagnosis** (the form uses "existence" illegitimately).
3. ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the island example to Kant, or the thaler example to Gaunilo.
4. ANALYSIS: Descartes' ontological proof (*Meditations* V) must not be confused with his causal proof from the idea of the infinite (*Meditations* III).
5. ANALYSIS: The modal version does not defeat Kant "cleanly"; it relocates the problem to the possibility premise.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not say the ontological argument is "obviously absurd". It is the argument that has attracted the most sustained modern logical attention of all the proofs.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not manufacture an "Indian ontological argument" out of Advaita. Brahman is not established by conceptual analysis.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "A-D-G-K-M":** Anselm defines, Descartes essentialises, Gaunilo parodies, Kant diagnoses, Modal logic repairs (and re-buries the burden).

Revision notes

- Anselm defines God as that than which nothing greater can be conceived - "greater" means more perfect.
- *Proslogion* 2 argues that existing in reality is greater than existing in the mind alone.
- *Proslogion* 3 upgrades the conclusion to necessary existence rooted in aseity.
- Descartes makes existence a perfection contained in the essence of a supremely perfect being.
- Gaunilo's *In Behalf of the Fool* offers the perfect-island parody.
- Anselm answers that only God is defined as having necessary, non-contingent existence.
- Kant: existence is not a real predicate; a hundred real thalers add no concept to a hundred possible ones.
- Chatterjee-Datta echo this with the hundred-rupees illustration.
- Frege-style analysis makes existence a second-order quantificational notion, not a perfection.
- Modal versions (Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga) shift the burden onto the possibility premise.
- 2018 asks about concept-to-existence entailment; the correct verdict is conditional entailment without instantiation.
- There is no classical Indian ontological argument, for *pramāṇa*-theoretic reasons.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE ONTOLOGICAL ARGUMENT AS A REDUCTIO

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | THE ONTOLOGICAL ARGUMENT AS A REDUCTIO

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

ontological argument · necessary existence · conceivability · Anselm · Gaunilo · Kant

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Anselm derives necessary existence from maximal greatness; Descartes treats existence as inseparable from supreme perfection.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Gaunilo tests whether the form proves too much, while Kant denies that existence adds a determining predicate.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

The modal repair shifts rather than removes the burden: coherent possibility must be defended independently.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The ontological argument is an a priori attempt to derive God's necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable being.

SESSION 3 - TWO KINDS OF CAUSAL SERIES (THE WHOLE ARGUMENT TURNS ON THIS)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cosmological arguments reason from present dependence, causation, contingency or temporal beginning to an ultimate explanatory cause or ground.

Technical definition: ANALYSIS: Kant's objection, spelled out because it is frequently mis-stated: the cosmological argument concludes to a necessary being; but to move from "a necessary being" to "the most real being (ens realissimum), i.e.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Ways 1-3 constitute the cosmological family; Way 4 is the henological / degrees argument; Way 5 is the teleological one, treated in Subtopic 4.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- essentially ordered series
- temporally ordered series
- contingency
- first cause
- sufficient reason
- infinite regress

How to use them: Use essentially ordered series, contingency and sufficient reason to separate Aquinas, Leibniz and temporal-beginning arguments, then test infinite regress, brute fact and the first-cause identification.

EXAM-READY LINE: Aquinas targets an essentially ordered present dependence, not merely a temporal sequence extending indefinitely into the past.

ACCIDENTALLY ORDERED (per accidens) - Aquinas does NOT need to stop this
great-grandfather -> grandfather -> father -> son
Each cause can perish and the effect continues.
An infinite backward series here is not obviously incoherent.

ESSENTIALLY ORDERED (per se) - THIS is what Aquinas terminates
HAND --moves--> STICK --moves--> STONE
Remove the hand and the whole series stops NOW.
Every intermediate member has only DERIVATIVE power.
An infinite series of borrowers with no owner explains nothing.

"FIRST" = EXPLANATORY PRIORITY, not the earliest event in time.

ANALYSIS: This diagram is the single highest-value item in the cosmological answer. The commonest UPSC error is to reduce all five Ways to "everything had a beginning, so God started it", which is neither Aquinas' argument nor a good argument.

1. Aquinas' Five Ways - the map before the detail

FACT: Aquinas offers five ways of proving divine existence (*Summa Theologiae* I, q.2, a.3). Unlike the ontological argument, which focuses on the idea of God and unfolds its inner implications, Aquinas' proofs **start from some general feature of the world around us** and argue that there could not be a world with this particular characteristic unless there also existed the ultimate reality we call God.

Way	Starts from	Terminates in
1	FACT: Change / motion	Prime Mover (unmoved mover)
2	FACT: Efficient causation	First Cause
3	FACT: Contingent beings (possibility and necessity)	Necessary Being
4	FACT: Degrees of value and perfection	Absolute Value / maximum
5	FACT: Evidence of purposiveness in nature	Divine Designer

ANALYSIS: Ways 1-3 constitute the **cosmological** family; Way 4 is the **henological / degrees** argument; Way 5 is the **teleological** one, treated in Subtopic 4. Each concludes with Aquinas' cautious formula, "*and this everyone understands to be God*" - a phrase that itself concedes that further theological work is needed to identify the terminus with the God of religion.

2. Way 1 - from motion

FACT: **Reconstruction:**

1. Some things in the world are in motion (in the broad sense: undergoing change, passing from potentiality to actuality).
2. Whatever is moved is moved by another; nothing can be in potentiality and actuality in the same respect at the same time.
3. That mover, if itself moved, requires a further mover.
4. An essentially ordered series of movers cannot proceed to infinity, for then there would be no first mover and hence no motion now.
5. There is a first, unmoved mover - "and this everyone understands to be God."

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition:** the act-potency analysis of change, and the claim that derivative causal power must be traced to non-derivative power *here and now*.

FACT: **Canonical example (state it in the answer):** the stick moves the stone only while the hand moves the stick. The stick has no power of its own; its causal efficacy is borrowed. This is what makes the series essentially ordered.

3. Way 2 - from efficient causation

FACT: **Reconstruction:** In the observable world there is an order of efficient causes. Nothing is the efficient cause of itself, for it would then have to be prior to itself. In an ordered series of efficient causes, the first is the cause of the intermediate and the intermediate of the last; take away the cause and you take away the effect. An infinite regress of such causes would remove the first, and hence the intermediate and the last. Therefore a first efficient cause must be admitted.

ANALYSIS: FACT: **Hick's assessment, worth reporting:** the weakness of the argument as Aquinas states it lies in the difficulty - which Aquinas himself elsewhere acknowledges - of excluding as impossible an endless regress of events requiring no first state. FACT: **Neo-Thomists reformulate it** by insisting that the excluded series is not a regress of *events back in time* but an endless and therefore *eternally inconclusive* series of dependent causes existing simultaneously.

ANALYSIS: **Do not miss the historical point:** Aquinas holds, on philosophical grounds alone, that the universe *could* be eternal; that it began is known by faith, not demonstration. So Way 2 is not, and cannot be, an argument for a temporal beginning.

4. Way 3 - from contingency

FACT: **Reconstruction:**

1. We find things that are possible-to-be and possible-not-to-be (they are generated and corrupted).
2. What is possible-not-to-be at some time is not.
3. If everything were contingent, then at some time nothing would have existed.
4. If nothing existed at some time, nothing would exist now, since what does not exist begins to exist only through something that already exists.
5. Not all beings are merely possible; there must be something NECESSARY.
6. Every necessary being either has its necessity from another or from itself; the series of necessity-from-another cannot regress infinitely.
7. There exists a being necessary of itself - "this all men speak of as God."

ANALYSIS: **Two vulnerable steps.** (i) Step 3 arguably commits a **quantifier shift**: from "for each thing there is a time at which it does not exist" it does not follow that "there is a time at which no thing exists". (ii) Step 6 needs the distinction - Aquinas himself makes it - between beings necessary *ab alio* (angels, on his scheme) and the being necessary *a se*.

ANALYSIS: **Precision worth writing:** Way 3 is not the same as Way 2. Way 2 concerns causal *dependence*; Way 3 concerns *modal status* - contingency versus necessity. A script that merges them loses the very distinction the 2022 question was testing.

5. Way 4 - from degrees of perfection

FACT: **Reconstruction:** Among beings there are some more and some less good, true and noble. But "more" and "less" are predicated of things according as they resemble in different degrees something which is the maximum. Therefore there must be something which is truest, best and noblest, and consequently something which is the cause of being, goodness and every perfection in all things - and this we call God.

ANALYSIS: This is the least popular Way and the one most exposed to the objection that comparative judgements do not require an existing maximum (a "hottest possible thing" is not entailed by degrees of heat). Its defence requires the Platonic-Aristotelian machinery of participation and of a cause containing eminently what it confers.

ANALYSIS: It is nonetheless the Way most useful for showing the examiner that you understand Aquinas' **metaphysics of participation** rather than only his causal reasoning.

6. The Kalām cosmological argument

FACT: The Kalām form, which originates in Islamic philosophical theology and has been revived in modern discussion, is structurally different from Aquinas:

1. Whatever BEGINS to exist has a cause of its beginning.
2. The universe began to exist.
3. The universe has a cause of its beginning.
(+ conceptual analysis: that cause is beginningless, uncaused, changeless, timeless, immaterial, enormously powerful - and personal, since only agency explains a temporal effect from a timeless cause.)

ANALYSIS: **Contrast to state explicitly:** the Kalām argues *for* a temporal beginning and therefore engages Big-Bang cosmology directly; Aquinas' Ways deliberately do not require one. Collapsing the two is the standard textbook error.

7. Leibniz and the Principle of Sufficient Reason

ANALYSIS: Leibniz's version asks not "what started it?" but "**why is there something rather than nothing?**" Every fact requires a sufficient reason; the totality of contingent facts is itself contingent; therefore its sufficient reason must lie in a necessary being. This is the version that engages the modern brute-fact debate.

8. Objections and replies

Objection	Aimed at	Reply	Residual pressure
FACT: Hume : why not an infinite series, with each member explained by its predecessor?	Ways 1-3	ANALYSIS: The series concerned is essentially ordered; an infinite set of derivative causes still has no non-derivative actualising power	ANALYSIS: Requires proving the series <i>is</i> essentially ordered, not merely asserting it
FACT: Hume : explaining each member explains the whole; the demand for a cause of the collection is illegitimate	Leibnizian version	ANALYSIS: A contingent totality is not made self-explanatory by enlarging the set	CAUTION: Tracks a genuine dispute over the scope of the PSR
FACT: Fallacy of composition : because each part has a cause, the whole need not	Cosmological family	ANALYSIS: The argument concerns <i>dependence</i> , not the transfer of a shared property	ANALYSIS: Must be stated as an essentially ordered series to hold
FACT: Kant : the cosmological argument covertly relies on the ontological	Ways 2-3	ANALYSIS: Thomists deny the covert reliance: they identify the necessary being with God through further metaphysical argument, not by definition	ANALYSIS: Even so, the identification is a separate and disputable stage
FACT: Hume : why must the cause be one, personal, infinite or good?	All	ANALYSIS: Cumulative-case strategies add attributes from several arguments together	FACT: <i>No single proof reaches classical theism</i>
ANALYSIS: Brute fact : the universe may simply be there	Leibnizian version	ANALYSIS: Explanatory demand does not evaporate merely because it is inconvenient	CAUTION: Genuinely unresolved

ANALYSIS: **Kant's objection, spelled out because it is frequently mis-stated**: the cosmological argument concludes to a *necessary being*; but to move from "a necessary being" to "the most real being (*ens realissimum*), i.e. God", one must argue that only the most perfect being can be necessary - and that step is the ontological argument. Kant's point is therefore an **adequacy-tier** attack: the cosmological argument's own resources take it only to "something necessary", and it borrows the rest.

9. India-West comparison

	Aquinas (Ways 1-3)	Nyāya kāryāt
Starting fact	FACT: Motion, causation, contingency	FACT: The world is a composite <i>effect</i>
Reason the world needs a cause	Derivative actuality requires non-derivative act	Composite parts + intermediate magnitude => producedness
Nature of the cause	FACT: Pure act; creator of <i>being</i> itself	FACT: Intelligent efficient cause who <i>orders</i> pre-existing eternal atoms
Material cause	God creates <i>ex nihilo</i> ; no independent matter	FACT: Eternal atoms are the material cause; God is not
Continuing relation	Conservation of being	FACT: Creation, maintenance, destruction - hence theism, not deism
Chief internal difficulty	Regress-exclusion; identification with God	Analogy from artefact to world; sufficiency of karma

ANALYSIS: **The single sharpest comparative sentence available for 2018 Q8(a)**: "*Both are a posteriori inferences from features of the world to an intelligent ultimate cause; but Aquinas' God confers existence itself, whereas Nyāya's Īśvara confers only order upon eternally existing atoms and souls.*"

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Do not merge the five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument**. They start from different features and terminate in differently described conclusions.
2. ANALYSIS: "First" means **explanatory priority**, not chronological firstness.
3. ANALYSIS: Aquinas does not argue that the universe began in time; he holds that its beginning is known by faith.

4. ANALYSIS: The Kalām *does* argue for a temporal beginning; it is not Aquinas' argument.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not attribute Paley's watch to Aquinas (see Subtopic 4).
6. ANALYSIS: Kant's objection is that the cosmological argument *borrow*s the ontological argument, not that it is invalid on its own terms.
7. ANALYSIS: Way 3 is modal (contingency/necessity); Way 2 is causal. Keep them apart.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not say Hume "refuted" the cosmological argument; he attacked the necessity of the regress-stop and the identification of the cause with God.

MEMORY: Mnemonic - "MCC-DP": Motion, Causation, Contingency (the cosmological three); then Degrees and Purpose (Ways 4 and 5).

Revision notes

- Aquinas' Ways begin from general features of the world, unlike the a priori ontological argument.
- Way 1: motion -> prime mover; Way 2: efficient causation -> first cause; Way 3: contingency -> necessary being.
- Way 4: degrees of perfection -> maximum; Way 5: purposiveness -> designer.
- The regress excluded is essentially ordered (hand-stick-stone), not accidentally ordered.
- "First" is explanatory, not temporal; Aquinas permits an eternal universe philosophically.
- Neo-Thomists reinterpret the excluded series as simultaneous dependence, not backward time.
- Kalām: whatever begins to exist has a cause; the universe began; therefore it has a cause.
- Leibniz's PSR version asks why there is something rather than nothing.
- Hume: infinite regress may be acceptable; explaining parts may explain the whole; the cause need not be God.
- Kant: the move from "necessary being" to "God" imports the ontological argument.
- Fallacy-of-composition charge is met by framing dependence rather than property-transfer.
- Aquinas' God causes being; Nyāya's Īśvara causes only order among eternal atoms.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - TWO KINDS OF CAUSAL SERIES (THE WHOLE ARGUMENT TURNS ON THIS)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | TWO KINDS OF CAUSAL SERIES (THE WHOLE ARGUMENT TURNS ON THIS)

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS essentially ordered series · temporally ordered series · contingency · first cause · sufficient reason · infinite regress	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Aquinas terminates present derivative dependence, Leibniz seeks a sufficient reason for contingent totality, and the kalam argues from temporal beginning.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Infinite regress, brute fact and composition objections attack different premises and must not be treated as one objection.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not turn Aquinas into a temporal first-event argument or identify a necessary ground with the personal God without further reasoning.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ways 1–3 constitute the cosmological family; Way 4 is the henological / degrees argument; Way 5 is the teleological one, treated in Subtopic 4.			

SESSION 4 - THREE TELEOLOGIES THAT MUST NOT BE CONFUSED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Teleological arguments infer intelligent direction from purposive order, biological adaptation or fine-tuned conditions, but these are distinct evidence-types.

Technical definition: Teleological arguments infer intelligence from order, purposiveness or fine-tuned conditions, but their premises and rival explanations differ and must not be conflated.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Design analogy, biological teleology and fine-tuning are distinct arguments; each requires its own evidence, probability claim and response to alternative explanations.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- design analogy

- teleological order
- fine-tuning
- biological adaptation
- probability
- alternative explanation

How to use them: Separate watchmaker analogy, purposive biological order and probabilistic fine-tuning, then test each against chance, necessity, selection effects and multiverse hypotheses.

EXAM-READY LINE: Teleological arguments infer intelligence from purposive order, but Aquinas, Paley and fine-tuning employ distinct forms of order and inference.

(A) AQUINAS, FIFTH WAY - regularity of NON-COGNITIVE nature	
Natural bodies without knowledge act for an end,	
and do so ALWAYS or NEARLY ALWAYS in the same way.	
Whatever lacks knowledge cannot move toward an end unless	
directed by something with knowledge -> as the ARROW by the	
ARCHER. an intelligent being directs natural things.	
NOT an analogy with human artefacts.	
(B) PALEY (1802) - ANALOGY from ARTEFACT to ORGANISM	
Watch on the heath : watchmaker :: eye, wing, fin : Designer	
Biological means-end ADJUSTMENT is the evidence.	
-> Directly vulnerable to Darwin.	
(C) FINE-TUNING (modern) - PROBABILISTIC, not analogical	
Cosmological constants lie in an extremely narrow life-permitting	
range -> design as inference to the best explanation.	
Rivals: multiverse, anthropic selection, brute necessity.	
-> NOT touched by Darwin, because it is pre-biological.	

ANALYSIS: Reproducing this three-way distinction is what separates a 60% answer from a 75% answer in 2025 Q6(a). Most candidates write Paley, get demolished by Darwin, and stop.

1. Aquinas' Fifth Way - stated properly

FACT: The design argument occurs in philosophical literature from Plato's *Timaeus* onward, and appears again as the last of Aquinas' five Ways.

FACT: The Fifth Way is *not* an analogy with human manufacture. Its premise is that things which lack cognition nevertheless act for an end, and do so with regularity - which cannot be chance. Hence they are directed by an intelligent being, as the arrow is directed by the archer.

ANALYSIS: Why the difference matters: Darwinian natural selection is a direct competitor to Paley's premise (biological adaptation) but a much less direct competitor to Aquinas' premise (the regular law-like directedness of nature as such), which arguably persists after evolution is granted.

2. Paley's watch

FACT: Paley's analogy of the watch conveys the essence of the argument. Walking in a desert place I see a stone, and may properly attribute its presence to the operation of natural forces - wind, rain, heat, frost, volcanic action. But if I find a **watch**, I cannot reasonably account for it in the same way. A watch consists of a complex arrangement of wheels, cogs, axles, springs and balances, all operating accurately together to give a regular measurement of time. I am obliged to postulate an intelligent mind responsible for the phenomenon.

FACT: Paley's three supplementary points - quote them; they anticipate obvious replies:

1. **FACT:** The inference is not weakened if I have **never seen a watch made** (as we have never seen a world other than this one) and therefore do not know from direct observation that watches are products of intelligence.
2. **FACT:** The inference is not invalidated if the mechanism **does not always work perfectly** - as may appear to be the case with the mechanism of the world.
3. **FACT:** The inference is not undermined if there are **parts whose function we cannot discover** - as there are in nature.

FACT: Paley then argues that the natural world is as complex a mechanism, and as manifestly designed, as any watch: the rotation of the planets, the procession of the seasons, the mutual adaptation of the parts of a living organism. The eye, in particular, is a superb optical instrument with self-adjusting lenses, colour sensitivity and long continuous operation; the bird's wing is suited to the air and the fish's fin to the water.

ANALYSIS: Paley's is a **long cumulative argument** drawing on virtually all the sciences of his day - not a single inference. Saying so is worth a mark.

3. Hume's critique - the 2025 question's centre of gravity

FACT: The classic critique of the design argument occurs in David Hume's *Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion*, published in 1779, twenty-three years before Paley's book - and Paley took no apparent account of it. That chronological point is a genuine fact worth stating, because it forestalls the naive assumption that Hume was replying to Paley.

Hume's attack proceeds on **five fronts**:

#	Front	Hume's argument	Tier attacked
1	FACT: Any universe must look designed	There could not be a universe at all in which the parts were not adapted to one another to a considerable degree - there could not be birds that grew wings but, like fish, could not live in air. So apparent adaptation is not evidence of design; it is a precondition of any persisting order. He proposes the Epicurean hypothesis : a finite number of particles in random motion will, in unlimited time, pass through every possible combination; one such combination is a stable order - perhaps ours.	Soundness
2	FACT: The analogy is weak	The universe is not particularly like a machine. One could as plausibly liken it to a great inert animal such as a crustacean, or to a vegetable - in which case the argument fails, since whether crustaceans and vegetables are designed is precisely the question at issue. Only if the world is strikingly analogous to a human artefact is there a basis for inferring a Designer.	Soundness
3	FACT: Proportioning cause to effect	From a given effect we can infer only a cause sufficient to produce it; therefore from a finite world we can never infer an infinite creator. Hume's illustration: if I see one side of a pair of scales and observe that ten ounces is outweighed by the unseen side, I may infer that the unseen weight exceeds ten ounces - but never that it is infinite.	Adequacy
4	FACT: Plurality and imperfection of designers	Great works are often built by many hands; the world may be the product of many deities, or an inferior deity, or a senile or infant one, or a bungled first attempt abandoned by its maker.	Adequacy
5	FACT: Evil and disorder	The mixed character of the world - waste, suffering, disease, catastrophe - counts against inferring a designer who is both good and powerful.	Adequacy

ANALYSIS: FACT: **The trap**: Hume does **not** claim to prove that no designer exists. His target is the **strength of the inference** and the **attributes** of the being inferred. In the *Dialogues* Philo himself concedes a remote, undefined analogy between the cause of order in the universe and human intelligence. Writing "Hume disproved design" is a factual error.

4. Darwin

FACT: The Darwinian theory of natural selection gives a more concrete account of the apparently designed character of animal bodies. Small random variations occur in every generation; species are relatively well adapted because the less well-adapted have perished in the continual competition to survive and have not perpetuated their kind. The "struggle for survival", as a constant pressure toward better adaptation, lies behind the evolution of life into increasingly complex forms.

FACT: Hick's ozone illustration reverses the design intuition beautifully: animal life is not sheltered by the ozone layer because God created the animals and then installed a filter for them; rather the ozone layer was there first, and only those forms of life capable of existing under the precise level of ultraviolet radiation that penetrates it have developed on earth.

ANALYSIS: Exact scope of Darwin's defeat: natural selection removes biological adaptation as evidence of design - that is, it removes Paley's premise. It does **not** touch (i) Aquinas' law-like directedness of non-cognitive nature, (ii) the fine-tuning of the physical constants that make chemistry and biology possible at all, or (iii) the question why there are law-governed regularities in the first place.

5. Fine-tuning and the probabilistic turn

ANALYSIS: Modern design reasoning is typically **Bayesian or explanatory** rather than analogical: the life-permitting values of certain cosmological parameters are said to be enormously improbable on chance, and less surprising on theism, so they raise the probability of theism.

Line of defence	Rival explanation	Assessment
ANALYSIS: Fine-tuning of constants	Multiverse plus observation-selection effect	CAUTION: Neither decisively wins; the dispute is about the legitimacy of the probability assignments
ANALYSIS: Intelligibility and law-governedness of nature	Brute necessity; the laws could not have been otherwise	ANALYSIS: Shifts the question rather than closing it
ANALYSIS: Cumulative case (Swinburne-style)	Underdetermination - many hypotheses fit	ANALYSIS: Yields a probability claim, never a demonstration

ANALYSIS: Contemporary fine-tuning discussion is model-dependent and supplies no settled scientific premise for theism.

6. The Indian analogue - potter and pot

FACT: Nyāya's inference is the closest Indian analogue: the world is treated as a vastly more complex *kārya* (effect) than a pot, and a pot's ordered parts warrant inference to a potter. **FACT:** Chatterjee and Datta observe that the Naiyāyika's causal argument strikingly resembles the reasoning of Western thinkers such as **Paul Janet, Hermann Lotze and James Martineau**, for whom the world of finite objects requires an intelligent cause giving order and co-ordination to its concurrent physical causes; Janet lays it down that all co-ordination between divergent phenomena implies a final cause or an intelligent agent. **FACT:** The Naiyāyika view of efficient cause as intelligent agent, they add, "strikingly anticipates Martineau's idea of cause as will directed to the realization of ends."

FACT: But the decisive difference: Western theists generally believe God is not only the cause of the unity/order of things but also **the creative energy that gives existence to the things of Nature**. For the Naiyāyikas, God is only the cause of the **order** of Nature, and not of the existence of its ultimate constituents.

ANALYSIS: Hume's second objection - that the world is unlike an artefact - therefore lands on Nyāya with full force, since Nyāya's inference is explicitly artefact-modelled (*ghaṭavat*, "like a pot").

7. Solved PYQ - 2025, Q6(a), 20 marks

FACT: Exact question: "Present an account of Design argument to prove the existence of God along with its criticism by David Hume."

Answer spine (write this shape, not a list):

1. CLASSIFY : teleological = a posteriori; distinguish Aquinas' Way 5 (regularity of non-cognitive nature, archer-arrow) from Paley's artefact ANALOGY.
2. RECONSTRUCT: Paley's watch on the heath + his three supplementary points (never seen one made; imperfect working; unknown parts) + the eye, wing, fin, seasons; note it is a CUMULATIVE argument.
3. CRITICISE : Hume, *Dialogues* (1779, PRIOR to Paley) on five fronts -
 - (a) any universe must look adapted; Epicurean hypothesis
 - (b) the world is as like a vegetable/animal as a machine
 - (c) proportion cause to effect: finite world => at most finite cause (the scales illustration)
 - (d) many/imperfect/infant/absentee designers are equally supported
 - (e) evil and disorder count against a good designer
4. EXTEND : Darwin removes Paley's biological premise (ozone illustration); but fine-tuning relocates the argument to pre-biological constants.
5. GRADE : Hume defeats DEMONSTRATION and defeats the inference to the infinite, single, perfectly good God; he does not disprove design. Design survives only as inference to the best explanation.
6. CONCLUDE : teleology retains cumulative and religious force while forfeiting demonstrative status; it points beyond the world without compelling.

India-West comparison

	Paley / Way 5	Nyāya āyojanāt
Evidence	FACT: Means-end adjustment in organisms; regular directedness in nature	FACT: Purposive combination of inert atoms into an ordered world
Model	Watch -> watchmaker; arrow -> archer	FACT: Pot -> potter
Cause's role	Creates and orders	FACT: Orders only; atoms are eternal
Cause's knowledge	Intelligence adequate to the design	FACT: Omniscience , since only an omniscient being can directly know entities as simple and infinitesimal as atoms
Main critic	Hume, Darwin	Mīmāṃsā, Buddhism, Jainism, Cārvāka

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Paley's watch is not Aquinas'**. Aquinas' Fifth Way is about the regular goal-directedness of non-cognitive nature.
2. ANALYSIS: Hume's *Dialogues* (1779) precede Paley's *Natural Theology* (1802).
3. ANALYSIS: Hume does not disprove a designer; he attacks inference-strength and divine attributes.
4. ANALYSIS: Darwin defeats Paley's biological premise, not every form of teleology.
5. ANALYSIS: Fine-tuning is probabilistic and pre-biological; it is not "Paley with physics".
6. ANALYSIS: "Irreducible complexity" is a modern, contested move - mention, never endorse.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not conflate the design argument with the problem of evil; evil enters here only as *one* of Hume's five fronts.
8. ANALYSIS: Nyāya's design-type inference reaches an *orderer*, not a creator of matter.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - Hume's five fronts, "A-A-P-P-E"**: Any universe looks adapted · Analogy is weak · Proportion cause to effect · Plurality/imperfection of designers · Evil.

Revision notes

- Teleology runs from Plato's *Timaeus* through Aquinas' Fifth Way to Paley and modern fine-tuning.
- Aquinas' Fifth Way: unknowing natural bodies act regularly for ends, as the arrow is directed by the archer.
- Paley: the watch on the heath obliges us to postulate an intelligent maker.
- Paley's three riders: never seen one made; imperfect working; unknown parts.
- Paley's evidence is cumulative - eye, wing, fin, planetary motion, seasons.
- Hume front 1: any persisting universe must exhibit adaptation; Epicurean hypothesis.
- Hume front 2: the world is as like a vegetable or animal as a machine.

- Hume front 3: proportion cause to effect - a finite world yields at most a finite cause (scales illustration).
- Hume front 4: many, imperfect, infant or absentee designers fit the evidence equally.
- Hume front 5: evil and disorder tell against a good and powerful designer.
- Darwin supplies a naturalistic mechanism for adaptation; the ozone case reverses the design intuition.
- Fine-tuning relocates design to pre-biological constants; multiverse and anthropic selection are the rivals.
- Nyāya's *āyojanāt* is the Indian analogue, modelled on potter and pot, reaching an orderer of eternal atoms.
- Verdict: teleology survives as inference to the best explanation, not as demonstration.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THREE TELEOLOGIES THAT MUST NOT BE CONFUSED

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW THREE TELEOLOGIES THAT MUST NOT BE CONFUSED			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS design analogy · teleological order · fine-tuning · biological adaptation · probability · alternative explanation	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Aquinas reasons from regular directedness, Paley from artifact-like adaptation, and fine-tuning arguments abductively compare rival explanations.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Darwin supplies a rival for biological adaptation, while multiverse and selection effects target fine-tuning rather than Paley's original analogy.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Hume weakens the analogy and divine-attribute inference; he does not prove that no designer exists.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Design analogy, biological teleology and fine-tuning are distinct arguments; each requires its own evidence, probability claim and response to alternative explanations.			

SESSION 5 - KANT'S TWO-STOREY STRUCTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Moral arguments reason from duty, conscience, objective value or the highest good toward a moral ground or governor, but these routes claim different kinds of support.

Technical definition: The moral argument may infer a moral governor, posit God to make the highest good practically coherent, or appeal to objective value; these routes have different justificatory force.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Kant's moral argument does not theoretically prove God; it postulates God, freedom and immortality as conditions of practical commitment to the highest good.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- moral law
- highest good
- freedom
- immortality
- God as postulate
- naturalistic ethics

How to use them: Present Kant's God as a postulate of practical reason tied to the highest good, not as a theoretical inference from observed moral behaviour.

EXAM-READY LINE: Kant rejects speculative demonstrations of God while postulating God within practical reason as a condition of the highest good.

===== THEORETICAL REASON (Critique of Pure Reason) =====

Categories apply only within possible EXPERIENCE.

God, freedom, immortality are IDEAS of reason - no intuition corresponds to them.

↓

ONTOLOGICAL -> demolished: existence is not a real predicate

COSMOLOGICAL -> demolished: covertly presupposes the ontological

PHYSICO-THEOL.-> demolished: reaches at most an architect,
(design) then leans on the cosmological, then on the
ontological

↓

VERDICT: SPECULATIVE THEOLOGY IS IMPOSSIBLE. God is not KNOWN.

ANALYSIS: **The whole examinable point is in the architecture, not the content.** Kant is the destroyer of the theistic proofs *and* the author of a moral argument, and he sees no contradiction because the two operate on different storeys.

FACT: Hick distinguishes a first form of the argument that is presented as a **logical inference**: from objective moral laws to a divine Law Giver; or from the objectivity of moral values to a transcendent Ground of Values; or from the fact of conscience to a God whose "voice" conscience is.

FACT: Hick's objection: the basic assumption of all such arguments is that moral values are not capable of naturalistic explanation - in terms of human needs, desires, ideals, self-interest, or the structure of human nature or society. **To make that assumption is to beg the question.** An essential premise of the inference from axiology to God is precisely what is in dispute; from the sceptic's standpoint nothing has been established.

FACT: The second kind of moral argument "is not open to the same objection, for it is not strictly a proof at all." It claims that anyone seriously committed to respecting moral values as exercising a **sovereign claim** upon their life must thereby implicitly believe in a transhuman source and basis for those values.

1. The moral law categorically obligates the will; obligation presupposes FREEDOM.
2. The complete object of a morally determined will is the HIGHEST GOOD: virtue (worthiness to be happy) together with happiness proportioned to it.
3. Reason commands us to promote the highest good; "ought implies can", so the highest good must be really possible.
4. Perfect conformity of the will to the moral law (holiness) cannot be achieved by a finite being at any moment of its existence
-> an endless progress is required -> POSTULATE OF IMMORTALITY.
5. Nature and morality are causally independent; a finite agent cannot ensure that happiness follows virtue -> a cause of the whole of nature, distinct from nature, possessing intelligence and will, must be postulated
-> POSTULATE OF GOD.
6. These are postulates of PRACTICAL reason: theoretically undemonstrable propositions inseparably attached to an unconditionally valid practical law.

ANALYSIS: **Three postulates, not one.** Freedom, immortality and God. Many scripts mention only God and lose the systematic point.

3. What a postulate is - and is not

A postulate of practical reason is	A postulate is not
ANALYSIS: A proposition whose acceptance is rationally required if the moral law is to be coherently obeyed	FACT: A speculative demonstration
ANALYSIS: An object of <i>Vernunftglaube</i> - rational faith	FACT: An empirical hypothesis confirmable by evidence
ANALYSIS: Practically necessary, theoretically undecidable	FACT: A theoretical extension of knowledge
ANALYSIS: Subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient assent	FACT: A dogma imposed on the sceptic

FACT: **Hick's verdict, which is also the safest exam verdict:** to recognise moral claims as taking precedence over all other interests is implicitly to believe in a reality other than the natural world that is superior to oneself and entitled to one's obedience. This is "at least a move in the direction of belief in God". But it cannot be presented as a proof, because the sovereign authority of moral obligation can itself be questioned; and even if moral values point toward a transcendent ground, they **cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, omnipotent, self-existent, personal creator** of biblical faith.

4. Objections and replies

Objection	Force	Reply	Residual
FACT: It assumes moral values resist naturalistic explanation (Hick, against the first form)	Fatal to Newman-type inference	ANALYSIS: Kant's version does not infer from values to a Lawgiver; it postulates conditions of the highest good	ANALYSIS: But the sceptic may deny the highest good is obligatory
ANALYSIS: Wish-fulfilment / projection: the postulate merely dresses up a desire for cosmic fairness	Serious	ANALYSIS: Kant answers that the postulate arises from the <i>structure of moral reason</i> , not from reward-seeking; acting for reward would be heteronomy and would destroy moral worth	ANALYSIS: The line between "rational hope" and "consoling wish" is thin
ANALYSIS: Autonomy tension: if morality is autonomous, why does it need God at all?	Serious and internal	ANALYSIS: Kant does not ground <i>obligation</i> in God; God enters only for the <i>realisability</i> of the highest good	ANALYSIS: Some Kantians (and Kant in places) suggest the highest good could be reconceived so as not to need the postulate
FACT: Euthyphro dilemma: is the good good because God wills it, or does God will it because it is good?	Fatal to divine-command versions	ANALYSIS: Kant is untouched: for him the moral law is not divine command; God is the guarantor of proportion, not the source of obligation	FACT: Useful to show which versions the dilemma actually hits
ANALYSIS: Adequacy: postulation reaches a moral governor, not the God of religion	Standard	ANALYSIS: Kant grants it: he claims practical faith, not theology	FACT: Reinforces the "no single proof reaches classical theism" thesis

5. The Indian counterpart - Nyāya's karmaphaladātā

FACT: This is a genuine and underused comparison. Chatterjee and Datta, expounding the Nyāya argument from *adṛṣṭa*, write that God "combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice" - and note explicitly: **"Or, as Kant would say, it is God who combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice."**

	Kant	Nyāya
Problem addressed	ANALYSIS: Nature does not proportion happiness to virtue	FACT: Unconscious <i>adṛṣṭa</i> cannot allot determinate fruits
Role assigned to God	Postulated author of a nature in which the highest good is possible	FACT: <i>Karmaphaladātā</i> - actual dispenser of the fruits of action, the moral governor
Epistemic status	ANALYSIS: Practical postulate; theoretically undemonstrable	FACT: Conclusion of an <i>anumāna</i> , claimed as knowledge
Where the proportioning happens	Beyond this life, over an endless progress	FACT: Across this and previous lives, through <i>adṛṣṭa</i>
Chief rival	Naturalistic ethics	FACT: Mīmāṃsā: karma is self-operating; no dispenser is needed

ANALYSIS: **Sharp exam sentence:** "Kant postulates a God who could proportion happiness to virtue; Nyāya infers a God who actually does. The Indian argument is therefore epistemically bolder and correspondingly more exposed - it must show that an unconscious principle could not do the job."

6. Solved PYQ - 2021, Q7(b), 15 marks

FACT: **Exact question:** "Give a critical account of moral argument to prove the existence of God."

FRAME : Kant's two storeys - speculative proofs destroyed in CPR;
God re-entered in CPrR as practical postulate.
STATE : Two forms - (i) inference from objective moral law/conscience to a Lawgiver (Newman); (ii) Kant's postulation from the highest good.
BUILD : moral law → highest good → ought implies can → virtue unattainable in finite time (immortality) + nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (God). Three postulates: freedom, immortality, God.
CRITIQUE: (a) first form begs the question against naturalistic axiology;
(b) projection/wish-fulfilment charge; (c) autonomy tension;
(d) Euthyphro hits divine-command, not Kant;
(e) adequacy - reaches a moral governor, not the biblical creator.
COMPARE : Nyaya's karmaphaladātā - same problem, stronger epistemic claim.
GRADE : as a PROOF it fails and was never offered as one; as an account of the practical presuppositions of the moral life it retains force.
CONCLUDE: the moral argument does not prove God; it shows what a serious moral agent must hope, which is a different and more defensible claim.

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Kant does not prove God through morality.** He postulates God for practical reason. This is the topic's most penalised error.
2. ANALYSIS: Three postulates - freedom, immortality, God - not one.
3. ANALYSIS: Newman's conscience argument is *not* Kant's; keep the two forms separate.
4. ANALYSIS: God is not the source of moral obligation for Kant; the moral law is autonomous.
5. ANALYSIS: Euthyphro refutes divine-command theories, not Kant's postulate.
6. ANALYSIS: "Ought implies can" applies to promoting the highest good, not to achieving it single-handedly.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not present the postulate as a reward-motive; that would be heteronomy and would destroy moral worth on Kant's own terms.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not omit the Indian comparison; *karmaphaladātā* is the natural Indian counterpart.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "F-I-G":** Freedom, Immortality, God - Kant's three postulates.

Revision notes

- Kant destroys the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs in the *Critique of Pure Reason*.

- He shows the cosmological and design arguments ultimately lean on the ontological.
- In the *Critique of Practical Reason* he postulates God, immortality and freedom.
- The moral law is a fact of reason and commands categorically.
- Its complete object is the highest good: virtue plus proportionate happiness.
- Ought implies can, so the highest good must be possible.
- Holiness is unattainable in finite time, hence immortality is postulated.
- Nature does not proportion happiness to virtue, hence God is postulated.
- A postulate is practically necessary and theoretically undemonstrable - rational faith.
- Newman's conscience argument is the first form and begs the question against naturalism.
- Hick: the moral argument moves toward belief in God but cannot reach the infinite personal creator.
- Euthyphro strikes divine-command theories, not Kant's postulate.
- Nyāya's *karmaphaladātā* is the Indian analogue; Chatterjee-Datta explicitly invoke Kant.
- Verdict: not a proof, but a defensible account of the practical presuppositions of moral seriousness.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - KANT'S TWO-STOREY STRUCTURE

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW KANT'S TWO-STOREY STRUCTURE			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS moral law · highest good · freedom · immortality · God as postulate · naturalistic ethics	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Lawgiver, objective-value and Kantian highest-good arguments move from different moral data to different conclusions.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Kant preserves autonomous obligation and postulates God only for the highest good, whereas lawgiver arguments make God the source or judge of duty.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not present Kant's postulate as theoretical knowledge or let the Euthyphro dilemma target the wrong moral argument.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kant's moral argument does not theoretically prove God; it postulates God, freedom and immortality as conditions of practical commitment to the highest good.			

SESSION 6 - NYĀYA'S COSMIC DIVISION OF LABOUR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Nyaya divides cosmic explanation among eternal atoms, karmic deposits and an omniscient Lord who intelligently orders matter and allocates results.

Technical definition: Udayana's proof cluster infers an eternal omniscient efficient cause from producedness, atomic combination, cosmic maintenance, linguistic order, scripture and karmic distribution.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

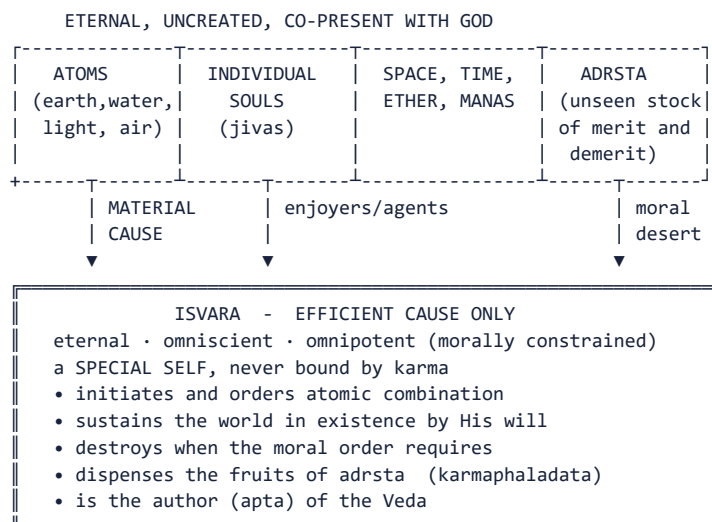
Nyāya's Īśvara is an eternal omniscient special self who orders atoms and administers karmic fruits without ever entering bondage.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Nyāya Lord (Īśvara)
- Udayana
- efficient causation
- atom-order
- karmic distribution
- cumulative case
- cosmic division of labour

How to use them: Organise Nyaya's cosmic division of labour through Udayana, efficient causation, atom-order and karmic distribution, then assess the proof cluster as a cumulative case rather than one demonstration.

EXAM-READY LINE: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) infers an omniscient efficient cause that orders eternal atoms and dispenses karmic fruits, not a material creator from nothing.



=> GOD IS NIMITTA-KARANA (efficient cause), NOT UPADANA-KARANA (material cause). Atoms are the material cause.

ANALYSIS: Write this distinction in the first two lines of any Nyāya answer. It is the trap the examiner is checking for, and it is the difference between Nyāya and both Advaita and Rāmānuja.

1. The idea of God in Nyāya

FACT: God is the creator of the world **in the sense of being the first efficient cause of the world and not its material cause** - "a sort of demiurgus or a builder of the ordered universe". **FACT:** He is also the **preserver**, in so far as the world is kept in existence by the will of God, and the **destroyer**, who lets loose the forces of destruction when the exigencies of the moral world require it.

FACT: God is one, infinite and eternal, since the world of space and time, minds and souls does not limit Him but is related to Him as a body to the self residing in it. **FACT:** He is **omnipotent**, although guided in His activities by moral considerations of the merit and demerit of human actions; **omniscient**, possessing right knowledge of all things and events; and possessed of **eternal intelligence** as a power of direct and steadfast cognition of all objects.

FACT: A precise doctrinal point worth stating: eternal intelligence is only an **inseparable attribute** of God, **not His very essence**, as maintained in Advaita Vedānta. **FACT:** God possesses to the full all the **six perfections** (ṣaḍ-aiśvarya).

FACT: Just as God is the efficient cause of the world, so He is the **directive cause** of the actions of all living beings. No creature, not even man, is absolutely free; man is relatively free - his actions are done under divine direction and guidance, as a wise and benevolent father directs his son according to his gifts, capacities and previous attainments. **FACT:** While man is the **efficient instrumental cause** of his actions, God is their **efficient directive cause** (prayojaka kartā). God is thus the moral governor of the world, the impartial dispenser of the fruits of our actions (karmaphaladātā), and the supreme arbiter of our joys and sorrows.

ANALYSIS: FACT: Theism, not deism: according to deism, God creates the world at a point of time and then leaves it to itself, having usually no concern with its affairs - like a clock-maker who intervenes only when the clock goes out of order. On the Nyāya theory God maintains a **continuous relation** with the world, being creator, maintainer and destroyer. This is the essence of theism as distinguished from deism.

2. The proofs - the classical enumeration

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta record that "the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣikas have to their credit an array of proofs which include almost all the arguments given in Western philosophy for God's existence. There are as many as **ten proofs**, of which the more important may be considered here." **CAUTION: Lists therefore vary across summaries and across editions of Udayana's Nyāyakusumāñjali (Book V).** Use only the arguments the question requires, and say that the list is variously enumerated - that is accuracy, not evasion.

The compact Sanskrit mnemonic set, which the authored knowledge file uses and which UPSC answers should carry:

Term	Literal sense	Argument
FACT: Kāryāt	"from the effect"	The composite world is an effect and needs an intelligent maker
FACT: Āyojanāt	"from combination/arrangement"	Inert atoms cannot combine purposively by themselves
FACT: Dhṛtyādeḥ	"from support/sustenance etc."	The world's being upheld, maintained and destroyed requires governance
FACT: Padāt	"from the word"	Linguistic convention and the meaning-relation of words require an authoritative source
FACT: Pratyayataḥ / Śruteḥ	"from credibility / from scripture"	The authority of the Veda presupposes a trustworthy omniscient author; and śruti testifies to God
FACT: Argument from adrṣṭa	-	Unconscious merit and demerit require an intelligent dispenser

3. Proof 1 - the causal argument (kāryāt), reconstructed

FACT: Premises, in Chatterjee-Datta's own sequence:

1. All composite objects of the world formed by the combination of atoms (mountains, seas, sun, moon, stars, planets) must have a cause, because they are of the nature of EFFECTS - like a pot (ghatavat).
2. That they are effects follows (a) from their being made up of parts (SAVAYAVA), and (b) from their possessing an intermediate magnitude (AVANTARA-MAHATTVA).
3. What is NOT an effect is excluded on the same principle: space, time, ether and self are infinite substances not made of parts; atoms of earth, water, light and air, and manas, are simple, indivisible and infinitesimal.
4. These composite objects are what they are because of the concurrence of a number of MATERIAL causes; but without the guidance of an INTELLIGENT cause (karta) the material causes cannot attain just that order, direction and co-ordination which enables them to produce effects.
5. This intelligent cause must have (i) direct knowledge of the material causes, i.e. the atoms, as means, (ii) a desire to attain some end, and (iii) the power of will to realise the end.
6. He must be OMNISCIENT (sarvajna), since only an omniscient being can have direct knowledge of entities so absolutely simple and infinitely small as atoms.
7. That intelligent cause is God and none but God.

ANALYSIS: **Notice how much work step 6 does.** The move to *omniscience* is not decorative: it is derived from the requirement of knowing atoms, which are imperceptible to ordinary cognition. This is the step that lifts the argument from "an intelligent artisan" to "an omniscient God", and it is Nyāya's answer to Hume's proportioning objection.

FACT: **Western parallels, from the same text:** the argument resembles the causal argument as explained by **Paul Janet** (Final Causes), **Hermann Lotze** (Outlines of a Philosophy of Religion) and **James Martineau** (*A Study of Religion*), for whom the world of finite objects requires an intelligent cause giving order and co-ordination to concurrent physical causes.

FACT: **But the crucial divergence:** Western theists generally believe that God is not only the cause of the unity of things but also **the creative energy that gives existence to the things of Nature**. For the Naiyāyikas, **God is only the cause of the order of Nature, and not of the existence of its ultimate constituents.**

4. Proof 2 - the argument from adrṣṭa

FACT: **The problem:** how are we to account for the differences in our lot on earth - some happy, some miserable, some wise, some ignorant? These are events, and every event must have a cause.

FACT: **Step one:** the causes are our own actions in this or some previous life, governed by the moral law of karma, which requires that every individual reap the fruits of its own actions. This follows from extending the law of universal causation to the moral world: just as bodily acts produce bodily changes and mental functions produce mental dispositions, so morally good or bad actions lead to good or bad moral consequences.

FACT: **Step two - the time-gap problem:** how do moral actions produce consequences separated from them by long intervals? "A sinner in the heyday of youth may be a sufferer in the infirmity of old age." Hence good actions produce an efficiency called **merit (puṇya)** and bad actions a deficiency called **demerit (pāpa)** in our souls, persisting long after the actions have ceased. This stock of merit and demerit is **adr̥ṣṭa**.

FACT: **Step three - the decisive move:** **adr̥ṣṭa** is an **unintelligent principle** which cannot by itself produce just that kind and degree of joy and sorrow which are due to our past actions. It must therefore be guided by an intelligent agent. Individual selves cannot direct it, for they know nothing about their own **adr̥ṣṭa**, and it not infrequently defies the control of their will. □ The intelligent agent who guides **adr̥ṣṭa** through the proper channels is the eternal, omnipotent and omniscient Divine Being, who dispenses all the joys and sorrows of life in strict accordance with it - "as a wise and potent monarch rewards or punishes his subjects according to the merit or guilt attaching to their actions."

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta themselves add the Kantian gloss: "*Or, as Kant would say, it is God who combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice.*"

5. Proofs 3 and 4 - the Veda's authority (padāt / āptaprāmāṇya) and śruti's testimony

FACT: **Proof 3 - from the authoritativeness of the scriptures.** The authority (*prāmāṇya*) of the Vedas has its source in the supreme authority of their author (*āptaprāmāṇya*). Just as the authoritativeness of medical science, or of any science, derives from the scientists who founded it, so the authoritativeness of the Vedas derives from a person who imparted that character to them. The individual self (*jīva*) cannot be the author, since the supramundane realities related in the Vedas cannot be objects of an ordinary individual's knowledge. Hence the author must be a supreme person with direct knowledge of all objects - past, present and future; finite, infinite and infinitesimal; sensible and supersensible. That is, the Vedas are revealed by God.

ANALYSIS: Note the neat epistemological analogy embedded here: the Veda may be **partially verified** in its worldly injunctions (following them produces the desired results), and we accept the whole as authoritative just as we accept a whole science as true when only some parts are verifiable.

FACT: **Proof 4 - the testimony of śruti.** God exists because Vedic scripture bears testimony to His existence - *Bṛhadāraṇyaka* ("the highest eternal self is the Lord of all, the ruler of all, the protector of all"), *Śvetāśvatara* ("the one God lies hidden in all, is all-pervading, is the inmost self of all"), *Kauṣītaki*, and the *Bhagavadgītā* ("I am the highest end of all, the maintainer of all, the controller of all, the witness of all...").

FACT: **The circularity objection and Nyāya's reply - a genuinely elegant piece of philosophy that almost no candidate writes.** The objection: proof 3 shows God is the author of the Vedas, while proof 4 exhibits the Vedas as the ground of our knowledge of God - a circle. The reply distinguishes **the order of existence from the order of knowledge**:

ORDER OF EXISTENCE : GOD --creates--> VEDA
ORDER OF KNOWLEDGE : VEDA --leads to--> KNOWLEDGE OF GOD

The Vedas depend on God for their EXISTENCE but not for our KNOWLEDGE of them (they may be learned from a competent teacher);
God depends on the Vedas for our KNOWLEDGE of Him but not for His EXISTENCE.
Reciprocal dependence across two different orders is not a vicious circle.
Circularity arises only within the SAME order or universe of discourse.

ANALYSIS: **A second classical objection with a dilemma-reply:** if God be the creator of the world He must have a body, since without a body no action is possible. The Naiyāyikas reply that the objection is caught between two horns - if God's existence is proved by śruti, arguing against what is already proved is pointless; and if God's existence is not yet granted, the objection presupposes what it disputes.

6. Anti-theistic criticism - including from within the Indian textbook tradition

Critic	Objection	Nyāya reply	Assessment
FACT: Cārvāka	God cannot be perceived; the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements, not by God; inference is unreliable	ANALYSIS: Inference is an independent <i>pramāṇa</i> ; the Cārvāka's own denial uses inference	ANALYSIS: The dispute is really about the scope of <i>pramāṇas</i>
FACT: Mīmāṃsā	The Veda is eternal and authorless (<i>apauruṣeya</i>), so no divine author is needed; karma is self-operating	FACT: Nyāya: an unconscious principle cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits	CAUTION: The dispute tracks rival metaphysics of causation and normativity
FACT: Buddhism / Jainism	The world runs by karma and conditions without a creator	ANALYSIS: Same reply as above, plus the <i>kāryāt</i> premise	ANALYSIS: Requires defending the artefact analogy
FACT: Śaṅkara (Advaita)	Nyāya's God is a <i>saguṇa</i> Īśvara at the empirical level, not the absolute Nirguṇa Brahman; and the atomistic scheme is logically weak	ANALYSIS: Nyāya denies that the empirical order is <i>mithyā</i> and defends realist pluralism	ANALYSIS: A level-distinction dispute, not a simple refutation
FACT: Śaṅkara's atomism dilemma (reported by C. D. Sharma)	Are atoms essentially active, inactive, both or neither? If active, creation is permanent; if inactive, creation is impossible; if both, the conception is self-contradictory; if neither, activity must come from an outside agency - and that agency, seen or unseen, generates further absurdities	ANALYSIS: Nyāya locates the initiating impulse in God's will operating through <i>adrṣṭa</i>	ANALYSIS: Sharp, and still discussed
FACT: Sharma's own verdict	The Vaiśeṣika God "is not the creator of this universe... He has been reduced to the status of a supervisor," His "hands and feet chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma unfolding itself as the <i>Adrṣṭa</i> "; the system "could have easily done away with a God"	ANALYSIS: Nyāya answers that a supervisor who alone can intelligently allot is not dispensable	ANALYSIS: The redundancy objection is the most serious challenge Nyāya theism faces

FACT: **The textbook's own conclusion, which is examiner-gold when quoted as a critical position:** Chatterjee and Datta, invoking Kant and Lotze, argue that **none of the so-called proofs can really prove God's existence**. To prove anything is to deduce it as a necessary conclusion from given premises; but God, being the ultimate reality, is "the highest of all premises", so there can be no anterior premise from which God is deducible. All the proofs, they say, are vitiated by deducing God's existence from the mere idea of Him: "the idea of the most perfect being may involve the idea of existence, but not actual existence, just as the thought of one hundred rupees in my pocket involves the image or the idea of their existence, but not their real physical existence." Their positive conclusion: **God must be known through direct experience, not through reasoning** - and they quote Lotze: "all proofs that God exists are pleas put forward in justification of our faith and of the particular way in which we feel that we must apprehend this highest principle."

ANALYSIS: **Deploy this as your evaluative paragraph in 2023 Q7(a) and 2025 Q7(b).** It lets you criticise Nyāya from *within* the Indian tradition rather than importing Hume, which is what a first-class script does.

7. Solved PYQ - 2018, Q8(a), 20 marks (the comparison question)

FACT: **Exact question:** "Compare St. Thomas Aquinas' five ways of knowing God with the arguments of the Nyāya School of Indian Philosophy for the existence of God."

Comparison axis	Aquinas	Nyāya
Epistemic type	FACT: A posteriori demonstration (<i>demonstratio quia</i>)	FACT: <i>Anumāna</i> requiring <i>vyāpti</i> , modelled on artefacts

Comparison axis	Aquinas	Nyāya
Starting facts	Motion, causation, contingency, degrees, purpose	Compositeness, arrangement, maintenance, <i>adr̥ṣṭa</i> , Vedic authority
Cause of <i>existence</i>	FACT: Yes - God creates being itself	FACT: No - atoms are eternal, uncreated
Cause of <i>order</i>	Yes	FACT: Yes, and only this
Relation to scripture	FACT: Proofs are <i>praeambula fidei</i> , from reason alone	FACT: Two of the standard proofs are explicitly scriptural
Moral government	Providence	FACT: <i>Karmaphaladātā</i> administering <i>adr̥ṣṭa</i>
Divine attributes reached	Pure act, simplicity, infinity	FACT: Omniscience derived from the need to know atoms
Principal internal weakness	Regress-exclusion; the identification with God	Artefact analogy; the redundancy of God given karma
Standard critique	Hume, Kant	Cārvāka, Buddhism, Jainism, Mīmāṃsā, Advaita

ANALYSIS: **The conclusion that earns marks:** "Both traditions produce a posteriori natural theology from order to intelligence, and both are attacked on the same two tiers - the strength of the inference and the adequacy of the God reached. They diverge decisively on material causation: Aquinas' God is the source of being, Nyāya's Īśvara only the architect of an eternally given material. The Indian argument is consequently more modest in metaphysical ambition and more exposed to the charge of divine redundancy."

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Nyāya's God is the efficient, never the material, cause.** Atoms are the eternal material causes.
2. ANALYSIS: Nyāya theism is **theism, not deism** - God preserves and destroys as well as creates.
3. ANALYSIS: Eternal intelligence is an *inseparable attribute* of God in Nyāya, not His essence as in Advaita.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not answer "the nature of Nyāya's God" merely by listing Udayana's proofs, or vice versa.
5. ANALYSIS: *Adr̥ṣṭa* does not consciously distribute its own fruits - that unconsciousness is the whole premise of the argument.
6. ANALYSIS: Enumerations of the proofs vary; say so and use the ones the question needs.
7. ANALYSIS: The Veda-God circularity is answered by the order-of-existence / order-of-knowledge distinction; do not concede the circle.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not treat Nyāya as "the Indian Aquinas" without flagging the material-causation divergence.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "K-A-D-P-Ś + adr̥ṣṭa":** Kāryāt · Āyojanāt · Dhṛtyādeḥ · Padāt · Śruteḥ, plus the argument from *adr̥ṣṭa*. MEMORY: **Second mnemonic - "E-A-K-V":** Efficient cause · Atoms · Karma · Veda - the four pillars of Nyāya theology.

Revision notes

- Nyāya's Īśvara is an eternal, omniscient, omnipotent special self, never bound by karma.
- God is the first efficient cause, a builder or *demiurgus*, not the material cause.
- Atoms, souls, space, time, ether, manas and *adr̥ṣṭa* are eternal and co-present with God.
- God is creator, preserver and destroyer - hence theism, not deism.
- God is *prajojaka kartā*, the efficient directive cause of human action; man is relatively free.
- God is *karmaphaladātā*, impartial dispenser of the fruits of action.
- Eternal intelligence is an inseparable attribute of God, not His essence.
- *Kāryāt*: the composite world (*sāvayava*, *avāntara-mahattva*) is an effect and needs an intelligent maker.
- Omniscience is inferred because only an omniscient being can directly know atoms.
- *Āyojanāt*: inert atoms cannot combine purposively without a conscious arranger.

- *Dhṛtyādeḥ*: the world's support, maintenance and destruction require governance.
- *Adṛṣṭa* argument: unconscious merit and demerit require an intelligent dispenser.
- *Padāt / āptaprāmāṇya*: the Veda's authority presupposes an omniscient trustworthy author.
- *Śruteḥ*: scriptural texts testify to God's existence.
- The circularity charge is met by distinguishing the order of existence from the order of knowledge.
- The bodiless-agent objection is answered by a dilemma.
- Janet, Lotze and Martineau are the Western parallels; but they make God the source of existence, Nyāya only of order.
- Cārvāka, Mīmāṃsā, Buddhism, Jainism and Advaita each reject the proofs on distinct grounds.
- Śaṅkara's dilemma of active/inactive atoms attacks the whole Vaiśeṣika cosmology.
- Chatterjee-Datta conclude with Kant and Lotze that no proof proves God; direct experience is required.
- Sharma's redundancy objection - Nyāya "could have easily done away with a God" - is the sharpest internal criticism.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - NYĀYA'S COSMIC DIVISION OF LABOUR

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | NYĀYA'S COSMIC DIVISION OF LABOUR

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Nyāya Lord (Īśvara) · Udayana · efficient causation · atom-order · karmic distribution · cumulative case · cosmic division of labour

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Udayana combines producedness, atomic conjunction, maintenance, language, scripture and karmic allocation into a cumulative inference to an omniscient efficient cause.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

God orders eternal atoms and allocates karmic fruits; God is not Nyaya's material cause.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not recite an unexplained Sanskrit list; state each proof's premise and flag variable glosses.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Nyāya's Īśvara is an eternal omniscient special self who orders atoms and administers karmic fruits without ever entering bondage.

SESSION 7 - TWO COMPLETELY DIFFERENT SENSES OF "GOD" IN THE INDIAN DEBATE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Indian debates use God-language for both a creator-governor and revered or liberated beings, so denial of the first does not automatically deny the second.

Technical definition: Creator-denial must not be equated with denial of every religious ideal, because Jainism rejects a creator while affirming achieved godhead.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Creator-denial must not be equated with denial of every religious ideal, because Jainism rejects a creator while affirming achieved godhead.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- creator God
- deity
- liberated being
- efficient cause
- worship-worthiness
- Indian non-theism

How to use them: Use creator God, deity, liberated being and worship-worthiness to distinguish cosmic efficient causation from achieved or revered godhood before classifying Indian non-theism.

EXAM-READY LINE: Creator-denial must not be equated with denial of every religious ideal, because Jainism rejects a creator while affirming achieved godhead.

Affirmed by : Nyaya-Vaisesika (efficient cause), theistic Vedanta
DENIED by : JAINA • BAUDDHA • MIMAMSA • SANKHYA • CARVAKA

▲	▲
+- denial on METAPHYSICAL grounds (karma/conditions suffice)	+- on EPISTEMIC grounds (no perception)

AFFIRMED by JAINISM : "Jainism denies God, but does not deny GODHEAD.
EVERY LIBERATED SOUL IS A GOD."
Godhood is ACHIEVED, not eternal · PLURAL, not unique ·
a MODEL, not a maker.

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- karma
- creator critique

How to use them: Explain why an eternal, law-governed cosmos and self-fructifying karma make a creator unnecessary, while liberated omniscient souls remain achieved rather than creating gods.

EXAM-READY LINE: Jainism rejects a creator God but affirms liberated, omniscient souls as achieved godhead attained through self-effort.

1. What Jainism denies

FACT: Jainism is "a religion without God" in the sense of a **creator**. FACT: There is no necessity of bringing in God to explain creation, **for the world was never created**: production, destruction and permanence characterise all substances; things have creation and dissolution because of their **modes (paryāya)**, while the substances themselves are eternal. The six *dravyas* - *jīva*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa* and *kāla* - are beginningless.

FACT: ANALYSIS: **Terminological caution that impresses examiners:** *nāstika* in Indian philosophy standardly means "one who denies the authority of the Veda", not "one who denies the spirit". In that Vedic sense Jainism and Buddhism are *nāstika*; but they are intensely spiritual and ethical, and denial of God does not amount to atheism in the Western sense - otherwise Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā, which likewise do not believe in a creator God, could not have been counted orthodox.

2. What Jainism affirms - godhood, and the proofs for it

FACT: **"Though Jainism denies God, it does not deny godhead. Every liberated soul is a god."** FACT: The Tirthaṅkaras, who were mortal beings like us but obtained liberation through personal effort, are always there to inspire us. **We are all potential Jinas, for what man has done man can do.** Jainism is a religion of self-help.

ANALYSIS: **The Jaina "proofs" are therefore proofs of the possibility and actuality of divine perfection in the soul, arranged as follows:**

PROOF 1 - FROM THE INTRINSIC NATURE OF THE JIVA (svabhava-siddhi)

1. Every jiva intrinsically possesses infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss and infinite power (ananta-catustaya).
2. Empirically these are obscured, not absent, since we observe DEGREES of knowledge, not its total absence.
3. Obscuration is caused by karmic matter (pudgala) adhering to the soul.
4. Remove the obscuring karma completely and the native perfections manifest completely.
5. Godhood is the soul's own nature recovered, not a status conferred from outside. [RECOVERY, not creation]

PROOF 2 - FROM DEGREES OF KNOWLEDGE TO OMNISCIENCE (sarvajna-siddhi)

1. Knowledge occurs in graded kinds: mati, sruta, avadhi, manahparyaya.
2. The gradation maps the progressive removal of karmic obstruction.
3. A graded series of obstruction-removal has a limiting case: COMPLETE removal.
4. At that limit knowledge is total, direct and unobstructed = KEVALA-JNANA.
5. An omniscient being (kevalin) is possible, and the Tirthaṅkaras are its actual instances.

PROOF 3 - FROM THE TESTIMONY OF THE OMNISCIENT (apta / agama)

1. Right faith rests on the teaching of the omniscient Tirthaṅkaras.
2. Their teaching is internally coherent, ascetically verified and transmitted through the Agama.
3. Their attained godhood is credible on the strength of apta-vacana.

ANALYSIS: FACT: Sharma states the epistemic role of Proof 3 exactly: faith is necessary because the deepest truths rest on the word "of the omniscient Tirthaṅkaras"; and right faith, right knowledge and right conduct - the **tri-ratna** - jointly constitute the path.

FACT: **The resulting concept of God:** plural (infinitely many *siddhas*), achieved (not eternal in status), non-creative (no cosmic function), non-interventionist (a *siddha* does not answer prayer or dispense karma), and purely exemplary.

ANALYSIS: Sharma notes the historical tension frankly: strictly there is no room for devotion in Jainism, since asceticism must burn all emotion to ashes; yet the ordinary Jaina, under Brahmanical influence, has deified the Tirthaṅkaras, built temples and worshipped their images.

3. Jaina refutation of a creator God

ANALYSIS: The classical Jaina anti-creator arguments (developed in the Digambara tradition and standard in Indian philosophical summaries) run:

#	Argument	Force
1	ANALYSIS: From what did God create? If from pre-existing matter, matter is uncreated and God is not the sole ultimate; if from nothing, anything could be produced anywhere at any time.	Attacks the coherence of creation
2	ANALYSIS: Why did God create? A perfect being has no unfulfilled desire; a motive implies lack.	Attacks divine perfection
3	ANALYSIS: If out of compassion , the world should contain only happiness.	Empirical refutation
4	ANALYSIS: If in sport (līlā) , God is childish, and cruel toward the suffering.	Moral refutation
5	ANALYSIS: Who created God? If God is self-existent, the world may equally be self-existent - the theist's own concession destroys the argument.	Regress / parity
6	FACT: Karma suffices. The world-order and the distribution of pleasure and pain are explained by each soul's own karmic matter; no external allocator is required.	Explanatory economy

FACT: **The Jaina positive alternative:** the universe is eternal and uncreated; *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya* (origination, decay, permanence) is the structure of every substance; change is real without a changer standing outside.

4. Solved PYQ - 2019, Q5(e), 10 marks

FACT: **Exact question:** "State and evaluate the proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism."

- 1 min : Disambiguate "God" - Jainism denies jagat-karta but affirms GODHEAD.
 4 min : The three Jaina routes - intrinsic ananta-catustaya of the jīva; the gradation of knowledge culminating in kevala-jnana; the testimony of the omniscient Tirthankaras (apta-vacana).
 2 min : The refutation of a creator - motive, material, compassion, sport, regress, karmic sufficiency.
 2 min : EVALUATE - the proofs succeed in establishing an ideal of attainable perfection, but they are internal to Jaina metaphysics: they presuppose the soul's intrinsic omniscience and material karma. They do NOT prove, and do not attempt to prove, a cosmic God.
 1 min : Verdict - Jaina theology is a soteriological, not a cosmological, theism; "God" names the terminus of the path, not its author.

ANALYSIS: **Evaluation lines available from within the Indian tradition (use one, not all):** Sharma presses the classic realist-pluralist difficulty - if ignorance and karma are inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if they are external to it, bondage is impossible - and holds that the Jainas have no real answer. If the soul is by nature pure consciousness and power, how can it be really tinged with ignorance, passion and karma? This objection strikes at the very premise on which Proof 1 rests.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE I: JAINISM

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE I: JAINISM			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Jain non-creationism · eternal cosmos · liberated soul (siddha) · self-effort · karma · creator critique	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Jainism treats the cosmos and substances as beginningless and karmically ordered while defining godhood as achieved liberation.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Its motive, regress, material, moral and redundancy arguments target a creator without denying perfected souls.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not invent Jain creator-proofs or equate a Tirthankara with a creator or with every liberated soul.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism rejects a creator while affirming liberated omniscient souls as achieved godhead, thereby separating spiritual perfection from cosmic production.			

SESSION 9 - INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE II: BUDDHISM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Buddhism rejects a permanent creator and explains suffering through conditioned arising rather than divine production.

Technical definition: Buddhist critiques reject an eternal creator because conditioned arising already explains phenomena and because unchanging agency, purposive creation and pervasive suffering generate further contradictions.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Buddhism rejects a permanent creator because dependent origination explains arising through conditions without introducing an unchanging divine producer.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Buddhist non-theism**
- **dependent origination**
- **impermanence**
- **no permanent self**
- **unchanging creator**
- **suffering**

How to use them: Use dependent origination to displace a first creator and argue that an eternal unchanging will create problems of change, purpose and responsibility for suffering.

EXAM-READY LINE: Buddhism rejects a permanent creator and explains suffering through conditioned arising rather than divine production.

5. The Buddhist arguments against a creator God

FACT: **Four core lines**, as recorded in the authored knowledge file:

1. **FACT:** If God is **eternal and unchanging**, genuine creation becomes difficult to explain, because willing or producing seems to involve change.
2. **FACT:** If God creates **from desire or purpose**, that suggests lack, preference or incompleteness.
3. **FACT:** The presence of **suffering and evil** sits uneasily with an omnipotent benevolent creator.
4. **FACT:** **Dependent origination (pratītyasamutpāda)** already explains the arising of phenomena through conditions, making a creator unnecessary.

ANALYSIS: **Three further lines that raise a 15-marker to distinction level:**

5. **ANALYSIS:** **The doctrinal-method argument.** Questions about a first beginning belong to the *avyākṛta* (undeclared) questions; the Buddha's refusal to answer them is not evasion but a judgement that they are soteriologically idle - the parable of the man wounded by an arrow, who dies while demanding to know the archer's caste before allowing the arrow to be drawn.
6. **ANALYSIS:** **The moral-agency argument.** If God determines all, karma and moral effort are meaningless; if God does not determine all, God is not the sufficient cause and the theistic explanation is redundant.
7. **ANALYSIS:** **The Dharmakīrti / Śāntarākṣita line.** A permanent, partless, immutable cause cannot produce *successive* effects, since a cause that is unchanging and fully present must produce its effect all at once and always; therefore an eternal God cannot be the cause of a temporally ordered world.

FACT: **Philosophical force, stated correctly:** the Buddhist critique is not mere atheistic denial; it is a **systematic refusal of explanatory surplus**. If conditioned arising explains the world-process, God is not needed. It is Ockhamite before Ockham.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition to expose:** the critique assumes (i) that explanation should proceed through conditional relations rather than through a substratum or an external agent, and (ii) that what matters philosophically is not an

absolutely first beginning but the structure by which bondage is maintained here and now.

6. Solved PYQ - 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks

FACT: Exact question: "Critically evaluate the Buddhist arguments against the existence of God as the creator of the world."

- FRAME** : Buddhism denies a creator without denying the sacred; the target is jagat-karta, not spiritual ultimacy.
- STATE** : (a) eternal unchanging cause cannot create; (b) creation from desire implies lack; (c) suffering tells against a benevolent omnipotent creator; (d) pratityasamutpada makes a creator explanatorily redundant; (e) the avyakṛta silence; (f) the freedom/karma dilemma; (g) Dharmakīrti: a permanent cause cannot yield successive effects.
- CRITIQUE** : - (i) Nyaya replies that unconscious karma cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits, so dependent origination explains sequence but not desert-appropriate ALLOCATION.
 - (ii) The change objection assumes a temporal model of divine willing; classical theism replies with an eternal act producing a temporal effect.
 - (iii) The desire objection assumes creation must satisfy a lack; theists appeal to gratuitous diffusive goodness.
 - (iv) Explanatory economy is a methodological preference, not a disproof.
- ASSESS** : the arguments are strong AGAINST an anthropomorphic, purposive, benevolent world-maker; weaker against a metaphysically refined classical theism. They shift the burden rather than close the case.
- CONCLUDE** : Buddhism establishes that a coherent, ethically serious cosmology is possible without a creator - which is a substantial result even if it is not a demonstration of atheism.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE II: BUDDHISM

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE II: BUDDHISM			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS Buddhist non-theism · dependent origination · impermanence · no permanent self · unchanging creator · suffering	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Dependent origination and the permanence-production dilemma challenge the need and coherence of an unchanging creator.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Buddhism rejects a creator while allowing impermanent deities within the conditioned order.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Silence about speculative questions is not by itself a refutation; state the causal argument.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Buddhism rejects a permanent creator because dependent origination explains arising through conditions without introducing an unchanging divine producer.			

SESSION 10 - INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE III: MĪMĀṂSĀ AND CĀRVĀKA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Mimamsa explains scriptural authority and ritual results through an authorless Veda and unseen ritual potency without requiring a divine author or karmic governor.

Technical definition: The Mimamsa anti-theistic case combines authorless scripture, an intrinsic word-meaning relation and unseen ritual potency to render Nyaya's author, teacher and fruit-dispenser arguments redundant.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Mīmāṃsā (school of inquiry into ritual duty) treats the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as authorless and karma (morally consequential action) as self-fructifying, thereby displacing the need for God.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Mīmāṃsā
- authorless Veda (apauruṣeyatva)
- unseen ritual potency (apūrvā)
- self-fructifying karma
- word-meaning relation
- creator redundancy

How to use them: Show how authorless scripture, intrinsic word-meaning relations and apūrva allocate explanatory work without God, then assess Nyāya's reply that order still requires intelligence.

7. Why Mīmāṃsā needs no God

FACT: The Veda is authoritative because it is **apauruṣeya** - eternal, authorless and self-valid. It is not authored by any human, **nor is a divine author needed**. FACT: Authorlessness protects it from personal defects: a personal author may deceive, or may lack complete knowledge; if the Veda had an author, its authority would depend on first proving that author's competence and sincerity.

FACT: **The direct counter to Nyāya's proof 3:** Mīmāṃsā objects that the Nyāya route is cumbersome - first prove God exists, then prove God is omniscient, then prove God intends truth, each stage needing independent support. Authorlessness avoids the entire dependence. FACT: Coupled with *svataḥ-prāmāṇya* (intrinsic validity of cognition), this blocks scepticism at the starting point without theological guarantee.

FACT: **And the direct counter to Nyāya's adṛṣṭa proof:** apūrva is the unseen potency produced by correctly performed ritual; it persists after the act and matures into future fruit. This allows Mīmāṃsā to explain ritual efficacy **without God as fruit-dispenser**. Prābhākara adds *niyoga*: the injunction itself creates obligation, so one ought to act because the Veda commands, not because a deity rewards.

FACT: **Chatterjee-Datta's report of the wider debate:** the Mīmāṃsā rejects the proofs of God's existence, like the Jains, without replacing them by others. They also record Max Müller's contention that if God were supposed to be the creator, He would be liable to the charges of **cruelty and partiality**; and Müller's further point that rejection of a *creator*-God is not necessarily rejection of God, since pantheisms such as Advaita and Spinoza's do not accept the reality of creation and yet are not fairly called atheistic. ANALYSIS: Their own verdict is more sceptical: judged by what the Mīmāṃsā itself does and says, the Vedic deities are not treated as objects of worship and are not believed to exist anywhere except in the *mantras* that describe them - "eternal and self-manifesting concepts", like the immortal characters of classical epics. ANALYSIS: In its anxiety to maintain the supremacy of the Vedas, the Mīmāṃsā "relegates God to an ambiguous position".

8. Cārvāka - and the Nyāya replies to all three

FACT: **Cārvāka:** the existence of God is a myth; God cannot be perceived; the world is made by the **automatic combination of the material elements** and not by God; no faith should be put in the Vedas. ANALYSIS: Perception alone is a *pramāṇa*, so inference - on which every theistic proof depends - is unreliable.

Objector	Core claim	ANALYSIS: Nyāya's reply	Assessment
Cārvāka	No perception of God; inference invalid	Inference is an independent <i>pramāṇa</i> ; the Cārvāka's own general denial itself requires inference	ANALYSIS: The dispute is about the scope of <i>pramāṇas</i> , not about God directly
Buddhism	Conditions suffice; a permanent cause cannot produce successive effects	An unconscious causal nexus explains sequence but not desert-appropriate allocation	CAUTION: Rival metaphysics; no knock-down
Jainism	Karma is material and self-operating; creation never happened	Material karma still requires an intelligent principle to allot determinate fruits	ANALYSIS: Nyāya's reply presupposes what Jainism denies
Mīmāṃsā	Veda is <i>apauruṣeya</i> ; <i>apūrva</i> self-matures	Unconscious <i>apūrva</i> cannot intelligently proportion fruit to desert; authorless language is normatively unexplained	CAUTION: The deepest and most evenly matched Indian dispute
Advaita	Nyāya's Īśvara is only <i>saguṇa</i> , empirically valid; atomism is incoherent	Realist pluralism denies the <i>mithyā</i> verdict on the empirical order	ANALYSIS: A level-distinction dispute

India-West comparison

Objection type	Indian instance	Western counterpart
Explanatory economy	FACT: <i>Pratītyasamutpāda</i> ; karma; <i>apūrva</i>	FACT: Darwinian natural selection; Hume's Epicurean hypothesis
Coherence of attributes	ANALYSIS: Immutable cause cannot produce successive effects	FACT: Omnipotence paradoxes; immutability vs responsiveness
Evil	FACT: Suffering vs a benevolent creator; Müller's cruelty/partiality charge	FACT: Hume's fifth front; the evidential problem of evil
Epistemic restriction	FACT: Cārvāka's perception-only	FACT: Logical positivist verificationism
Authority without an author	FACT: Mīmāṃsā <i>apauruṣeya</i>	ANALYSIS: No close Western analogue - a genuinely distinctive Indian contribution

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: **Jainism denies God but not godhead**. Answering the 2019 question with "Jainism is atheistic" misreads it.
2. ANALYSIS: Jaina godhood is plural, achieved and non-creative; a *siddha* has no cosmic function.
3. ANALYSIS: Jaina karma is **material (pudgala)**; do not equate it with Nyāya's *adr̥ṣṭa* or a generic moral force.
4. ANALYSIS: *Nāstika* means denier of Vedic authority, not denier of spirit.
5. ANALYSIS: Buddhism's critique is a refusal of explanatory surplus, not a proof of atheism.
6. ANALYSIS: The *avyākṛta* silence is a methodological judgement, not agnostic evasion.
7. ANALYSIS: Mīmāṃsā's Veda is authorless - **not** God-authored; this is the exact contradictory of Nyāya's third proof.
8. ANALYSIS: *Apūrva* is Mīmāṃsā's substitute for a fruit-dispensing God; do not call it "karma" loosely.
9. ANALYSIS: Do not say Sāṃkhya "has no view"; classical Sāṃkhya is *nirīśvara* and also denies a creator.
10. ANALYSIS: Do not present these schools as a single "Indian atheism". Their grounds differ - economy, coherence, epistemic restriction.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "E-C-E"**: every Indian anti-creator argument is an **E**conomy, **C**oherence or **E**pistemic move.

Revision notes

- Jainism denies a creator God but affirms godhood: every liberated soul is a god.
- The world was never created; substances are eternal and change through modes.
- *Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya* - origination, decay and permanence characterise all substances.
- Jaina proof 1: the *jīva*'s intrinsic *ananta-catustaya* is obscured, not absent.
- Jaina proof 2: graded knowledge (*matī, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya*) has a limiting case in *kevala-jñāna*.
- Jaina proof 3: the testimony of the omniscient Tīrthaṅkaras (*āpta-vacana*).
- Tīrthaṅkaras were mortals who attained liberation by personal effort - "we are all potential Jinas".
- Jaina anti-creator arguments: material of creation, motive, compassion, sport, regress, karmic sufficiency.
- Sharma's internal objection: if karma is inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if external, bondage is.
- *Nāstika* means denier of Vedic authority; Jainism and Buddhism are *nāstika* only in that sense.
- Buddhism: an immutable eternal cause cannot create; creation from desire implies lack.
- Buddhism: suffering counts against a benevolent creator; dependent origination makes God redundant.
- The *avyākṛta* questions and the arrow parable show the critique is soteriological in motive.
- Dharmakīrti-type argument: a permanent cause cannot produce successive effects.
- Mīmāṃsā: the Veda is *apauruṣeya*, eternal and authorless; no divine author is needed.
- Authorlessness protects the Veda from an author's deceit or ignorance.

- Mīmāṃsā's objection to Nyāya: proving God, then omniscience, then truthfulness, is cumbersome.
- *Apūrva* explains ritual fruit without a divine dispenser; *niyoga* grounds obligation in injunction.
- Max Müller: a creator God would face charges of cruelty and partiality.
- Cārvāka: God is unperceived; the world results from the automatic combination of elements.
- All Indian anti-creator arguments reduce to economy, coherence or epistemic-restriction moves.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE III: MĪMĀṂSĀ AND CĀRVĀKA

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | INDIAN ANTI-CREATOR CRITIQUE III: MĪMĀṂSĀ AND CĀRVĀKA

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

Mīmāṃsā · authorless Veda (apauruṣeyatva) · unseen ritual potency (apūrva) · self-fructifying karma · word-meaning relation · creator redundancy

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Authorless scripture, intrinsic word-meaning relations and unseen ritual potency distribute explanatory work without a divine author or dispenser.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Nyaya must show why linguistic authority and karmic fruition require conscious administration.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not call unseen ritual potency a deity or treat Mīmāṃsā's Vedic orthodoxy as creator-theism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mīmāṃsā (school of inquiry into ritual duty) treats the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as authorless and karma (morally consequential action) as self-fructifying, thereby displacing the need for God.

SESSION 11 - CUMULATIVE-CASE LOGIC: HOW WEAK ARGUMENTS ARE SUPPOSED TO ADD UP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A cumulative case is the claim that several arguments, none of which proves God on its own, can together make belief in God more reasonable than not.

Technical definition: A cumulative case aggregates independent probability-raising (C-inductive) arguments on a confirmation model, aiming at a P-inductive result in which the total evidence makes theism more probable than not.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

No single theistic argument is today defended as demonstrative; the live claim is that several independently weak arguments jointly raise the probability of theism, which is a rope and not a chain.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- cumulative case
- C-inductive and P-inductive
- confirmation, not demonstration
- rope, not chain
- leaky buckets (Flew)
- underdetermination

How to use them: Open by declaring the claimed force, distinguish probability-raising from probability-tipping arguments, run the rope image against the chain image, concede Flew's objection in its strongest form, and close on underdetermination - which is what the aggregation still cannot fix.

1. Why the clause needs this session at all

FACT: Every one of the twelve owner PYQs asks, directly or by implication, what the argument *establishes*. Once each argument has been individually graded and found short of demonstration, only one live theistic option remains: that the arguments are meant to work together. Leaving this out makes every verdict look like a bare list of failures.

ANALYSIS: It is also the concealed premise of the 2018 comparison question. Aquinas' Five Ways and Udayana's collected grounds (*hetus*) are both **collections**, and the correct comparative point is that each is a cumulative case rather than a single knock-down proof.

2. The two grades of inductive force - state them exactly

C-INDUCTIVE argument

The premises RAISE the probability of the conclusion,
without making it more probable than not.
 $P(\text{theism} \mid \text{evidence}) > P(\text{theism})$
but not necessarily > 0.5
|
| several independent C-inductive arguments
▼
P-INDUCTIVE argument

The premises make the conclusion MORE PROBABLE THAN NOT.
 $P(\text{theism} \mid \text{total evidence}) > 0.5$

FACT: The distinction is Richard Swinburne's, in *The Existence of God*. ANALYSIS: Use the two terms precisely: they are not synonyms, and a script that treats every theistic argument as C-inductive has conceded the theist's whole case in advance.

3. The structure of the case, step by step

FACT: (1) Cosmological, teleological, consciousness, providence, religious-experience and moral arguments are individually C-inductive at best. (2) On a confirmation model, several *independent* C-inductive arguments can jointly yield a P-inductive result. (3) That result holds only if the prior probability of theism is not vanishingly small and the evidence-items do not merely repeat one another. (4) Swinburne adds that theism has a high prior on grounds of **simplicity**: a personal explanation citing one agent with infinite - hence non-arbitrary - degrees of power, knowledge and freedom is simpler than any finite alternative.

ANALYSIS: Steps (3) and (4) are where the argument is attacked, and a top script attacks them by name rather than complaining vaguely that "probability is subjective".

4. Rope, chain and legal brief - the images that decide the answer

Image	What it implies	Verdict
ANALYSIS: Chain	The case is as strong as its weakest link; one broken argument destroys it	FACT: Wrong model - the components are not deductions, so there is no link to break
FACT: Rope	Many strands, none reaching end to end, jointly bearing the load	FACT: The standard theistic image
FACT: Legal brief / jury	Converging circumstantial evidence, no item sufficient alone	FACT: Basil Mitchell's analogy in <i>The Justification of Religious Belief</i>

FACT: Distinguish the cumulative case also from **inference to the best explanation**, which compares rival *total* hypotheses rather than accumulating confirmation from independent items. They are often run together, but they are different logical operations, and saying so is worth a mark.

5. Objection - Antony Flew's ten leaky buckets

FACT: **Flew's objection** (*God and Philosophy*): ten buckets that each leak hold no more water when stacked than any one of them; zero plus zero is zero. If each theistic argument fails, their conjunction fails too.

FACT: **The standard reply**: the objection would be correct only if each argument had *no* evidential force. A C-inductive argument by definition has some force, so the correct image is strands of a rope, or Bayesian updating on successive independent items of evidence. ANALYSIS: The reply is only as good as the claim that the components really do raise probability - which must be argued case by case, not asserted.

6. Objection - underdetermination

ANALYSIS: The same aggregation procedure would confirm rival hypotheses: a finite designer, a committee of gods, an impersonal value-principle. FACT: Swinburne answers by simplicity, which is supposed to select the single infinite agent; ANALYSIS: critics reply that "simplicity" is doing contested metaphysical work rather than neutral logical work.

ANALYSIS: **The decisive residue**: even a successful cumulative case delivers a probability, and a probability does not by itself select the personal, morally perfect, worship-worthy God of a living religion. That gap - between the God of the arguments and the God of religion - is the standing conclusion of the entire clause.

7. Objection - the case must be run as a net balance

ANALYSIS: Suffering is evidence on the other side. A cumulative case that sums only the favourable strands has not finished the calculation it began; the full evidential problem of evil belongs to Topic 03, but the *accounting requirement* belongs here.

8. Udayana's collection is the same move, eight centuries earlier

FACT: Udayana's *Nyāyakusumāñjali*, fifth section (*stabaka*), assembles distinct grounds - the world as effect, the conjunction of atoms, cosmic maintenance, the transmission of language and arts, the Veda's validity, its testimony, its sentence-form, and the special number at the first dyad - into one collected case. ANALYSIS: No single ground is offered as a demonstration; the force is meant to be joint.

ANALYSIS: **Therefore the sharpest comparative sentence available in this topic:** *"Udayana's collection and Swinburne's programme are structurally the same move, and Flew's leaky-bucket objection applies to both equally."*

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not treat a cumulative case as a chain of deductions; the chain image concedes the objection before it is made.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not use "C-inductive" and "P-inductive" interchangeably; the whole programme is the passage from the first to the second.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not present simplicity as a neutral logical virtue; it is a contested metaphysical premise in this debate.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not forget independence: repeating the same evidence in two vocabularies adds nothing on a confirmation model.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not run the case one-way; evil is evidence on the other side and the balance must be net.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not claim that the cumulative case reaches classical theism; at best it reaches a probable intelligent ground.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the leaky-bucket objection to Hume or the rope image to Flew.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "S-M-F":** Swinburne aggregates, Mitchell gives the jury analogy, Flew leaks the buckets.

Revision notes

- No single theistic argument is standardly defended today as demonstrative.
- A C-inductive argument raises probability; a P-inductive argument tips it past one half.
- Independent C-inductive arguments can jointly yield a P-inductive result on a confirmation model.
- Swinburne grounds a high prior for theism in the simplicity of one infinite personal agent.
- The correct image is a rope or a circumstantial legal brief, never a chain.
- Basil Mitchell's jury analogy is the standard illustration of converging evidence.
- Flew's ten leaky buckets objects that zero plus zero is zero.
- The reply is that C-inductive arguments are not zero-valued by definition.
- Underdetermination survives the reply: many hypotheses fit the same aggregated evidence.
- Simplicity is the proposed selector, and is itself contested.
- The case must be run as a net balance, with suffering counted on the other side.
- Udayana's collected grounds are the Indian instance of exactly this logical structure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CUMULATIVE-CASE LOGIC

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW CUMULATIVE-CASE LOGIC			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS cumulative case · C-inductive · P-inductive · rope not chain · leaky buckets · underdetermination	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Independent probability-raising strands are combined on a confirmation model, with simplicity supplying a non-negligible prior.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Flew answers that leaking buckets hold no water; the theist answers that C-inductive arguments are not zero-valued.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Even a successful aggregation yields a probability, not the personal and morally perfect God of worship.

SESSION 12 - COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS: THE WHOLE CLAUSE ON ONE PAGE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Comparative synthesis is the stage at which every proof and every critic is placed on a single grid, so that an answer can compare them instead of narrating them one by one.

Technical definition: Synthesis aligns each argument's starting point, claimed conclusion, Indian analogue, principal critic and surviving residue, producing a defensible verdict rather than an inventory.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

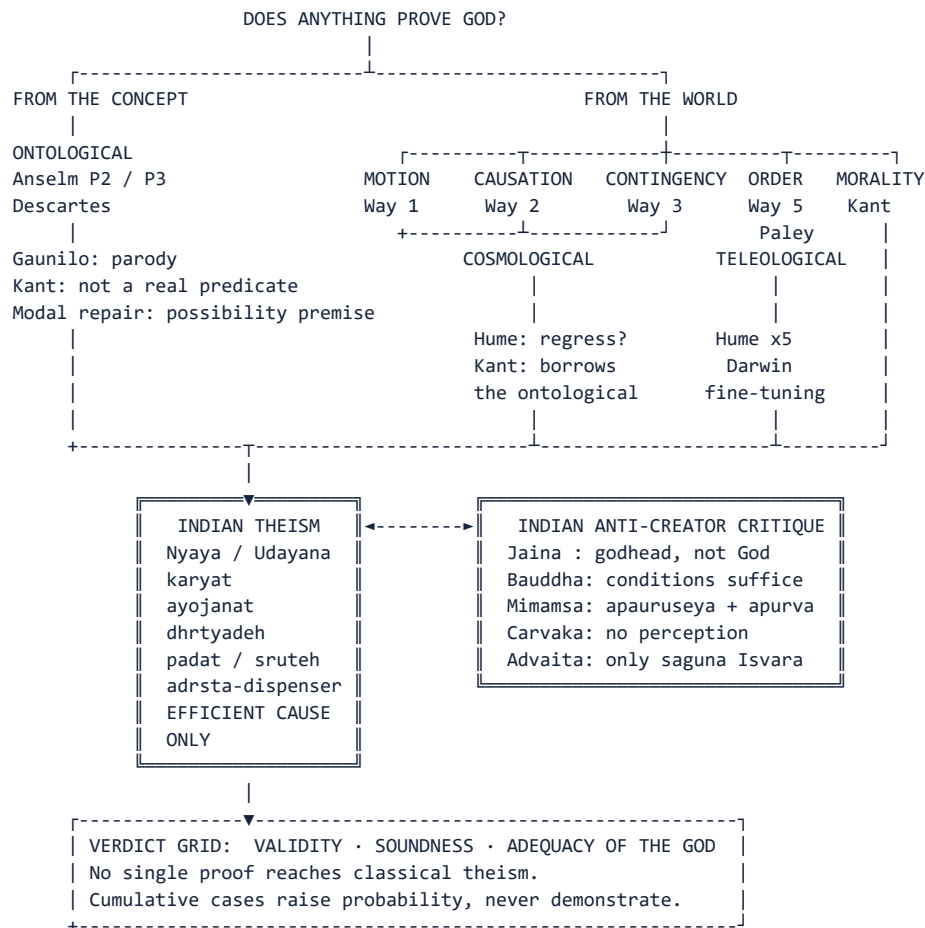
No proof is demonstrative unless it survives validity, soundness and adequacy together, and every argument in this clause - Indian and Western alike - underdetermines the rich God of religion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- parity bench
- surviving residue
- underdetermination
- efficient versus material causation
- critique from inside orthodoxy
- graded verdict

How to use them: Announce the axis of comparison before comparing, run both traditions down that axis, name what survives each critique, and close with one graded verdict rather than a hedge across several.

1. Master concept map - the whole syllabus item on one page



2. The master comparison table

Proof	Starting point	Conclusion claimed	Indian parallel	Main critic	What actually survives
Ontological	FACT: Concept of maximal being	Necessary existence	ANALYSIS: No exact classical analogue	Gaunilo, Kant	ANALYSIS: A conditional: <i>if</i> possible, then necessary
Cosmological	FACT: Motion, causation, contingency	First or necessary cause	FACT: Nyāya <i>kāryāt</i>	Hume, Kant	ANALYSIS: An explanatory demand, not a demonstration
Design	FACT: Order, adaptation, fine order	Intelligent designer	FACT: Nyāya <i>āyojanāt</i>	Hume, Darwin	ANALYSIS: Inference to the best explanation, at best
Moral	FACT: Moral law and the highest good	Practical postulate	FACT: Nyāya's fruit-giver (<i>karmaphaladātā</i>)	Naturalist axiology, Euthyphro	ANALYSIS: A rational hope internal to moral seriousness
Nyāya inference	FACT: World as composite effect (<i>kārya</i>)	Omniscient efficient cause	-	Mīmāṃsā, Buddhism, Jainism, Cārvāka	ANALYSIS: A cumulative theism vulnerable to the redundancy charge
Mīmāṃsā counter	FACT: Eternal Veda; self-operating <i>apūrva</i>	No creator required	-	Nyāya	FACT: A coherent non-theistic account of normativity
Jaina counter	FACT: Uncreated world; material karma	Godhood without God	-	Nyāya	FACT: A soteriological divinity without cosmology
Buddhist counter	FACT: Causal efficacy; conditioned co-arising	A permanent cause cannot produce a temporal world	-	Nyāya	FACT: The sharpest metaphysical objection in either tradition

3. Criticisms and replies - the consolidated grid

Objection	Proof affected	Reply	Assessment
FACT: "Existence is not a real predicate"	Ontological	ANALYSIS: Modal versions use <i>necessary</i> existence	ANALYSIS: The possibility premise now bears the burden
FACT: Fallacy of composition	Cosmological	ANALYSIS: The argument concerns dependence, not property-transfer	ANALYSIS: Must be framed as an essentially ordered series
FACT: Infinite regress may be acceptable	Cosmological	ANALYSIS: An infinite series of derivative causes supplies no actualising power	ANALYSIS: Requires showing the series is essentially ordered
FACT: The cosmological borrows the ontological	Cosmological	ANALYSIS: Thomists identify the necessary being with God by further argument	ANALYSIS: That further argument is itself disputable
FACT: Weak world-artefact analogy	Design, Nyāya	ANALYSIS: Treat as probabilistic rather than deductive	ANALYSIS: The conclusion becomes modest
FACT: Natural selection explains adaptation	Paley	ANALYSIS: Relocate the claim to law-governedness and fine-tuning	ANALYSIS: Rivals such as a multiverse remain available
FACT: The cause need not be one, personal or perfect	Cosmological, design	ANALYSIS: Cumulative arguments add attributes	FACT: No single proof reaches classical theism
FACT: Karma can operate without God	Nyāya	ANALYSIS: Intelligent allocation explains determinate desert	CAUTION: Tracks rival metaphysics
FACT: The Veda needs no author	Nyāya <i>padāt, śruteḥ, vākyāt</i>	ANALYSIS: Authorless normativity is itself unexplained	CAUTION: The most evenly matched Indian dispute
FACT: Moral values may be naturalistically explained	Moral	ANALYSIS: Kant postulates rather than infers	ANALYSIS: The postulate can still be declined
FACT: A permanent cause must act all-at-once or successively	Nyāya, classical theism	ANALYSIS: Eternal will with effects timed by unseen potency	ANALYSIS: A will timed by another is not the sole cause claimed
ANALYSIS: Divine redundancy	Nyāya	ANALYSIS: A supervisor who alone allots is not dispensable	ANALYSIS: Nyāya's hardest challenge

4. Four verdicts you may safely defend

ANALYSIS: Choose **one** as the thesis of any answer and defend it; do not hedge across all four.

- V1 MINIMAL : No proof is demonstrative; each fails on validity, soundness or adequacy. (Chatterjee-Datta, following Kant and Lotze.)
- V2 CUMULATIVE : Individually weak, jointly they raise the probability of theism. (Udayana; Swinburne; Mitchell.)
- V3 DIVERGENT : Different proofs establish different things - necessity, agency, intelligence, moral government - and no single one was ever meant to deliver the whole God of religion.
- V4 EXPERIENTIAL: Proofs are "pleas put forward in justification of our faith" (Lotze); God must be known through direct experience rather than through reasoning. (Chatterjee-Datta's own view.)

5. India and the West - convergence and divergence

Axis	FACT: Convergence	FACT: Divergence
Method	Both build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence	ANALYSIS: India has no a priori ontological route; Nyāya requires invariable concomitance (<i>vyāpti</i>)
Object established	Both reach an intelligent cause	FACT: Aquinas' God causes <i>being</i> ; Nyāya's Lord causes only <i>order</i>
Material cause	-	FACT: Creation from nothing versus the arrangement of eternal atoms
Moral government	FACT: Providence resembles the fruit-giver (<i>karmaphaladātā</i>)	ANALYSIS: Kant postulates it; Nyāya infers it
Scriptural authority	Both invoke revelation somewhere	FACT: Nyāya makes God the Veda's author; Mīmāṃsā makes the Veda authorless - no Western analogue
Aggregation	FACT: Both run collected rather than single arguments	ANALYSIS: Udayana's collection predates the Western confirmation-theoretic defence by eight centuries
Anti-theistic critique	FACT: Both traditions field economy, coherence and evil-based objections	ANALYSIS: India's critiques come from <i>within</i> orthodoxy (Mīmāṃsā, Sāṃkhya), not only from sceptics

ANALYSIS: **The best single comparative sentence in the topic:** *"Nyāya and Western natural theology converge in inferring from order to intelligence, but diverge over material causation and karma - and where the West's sharpest critics stood outside religion, India's stood inside it."*

6. Model philosophical conclusion

ANALYSIS: "The proofs for God's existence fail as demonstrations but succeed as diagnostics. The ontological argument shows that God, if real, cannot be a contingent item in the world; the cosmological arguments show that contingent reality does not explain itself; the design argument shows that order invites, without compelling, an intentional explanation; the moral argument shows what a serious moral agent must hope; and Nyāya shows that the same inferential path was walked in India, and met the same objections from Mīmāṃsā and Buddhism that Hume and Kant later pressed in Europe. What no proof delivers is the passage from the being it establishes to the God actually worshipped - which is why every tradition, Indian and Western alike, eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith."

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not compare without first naming the axis of comparison; an unannounced comparison reads as parallel narration.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not say Aquinas and Udayana reach "the same God"; one causes being, the other arranges eternal atoms.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not present Indian anti-theism as a single position; four schools deny four different premises.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not describe Mīmāṃsā or Sāṃkhya as sceptical or irreligious; their critique is internal to orthodoxy.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not hedge across all four verdicts; select one, state the criterion, and pay its cost.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not omit the surviving residue column - "what survives" is what a graded verdict is made of.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not import theodicy; suffering enters here only as counter-evidence in the balance.

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "S-C-I-C-S"**: Starting point, Conclusion claimed, Indian parallel, Critic, Surviving residue - the five columns of any comparison in this topic.

Revision notes

- Comparison requires a stated axis before any content is compared.
- Each proof must be recorded with its starting point, claimed conclusion and surviving residue.

- The ontological argument survives only as a conditional about necessary existence.
- Cosmological arguments survive as an explanatory demand rather than a demonstration.
- Design survives at best as inference to the best explanation.
- The moral argument survives as a rational hope internal to moral seriousness.
- Nyāya's case survives as a cumulative theism facing the redundancy charge.
- Mīmāṃsā supplies a coherent non-theistic account of normativity.
- Jainism supplies divinity without cosmology; Buddhism supplies the sharpest metaphysical objection.
- Aquinas' God causes being; Nyāya's Lord causes order over eternal atoms.
- India's decisive critics stood inside orthodoxy, unlike Hume and Kant.
- Four verdicts are defensible; a good answer selects one and names its criterion.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS parity bench · surviving residue · underdetermination · efficient versus material causation · internal critique	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Each argument is aligned on starting point, claimed conclusion, analogue, critic and residue, so that comparison replaces narration.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Aquinas' God causes being while Nyaya's Lord arranges eternal atoms, so convergence in form conceals divergence in content.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Select one of the four defensible verdicts and pay its cost rather than hedging across all of them.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No proof is demonstrative unless it survives validity, soundness and adequacy together, and every argument in this clause underdetermines the rich God of religion.			

SESSION 13 - ANSWER ARCHITECTURE FOR PROOFS AND THEIR CRITIQUE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Answer architecture is the fixed order in which a proof question should be written, so that the directive is obeyed and no scoring element is forgotten under time pressure.

Technical definition: It converts the directive verb into a structural obligation, allocates the word budget across exposition, critique and verdict, and enforces the separation of validity, soundness and divine adequacy.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

For every proof the examiner is buying three separate answers - is it valid, are its premises true, and does its conclusion reach the God of religion - and most scripts answer only the first.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **directive fidelity**
- **premise reconstruction**
- **objection and reply, in that order**
- **graded verdict**
- **named criterion**
- **quotation discipline**

How to use them: Decode the directive first, reconstruct premises as numbered steps, attach the canonical objection to the premise it attacks, give the proponent's best reply, then grade the verdict against a criterion you have named.

1. Marks-wise architecture

10 marks (≈150 words, 7-8 minutes)

Name and classify the proof -> state its premises in sequence -> identify ONE presupposition -> give the canonical objection -> one-sentence verdict on what the proof actually establishes.

15 marks (≈220-260 words, 12-13 minutes)

Frame the explanatory question the proof answers -> reconstruct the argument as numbered steps -> give the canonical example (watch, pot, stick-and-stone) -> the critic's strongest objection -> the proponent's best reply -> assess VALIDITY and the ADEQUACY OF THE CONCLUSION SEPARATELY.

20 marks (≈320-360 words, 17-18 minutes)

Classify the family of proofs -> full internal steps -> contrast the Indian/Western analogue -> TWO objections with replies -> the underdetermination of divine attributes -> a graded, criterion-named conclusion.

2. Directive decoder - what the verb obliges you to produce

Directive	Examiner is buying	Structural consequence	Live example
Present an account of... along with its criticism	Two balanced halves, explicitly signposted	Split the page - exposition first, then critique; do not let critique eat exposition	2025 Q6(a) design and Hume; 2024 Q7(c) ontological, where 10+5 fixes the split
Critically examine / evaluate	Reconstruction and a verdict on validity <i>and</i> soundness	Premises -> presupposition -> objection -> reply -> graded verdict	2023 Q7(a) Nyāya; 2018 Q8(b) Buddhist
Compare X with Y	A stated third term of comparison	Announce the axes first, then run both traditions down each axis	2018 Q8(a) Aquinas and Nyāya - use Session 12 Section 5
Which do you find most interesting? Give reasons	A defended personal selection with a criterion	Name the criterion - explanatory reach? least contested premise? - before choosing	2022 Q6(a) Five Ways
Does the concept entail the existence?	Engagement with the <i>predicate</i> question	Kant's premise must be stated, not merely named	2018 Q6(c)
Which should be preferred? Give reasons	A ranking with a cost accounting	Prefer one, then state precisely what is lost	2022 Q8(a) a priori and a posteriori
State and evaluate the proofs propounded in [school]	Fidelity to what the school actually holds	If the school holds none, say so in line 1 and supply what it does hold	2019 Q5(e) Jainism
What proofs do X offer? Discuss	Enumeration with premises , not a list of labels	One line of content per named ground (<i>hetu</i>)	2025 Q7(b) Nyāya

MEMORY: **Rule:** for every proof, answer three separate questions - is it **valid**, are its premises **true**, and does its conclusion reach the **God of religion**?

3. Graded verdict ladder - what separates a 60 from a 70

Band	What the script contains	Typical fault
Weak (≈40%)	Names the four Western proofs and "Nyāya's inference"; narrates the watch	No premises; critique reduced to "Kant disagreed"
Average (≈50%)	One proof reconstructed; the standard critique attached	Indian side reduced to one sentence; validity and soundness not separated
Good (≈60%)	Premises numbered; presupposition named; one objection answered	The conclusion-gap from "first cause" to "God" is not noticed
Strong (≈65-70%)	Validity, soundness and adequacy separated; the Indian parallel argued rather than asserted; a reply supplied	Cumulative logic still treated as a chain
Top (≈70%+)	All of the above plus one discriminating distinction - essentially versus accidentally ordered series, C-versus P-inductive, ford-maker versus liberated soul, the successive-or-simultaneous dilemma - and a statement of what evidence would change the verdict	-

Graded-verdict templates:

- ANALYSIS: *Single-proof stem*: "The argument is valid on reading X, but its second premise is exactly what the critic denies; even if sound it delivers only ____, and the distance from that to the God of worship must be crossed by a separate argument."
- ANALYSIS: *Comparison stem*: "Aquinas and Udayana converge in form - both are cumulative inferences from the world's dependence and order - and diverge in content: Aquinas' God is the source of *being*, Udayana's the arranger of *eternal* atoms and the allocator of karmic results."
- ANALYSIS: *Anti-theistic stem*: "The school's negative case succeeds against the creator it targets - an anthropomorphic, motivated, changing maker - and leaves untouched the classical theist's non-needy, timeless creator; whether that surviving concept is intelligible is a different question."

4. How to write the answer paragraph - claim, evidence, analysis, qualification

ANALYSIS: Every substantive paragraph in this topic should be built in four moves. The demonstration below is for the 2025 design stem.

CLAIM : Paley's design argument is an argument from analogy, not a deduction.
 EVIDENCE : Natural Theology (1802) opens with a watch found on a heath whose parts are adjusted to a purpose, and transfers the inference to the adapted organism.
 ANALYSIS : The strength of the conclusion therefore tracks the closeness of the analogy, which is precisely what Hume's Philo denies: the universe resembles an organism at least as much as a machine.
 QUALIFICATION: The argument is not thereby refuted; it is demoted from demonstration to a probabilistic inference which Darwin later strips of its best biological evidence while leaving cosmic lawfulness untouched.

ANALYSIS: Repeat the same four moves for each of the topic's argument families. A paragraph that stops after evidence is descriptive; a paragraph that starts at analysis is unsupported.

5. "Which Way is philosophically most interesting?" - handling the 2022 evaluative demand

ANALYSIS: The question invites a **defended personal judgement**. The two strongest defensible answers:

Choice	Why defensible	What you must then show
ANALYSIS: Way 3 (contingency)	It alone asks the deepest question - why is there anything at all rather than nothing? - and connects to the live sufficient-reason and brute-fact debate	That you can state the quantifier-shift objection and the distinction between depending on another (<i>ab alio</i>) and existing from itself (<i>a se</i>)

Choice	Why defensible	What you must then show
ANALYSIS: Way 5 (purposiveness)	It generates the richest downstream tradition - Paley, Hume, Darwin, fine-tuning - and is the one still being fought over	That you can separate Aquinas' regularity premise from Paley's artefact analogy

ANALYSIS: **What loses marks:** choosing Way 2 and describing it as "the first cause who started the universe", which is not Aquinas' argument at all.

6. Quotation and attribution discipline

Item	Status	Safe use
"That than which nothing greater can be conceived"	FACT: Anselm, <i>Proslogion</i> 2	Quote, then give the reductio form
"Existence is not a real predicate"	FACT: Kant, <i>Critique of Pure Reason</i> , A598/B626 region	Quote in this standard English form
Watch and watchmaker	FACT: Paley , <i>Natural Theology</i> (1802), ch. 1	Never attribute to Aquinas
Aquinas' Five Ways	FACT: <i>Summa Theologiae</i> I q.2 a.3	Way 5 concerns regular directedness, not Paley's artefact analogy
Hume's design critique	FACT: <i>Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion</i> (1779), Parts II, V, VII, XI	Philo, not Cleanthes, carries the objections
Udayana's grounds	FACT: <i>Nyāyakusumāñjali</i> , fifth section (<i>stabaka</i>)	Give the Sanskrit term plus one clause; flag that glosses vary CAUTION:
Jaina anti-creator arguments	FACT: Assembled in Jinasena's <i>Mahāpurāṇa</i> and in Hemacandra	Attribute to the tradition; avoid verbatim English "quotations"
Buddhist anti-Lord argument	FACT: Śāntarakṣita's <i>Tattvasaṃgraha</i> with Kamalaśīla's commentary; Dharmakīrti	Cite the <i>argument</i> , never an English sentence
<i>Brahmajāla</i> (DN 1), <i>Aggañña</i> (DN 27), <i>Devadaha</i> (MN 101)	FACT: Verified canonical references	Paraphrase; translations differ
Bhūridatta Jātaka anti-creator verses	CAUTION: Widely cited, wording translation-dependent	Paraphrase only
"Ten leaky buckets"	FACT: Antony Flew, <i>God and Philosophy</i>	Pair it with the rope and confirmation reply
C-inductive and P-inductive	FACT: Richard Swinburne, <i>The Existence of God</i>	Use precisely; they are not synonyms

7. Final twenty-second audit before you close the answer

1. Did I obey the directive verb, and is the split visible on the page?
2. Are the premises numbered rather than narrated?
3. Is each objection attached to the premise it attacks?
4. Did I give the proponent's best reply, not a straw reply?
5. Did I separate validity, soundness and adequacy?
6. Did I name the criterion behind my verdict?
7. Is there one discriminating distinction the average script will not have?
8. Is the Indian or Western analogue argued rather than asserted?

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not answer a two-part directive with one undivided block; "along with its criticism" is a structural instruction.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not narrate a proof; reconstruct it as numbered premises.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not attach an objection to the wrong premise, which makes the reply unintelligible.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not give a verdict without naming its criterion.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not exceed the word band; the 2024 stem prints its own 10+5 split.

6. ANALYSIS: Do not invent page numbers, editions or English "quotations" for Sanskrit or Pali sources.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not close with "thus God's existence is proved" or "thus God does not exist"; neither is the demand.

MEMORY: Mnemonic - "D-P-O-R-V": Directive, Premises, Objection, Reply, Verdict.

Revision notes

- The directive verb fixes the structure before any content is chosen.
- Ten marks buys classification, premises, one presupposition, one objection and a one-line verdict.
- Fifteen marks adds the canonical example, the proponent's reply and a separated assessment.
- Twenty marks adds the Indian or Western analogue, a second objection and underdetermination.
- Every paragraph runs claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification.
- Validity, soundness and adequacy are three separate verdicts, not one.
- A defended personal choice requires the criterion to be named first.
- Way 3 and Way 5 are the two defensible answers to the 2022 evaluative demand.
- Philo, not Cleanthes, carries Hume's objections in the *Dialogues*.
- The watch belongs to Paley in 1802 and never to Aquinas.
- Sanskrit and Pali sources are cited by argument, not by invented quotation.
- The closing line states what the proof establishes, not whether God exists.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | ANSWER ARCHITECTURE FOR PROOFS AND THEIR CRITIQUE

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS directive fidelity · premise reconstruction · objection and reply · graded verdict · named criterion · quotation discipline	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Word budget is allocated across exposition, critique and verdict, and each objection is attached to the premise it attacks.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Validity, soundness and divine adequacy are graded separately, which is what distinguishes a strong script from an average one.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Never close on whether God exists; close on what this particular argument establishes and what it cannot.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For every proof the examiner is buying three separate answers - is it valid, are its premises true, and does its conclusion reach the God of religion - and most scripts answer only the first.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Philosophy Optional is examined only at the Mains stage, so **no question below is a Prelims previous-year question**. All thirty-two are original UPSC-style diagnostics written against this owner's doctrine.

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed **independently**, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated and no cycle such as ABCD - or its reverse - can be used to guess. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

Coverage: the twenty-four core questions run across the whole printed clause - *Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)* - covering the three tiers of assessment, the a priori/a posteriori division, Anselm's two forms with Gaunilo and Kant, the modal repair, essentially ordered causal series, the Five Ways, the Leibnizian and temporal-beginning variants, Kant's charge against the cosmological argument, the composition objection, the Fifth Way against Paley's analogy, Hume's five-front critique, the exact scope of Darwin's defeat, fine-tuning and its rivals, Kant's practical postulate, the three moral routes with the Euthyphro pressure, Nyāya's efficient causation, Udayana's grounds (*hetus*), unseen moral potency (*adr̥ṣṭa*) with the karma-superintendent (*karmādhyaḥṣa*), the Jaina motive argument, the Buddhist successive-or-simultaneous dilemma (*krama-akrama-virodha*), Mīmāṃsā's authorless Veda (*apauruṣeya*) with Cārvāka's attack on inference, and cumulative-case logic. The eight remedial drills attack the errors that cost marks every year on this clause.

MCQ 1. The three tiers on which any proof of God is assessed

A script argues that Aquinas' Second Way is formally valid, that its causal premise is defensible, and that it therefore establishes the God of classical theism. Which tier of assessment has the script omitted?

- A. Validity - whether the stated conclusion actually follows from the premises as they are set out.
- B. Soundness - whether the causal premise on which the whole inference rests is in fact true.
- C. Adequacy - whether the being reached carries the unity, necessity, personality and goodness of God.
- D. Consistency - whether the argument sits comfortably beside the other four Ways in the same article.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: validity is the tier the script has already claimed, and no critic in this debate denies that the Second Way can be set out in valid form.
- **B:** Incorrect: soundness is also claimed, since the script explicitly defends the causal premise; the objection being missed lies beyond premise-truth.
- **C:** Correct: adequacy asks whether a first efficient cause is thereby one, necessary, personal and good - the gap Kant marks when he says the passage to the most real being is unsupplied.
- **D:** Incorrect: internal consistency across the Ways is not a standard assessment tier, and a mutually consistent set of arguments could still fail all three real tests.

Examiner trap 1: Treating "valid" and "true premises" as the finish line loses the marks reserved for the conclusion-gap; every graded verdict on this clause must separately answer *what God, if any, the argument delivers*.

MCQ 2. Where the a priori / a posteriori line actually falls

Consider the following statements about the classification of theistic arguments.

1. The ontological argument is the only classical proof that reasons from the concept of God alone.
2. Nyāya's inference to the Lord (*Īśvara-anumāna*) counts as a priori because its conclusion is an omniscient being.
3. Kant's moral argument starts from the fact of obligation and is therefore a posteriori in its starting point.
4. Aquinas' Fourth Way is a priori because it works with the notion of maximal perfection.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only, because classification follows the source of the premises rather than the conclusion.
- B. 1, 2 and 4 only, because any argument reaching a perfect being must reason from that concept.
- C. 2 and 3 only, because omniscience and obligation are both non-empirical starting conditions.
- D. 1 and 4 only, because both begin from notions rather than from any observed feature.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: statement 1 holds because no other classical proof reasons from the concept alone, and statement 3 holds because Kant begins from the moral law as a datum of practical experience.
- **B:** Incorrect: statement 2 fails because Nyāya begins from the world as a composite effect and needs invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*) fixed by observation.
- **C:** Incorrect: statement 2 is false for the same reason, and dropping statement 1 discards the one uncontested a priori case in the whole tradition.
- **D:** Incorrect: statement 4 fails because the Fourth Way begins from *observed degrees* of goodness, truth and nobility, not from a concept of the maximum.

Examiner trap 2: Candidates classify by the modality of the conclusion; the examiner classifies by the source of the premises, which is why an argument to a necessary being can still be thoroughly a posteriori.

MCQ 3. The two forms of Anselm's argument

Which statement states the difference between *Proslogion* 2 and *Proslogion* 3 correctly?

- A. *Proslogion* 2 was composed against Gaunilo's parody, whereas *Proslogion* 3 was composed against Kant's predicate objection.
- B. The two forms establish an identical conclusion, the second being a devotional restatement without new argumentative content.
- C. *Proslogion* 2 establishes necessary existence by aseity, while *Proslogion* 3 retreats to existence in the understanding alone.
- D. *Proslogion* 2 argues that real existence is greater than mental existence, and *Proslogion* 3 that necessary existence is greater still.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Gaunilo's *In Behalf of the Fool* replies *after* the *Proslogion*, and Kant writes seven centuries later, so neither can be the addressee of a chapter.
- **B:** Incorrect: the second form changes the modal status of the conclusion from bare existence to necessary existence grounded in self-existence (*aseity*), which is new content.
- **C:** Incorrect: this inverts the two chapters; nothing in *Proslogion* 3 weakens the conclusion, and the weaker mental-existence claim is the assumption being refuted.
- **D:** Correct: the first form uses the comparative "greater in reality", and the second upgrades it to a being whose non-existence cannot be thought - the form Anselm needs against Gaunilo.

Examiner trap 3: Reproducing only *Proslogion* 2 makes Anselm's reply to the island parody unintelligible, because that reply depends entirely on necessary existence being unavailable to any contingent thing.

MCQ 4. Gaunilo's island and what Anselm's reply actually secures

Which statement best describes the exchange between Gaunilo and Anselm?

- A. Gaunilo shows that existence is not a determining predicate, and Anselm concedes the point while retaining the devotional value of the formula.
- B. Gaunilo parodies the form with a most perfect island, and Anselm replies that necessary existence belongs to God alone and to no contingent thing.
- C. Gaunilo denies that the fool possesses the concept of God at all, and Anselm answers by appealing to the authority of scripture rather than to argument.
- D. Gaunilo accepts Anselm's first form and rejects the second, while Anselm defends the first form and abandons the second as superfluous.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the predicate objection is Kant's diagnosis, not Gaunilo's parody, and Anselm concedes nothing - he restricts the argument's scope instead.
- **B:** Correct: an island is by definition a contingent piece of the physical world and can be thought not to exist, so the principle does not reach it; the cost is that coherence of maximal greatness must now be shown independently.
- **C:** Incorrect: Anselm's whole strategy is that the fool *does* possess the concept and is refuted out of his own understanding, and the reply is argumentative rather than scriptural.
- **D:** Incorrect: Anselm relies on the second form precisely to answer the parody, so he can neither abandon it nor rest the reply on the first form alone.

Examiner trap 4: A stronger script also notes that Gaunilo wrote of the most perfect *of* islands rather than the most perfect *conceivable* island - correcting the parody before answering it signals genuine reading of the exchange.

MCQ 5. Kant's objection stated precisely

Kant's central objection to the ontological argument is best stated as which of the following?

- A. Existence is not a real or determining predicate; it posits an object rather than adding content to a concept.
- B. The concept of a maximally great being is internally contradictory in the way that a round square is contradictory.
- C. Empirical evidence for a supremely perfect being is unavailable, so the conclusion cannot be responsibly asserted.
- D. The argument commits a fallacy of composition by moving from parts of the concept to the whole concept.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: a hundred real coins contain no more concept than a hundred possible coins - only the holder's position differs - so nothing can be defined into existence.
- **B:** Incorrect: Kant does not claim demonstrable incoherence; that is the later burden the modal defender must discharge about the possibility premise.
- **C:** Incorrect: demanding empirical evidence would misdescribe an a priori argument, and Kant's point is logical rather than evidential.
- **D:** Incorrect: the composition fallacy is raised against cosmological reasoning about the contingent totality, not against Anselm's conceptual comparative.

Examiner trap 5: Writing "Kant refuted Anselm because we cannot see God" replaces a logical objection with an empiricist slogan and forfeits the predicate analysis the question is actually buying.

MCQ 6. What the modal reconstruction changes and what it does not

Malcolm, Hartshorne and Plantinga rebuild the argument around necessary existence. What is the accurate verdict on that repair?

- A. It removes Kant's objection entirely, because modal logic shows that necessary existence is a determining predicate after all.
- B. It abandons Anselm's second form and returns to the comparative reasoning of the first form dressed in symbolic notation.
- C. It survives the predicate objection but transfers the whole burden to the possibility premise, which a contrary possibility offsets.
- D. It converts the argument into an a posteriori inference, since possible worlds are established by empirical cosmological survey.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: overstating the repair is a common script fault; necessary existence is defended as a modal status rather than as a rehabilitated ordinary predicate.
- **B:** Incorrect: the modal versions work exclusively with the second form, because only necessary existence gives the inference from one possible world to every world.
- **C:** Correct: if maximal greatness is possible it is actual, but "possibly no maximally great being exists" yields the contrary result by the same logic, so coherence must be argued separately.
- **D:** Incorrect: possible-worlds semantics is a modal framework, not an empirical survey, so the argument stays a priori throughout.

Examiner trap 6: Announcing that the modal version "answers Kant" without naming the possibility premise reads as borrowed confidence; the mark lies in showing that the burden migrated rather than vanished.

MCQ 7. Essentially ordered and accidentally ordered causal series

Why does the distinction between essentially and accidentally ordered causal series matter for Aquinas' Ways?

- A. It shows that the universe must have begun a finite time ago, which is the conclusion the First and Second Ways are designed to reach.
- B. It shows that the "first" member is first in explanatory dependence, so an infinite series of derivative causes still lacks non-derivative causal power.
- C. It shows that Aquinas is arguing about temporal succession, so any beginningless universe would defeat the first three Ways outright.
- D. It shows that efficient causes and final causes are interchangeable, so the Second and Fifth Ways collapse into a single argument.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Aquinas explicitly does not need a first moment; a temporally beginningless world is compatible with a here-and-now dependence hierarchy.
- **B:** Correct: a hand moves a stick which moves a stone only while the hand acts, so borrowed power at every level never adds up to underived power, however long the chain.
- **C:** Incorrect: reading "first" temporally is the standard misreading; it makes the regress objection look decisive when it is not even on target.
- **D:** Incorrect: the Second Way concerns ordered efficient causation and the Fifth Way concerns regular directedness of non-conscious things, and they are separately assessed.

Examiner trap 7: Scripts that write "there cannot be an infinite regress" without saying *which kind* of series is at issue give the critic a free win, because accidental series may indeed be beginningless.

MCQ 8. Mapping the Five Ways to their starting points

Which pairing of an Aquinas Way with its starting point is correct?

- A. The Third Way begins from observed grades of perfection and terminates in a maximum that causes all lesser instances.
- B. The Fourth Way begins from the regular goal-directed behaviour of things that lack knowledge of their end.
- C. The Fifth Way begins from the contingency of things that are able to be and not to be within the world.
- D. The First Way begins from change understood as the reduction of potentiality to actuality by something already actual.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: grades of perfection are the Fourth Way's starting point; the Third Way begins from things that come to be and pass away.
- **B:** Incorrect: goal-directed behaviour without knowledge is the Fifth Way's datum, which is why it is a governance argument rather than an artefact analogy.
- **C:** Incorrect: contingency belongs to the Third Way; the Fifth Way never argues from possibility and necessity at all.
- **D:** Correct: motion in Aquinas means change generally, analysed as actualisation of potential, which cannot be self-supplied by what is merely potential.

Examiner trap 8: Merging the Five Ways into one "first cause" argument destroys the 2022 evaluative demand, which asks which Way is philosophically most interesting and therefore presupposes that they are genuinely distinct.

MCQ 9. Aquinas, Leibniz and the temporal-beginning argument

Which statement correctly separates the three cosmological forms?

- A. All three argue alike that the universe began to exist and that whatever begins to exist must have an external cause.
- B. Aquinas argues from present dependence, Leibniz from why a contingent totality exists, and the third form from an origin premise.
- C. Leibniz argues from a first moment of time, Aquinas from sufficient reason, and the temporal-beginning form from essentially ordered series.
- D. Aquinas and Leibniz both rely on an origin in time, whereas the temporal-beginning form is neutral about whether the universe began.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: only the temporal-beginning form makes an origin its premise; flattening the three is exactly what makes the regress objection imprecise.
- **B:** Correct: the three differ in starting point and in what each must defend - dependence hierarchy, the principle of sufficient reason, and the beginning premise respectively.
- **C:** Incorrect: this swaps the labels; sufficient reason is Leibniz's engine and the dependence hierarchy is Aquinas'.
- **D:** Incorrect: it reverses the position of every form and would make Aquinas vulnerable to cosmological findings he never needed.

Examiner trap 9: A critic who says "science shows the universe may be beginningless" defeats only the temporal-beginning form; naming which form is hit is the difference between a graded verdict and a generic one.

MCQ 10. Kant's charge against the cosmological argument

Kant argues that the cosmological argument conceals a dependence on the ontological argument. What exactly is the alleged concealed step?

- A. The claim that every event must have a cause, which Kant regards as an unjustified extension of a category beyond experience.
- B. The claim that an infinite regress of causes is impossible, which Kant treats as an illegitimate application of totality.
- C. The claim that the world is contingent, which Kant thinks smuggles in a comparison with a necessary being.
- D. The claim that a necessary being must be the most real being, which can only be shown by analysing the concept of God.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Kant's causal worry belongs to his general critique of the categories and is not the specific charge of ontological dependence.
- **B:** Incorrect: the regress issue is a separate antinomy problem and does not involve identifying the terminus with the supremely perfect being.
- **C:** Incorrect: contingency is conceded as the starting datum; the disputed move happens after a necessary being has been reached.
- **D:** Correct: the passage from "a necessary being exists" to "that being is God" is achieved only by unpacking the divine concept, which is the ontological procedure.

Examiner trap 10: Answering Kant with "but the world clearly needs a cause" misses the target, because his objection concerns the identification of the terminus rather than the demand for one.

MCQ 11. The composition objection and the brute-fact reply

Which statement most accurately reports the composition objection and the standard theistic reply?

- A. The objection is that a whole need not share a property of its parts; the reply is that the argument concerns dependence rather than a shared property.
- B. The objection is that the universe is a whole with no parts; the reply is that scientific cosmology has now settled the question.
- C. The objection is that causation is only a habit of mind; the reply is that habits of mind can still track real regularities.
- D. The objection is that God would also require a cause; the reply is that God is defined as uncaused by stipulation.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: "every member is contingent, so the collection is contingent" is the composition move, and the theist answers by restating the argument as one about explanatory dependence.
- **B:** Incorrect: nobody argues that the universe lacks parts, and appeals to settled cosmology are not what the classical exchange turns on.
- **C:** Incorrect: the habit-of-mind analysis is Hume's account of causal belief, a different line of attack from composition.
- **D:** Incorrect: bare stipulation would be question-begging; the serious reply argues that a necessary being's existence needs no external explanation.

Examiner trap 11: The reply is not complete until the answer records the standing counter - that allowing the contingent totality to be a brute fact rejects the principle of sufficient reason rather than refuting the argument.

MCQ 12. Aquinas' Fifth Way against Paley's watch

Which statement distinguishes the Fifth Way from Paley's design argument correctly?

- A. Both argue from artefacts to a designer, differing only in the illustration that each individual author happens to prefer.
- B. The Fifth Way argues from biological adaptation, whereas Paley argues from the regularity of inanimate physical law.
- C. The Fifth Way argues from regular directedness in things lacking knowledge; Paley argues by analogy from contrivance in artefacts.
- D. Paley argues that order is improbable on chance alone, whereas Aquinas argues that order is logically impossible without God.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: only Paley reasons by artefact analogy; treating the Fifth Way as an early watch argument invites Hume's analogy critique against a target it does not fit.
- **B:** Incorrect: this reverses the two, since Paley's leading case is the adapted organism and Aquinas' is the lawful behaviour of natural bodies.
- **C:** Correct: an arrow needs an archer because it lacks knowledge of its target, which is a governance argument rather than an inference from resemblance to machines.
- **D:** Incorrect: Aquinas claims explanatory necessity rather than logical impossibility, and probability language belongs to later formulations.

Examiner trap 12: Attributing the watch-and-watchmaker illustration to Aquinas is a factual error the examiner reads instantly; the watch belongs to Paley's *Natural Theology* of 1802.

MCQ 13. Hume's critique of the design argument

Which set correctly reports Hume's principal objections to the design argument?

- A. That design arguments are circular, that they misuse mathematical reasoning, and that they confuse necessity with contingency.
- B. That the world is too orderly to need explanation, that analogy is always invalid, and that intelligence is impossible without a body.
- C. That order is an illusion, that natural theology is irreligious, and that only special revelation can ground belief in God.
- D. That the world-machine analogy is weak, that a cause need only be proportioned to its effect, and that evil and plural designers fit equally well.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: circularity and mathematical misuse are not Hume's charges here, and the necessity-contingency issue belongs to his treatment of cosmological reasoning.
- **B:** Incorrect: Hume never claims that analogy is invalid as such; his complaint is that this particular analogy is remote and therefore weak.
- **C:** Incorrect: Hume does not deny that order exists, and a retreat to revelation is the opposite of the position argued in the *Dialogues*.
- **D:** Correct: these are the objections Philo presses - weak analogy, proportioning, underdetermination between one perfect designer and several imperfect ones, and evil as counter-evidence.

Examiner trap 13: Attributing the objections to Cleanthes reverses the *Dialogues*; Philo carries the critical case and Cleanthes defends the analogy.

MCQ 14. The exact scope of the Darwinian objection

What does natural selection establish against the design argument, stated with proper limits?

- A. It disproves the existence of God by showing that the universe requires no explanation of any kind.
- B. It supplies a non-intentional explanation of biological adaptation, but does not by itself explain cosmic law or fine-tuning.
- C. It shows that Paley's watch analogy is invalid because watches, unlike organisms, are manufactured objects.
- D. It shows that apparent purpose in nature is an illusion produced by human psychological projection alone.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: a biological mechanism cannot disprove a metaphysical thesis, and the design argument survives in cosmological rather than biological form.
- **B:** Correct: cumulative selection removes the need for a designer of adapted organisms, which was Paley's chosen evidence, while leaving the lawfulness that selection presupposes untouched.
- **C:** Incorrect: the manufactured-object point is Hume's disanalogy complaint, available a century before Darwin and independent of him.
- **D:** Incorrect: projection is a psychological diagnosis of belief, whereas selection is a causal explanation of the adaptation itself.

Examiner trap 14: Writing "Darwin destroyed the design argument" overreaches; the mark is earned by naming precisely which evidence base was displaced and which was not.

MCQ 15. Fine-tuning and its live rivals

Which statement about fine-tuning arguments is most defensible?

- A. Fine-tuning is a demonstrative proof, since the improbabilities involved are large enough to exclude any alternative.
- B. Fine-tuning is irrelevant to philosophy of religion, because physical constants are empirical matters with no metaphysical bearing.
- C. Fine-tuning offers at best a probabilistic consideration, and must be weighed against multiverse and observer-selection rivals.
- D. Fine-tuning revives Paley's analogy exactly, since the universe is shown to be literally a machine with adjusted parts.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no probability claim yields demonstration, and the assignment of prior probabilities to constants is itself contested.
- **B:** Incorrect: the argument is philosophically live precisely because it concerns what best explains lawful conditions, not merely what the constants are.
- **C:** Correct: fine-tuning is an inference to the best explanation that must survive comparison with a multiverse ensemble and with anthropic observer-selection reasoning.
- **D:** Incorrect: contemporary formulations abandon the artefact analogy and argue probabilistically about initial conditions and constants.

Examiner trap 15: Using contemporary cosmology as if it were evidence *for* God converts a contested objection-space into a claimed proof, which the owner's evidence discipline explicitly forbids.

MCQ 16. What Kant's moral argument claims

Which statement reports Kant's moral argument accurately?

- A. God and immortality are postulates of practical reason required for the possibility of the highest good, not objects of theoretical proof.
- B. Moral obligation is unintelligible unless commanded by a divine lawgiver, so conscience theoretically demonstrates God.
- C. The existence of objective moral values proves God, since only a transcendent ground can make values stance-independent.
- D. Morality proves God because virtue is in fact rewarded with happiness in the observable course of human life.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the moral law already obligates autonomously; God enters only as a condition under which virtue and proportionate happiness could be united.
- **B:** Incorrect: the divine-lawgiver route is a different moral argument, and Kant's autonomy thesis is designed to exclude heteronomous command.
- **C:** Incorrect: the value-grounding route is an abductive argument associated with moral realism, again not Kant's postulate.
- **D:** Incorrect: the manifest absence of such proportionality in experience is exactly why Kant must postulate rather than observe.

Examiner trap 16: Writing that "Kant proves God through morality" contradicts the whole architecture of the first *Critique*; the correct formula is demolition of the theoretical proofs followed by practical reinstatement.

MCQ 17. Three moral routes and the Euthyphro pressure

Which statement correctly relates the moral-argument routes to the Euthyphro dilemma?

- A. The dilemma refutes Kant's postulate, since a postulated God cannot ground any obligation whatever.
- B. The dilemma applies only to the conscience route, because conscience is a psychological faculty rather than a metaphysical ground.
- C. The dilemma is irrelevant to all three routes, since it concerns Greek piety rather than modern moral philosophy.
- D. The dilemma bears hardest on the divine-grounding route, asking whether acts are good because willed or willed because good.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Kant's postulate does not ground obligation at all - the moral law grounds itself - so the dilemma cannot bite there in the first place.
- **B:** Incorrect: the conscience route infers a lawgiver from the phenomenology of duty and is pressed instead by naturalistic explanations of conscience.
- **C:** Incorrect: the dilemma is a general structural test of any attempt to found value on will, and its Greek origin does not limit its reach.
- **D:** Correct: if goodness depends on will, morality becomes arbitrary; if will tracks antecedent goodness, the ground is not the divine will after all.

Examiner trap 17: Merging the three routes into "the moral argument" loses the marks, because the objection that defeats one route often leaves the other two untouched.

MCQ 18. God's causal role in Nyāya

Which statement states Nyāya's position on divine causation correctly?

- A. The Lord (*Īśvara*) is the efficient and ordering cause who arranges eternal atoms, and never their material cause.
- B. The Lord is the material cause of the world, since the atoms are produced out of divine substance at each creation.
- C. The Lord is both efficient and material cause, on the model of Advaita's single reality appearing as the world.
- D. The Lord is neither efficient nor material cause but only the witness of a process governed wholly by unseen potency.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: atoms (*paramāṇu*), selves, space, time and ether are eternal and uncreated, so the Lord arranges rather than manufactures from nothing.
- **B:** Incorrect: material causation would abolish the atomism on which the whole Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika cosmology rests.
- **C:** Incorrect: the single-reality model belongs to Advaita, which in any case treats the Lord as valid only at the empirical level.
- **D:** Incorrect: a mere witness could not perform the initial conjunction of atoms or allot karmic fruits, which are the Lord's defining functions here.

Examiner trap 18: Calling Nyāya's God a creator from nothing imports an Abrahamic frame; the examinable formula is *efficient and ordering cause of an eternal material stock*.

MCQ 19. Udayana's grounds for inferring the Lord

Which statement about Udayana's enumeration of grounds (*hetus*) is most accurate?

- A. The grounds are exactly eight, fixed in wording, and every commentator glosses them identically.
- B. The grounds are drawn from perception of the Lord rather than from inference, which is why Cārvāka cannot attack them.
- C. A mnemonic verse in the *Nyāyakusumāñjali* is conventionally unpacked as eight grounds, but glosses of the last four differ.
- D. The grounds were introduced by Vātsyāyana and rejected by Udayana as insufficiently rigorous for a formal proof.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: presenting a fixed canonical eight overstates the tradition, since translations divide and gloss *padāt*, *pratyayataḥ*, *vākyāt* and *saṃkhyāviśeṣāt* differently.
- **B:** Incorrect: the whole apparatus is inferential (*anumāna*), which is exactly why Cārvāka's attack on inference to the supersensible is on target.
- **C:** Correct: the safe practice is to give the Sanskrit term with one clause of content and to flag that enumerations vary, rather than reciting a list of labels.
- **D:** Incorrect: earlier statements in Vātsyāyana, Uddyotakara and Jayanta are systematised rather than rejected by Udayana's fifth section (*stabaka*).

Examiner trap 19: Listing eight Sanskrit words without a clause of content each converts an argument into vocabulary; the 2025 stem asks what proofs are offered, which means premises, not labels.

MCQ 20. Unseen moral potency and the karma-superintendent

Why does Nyāya argue that unseen moral potency (*adr̥ṣṭa*) requires a superintendent (*karmādhyaḥṣa*)?

- A. Because unseen potency is a physical substance and every substance needs an owner to hold it in existence.
- B. Because unconscious merit and demerit cannot themselves select which agent receives which determinate fruit.
- C. Because the Veda states that the Lord dispenses fruits, and scriptural testimony settles the metaphysical question.
- D. Because karma would otherwise operate instantaneously, leaving no interval in which moral effort could matter.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: unseen potency is a quality of selves rather than a substance, and ownership would not explain intelligent allocation in any case.
- **B:** Correct: allocation is a discriminating act, and an unconscious residue has no capacity to match a specific result to a specific agent at a specific time.
- **C:** Incorrect: appealing to the Veda here would be circular, since Udayana separately argues that the Veda's authority itself presupposes a trustworthy author.
- **D:** Incorrect: timing objections belong to the Buddhist attack on a permanent cause, not to Nyāya's positive case.

Examiner trap 20: The Jaina and Mīmāṃsā reply - that karmic maturation is law-like, as poison acts without a supervisor - must be recorded, or the answer presents one side of a live dispute as settled.

MCQ 21. The Jaina case and what Jainism affirms instead

Which statement about the Jaina position is correct?

- A. Jainism proves a creator through the argument that its six substances require an intelligent external coordinator.
- B. Jainism denies a creator and also denies every form of divinity, making it indistinguishable from plain materialism.
- C. Jainism denies a creator and relocates divinity in the perfected soul, distinguishing the ford-maker from the liberated soul (*siddha*).
- D. Jainism treats the ford-maker as a responsive deity who answers petition once the four obscuring karmas are destroyed.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the six substances are advanced as making a creator redundant, which is the parsimony (*lāghava*) move rather than a proof.
- **B:** Incorrect: Jainism is non-theistic but not irreligious; omniscient perfected beings occupy the place a creator would otherwise hold.
- **C:** Correct: every ford-maker becomes a liberated soul, but not every liberated soul was a ford-maker, and neither creates, judges or responds.
- **D:** Incorrect: the ford-maker is passion-free (*vītarāga*), so responsiveness is excluded by definition and worship is commemorative.

Examiner trap 21: The 2019 stem asks for "the proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism"; the first line must correct the presupposition rather than invent Jaina theistic proofs.

MCQ 22. The Buddhist dilemma about a permanent cause

The Buddhist argument from successive-or-simultaneous production (*krama-akrama-virodha*) claims which of the following?

- A. That God cannot be perceived, and that what cannot be perceived cannot be the subject of any valid inference whatever.
- B. That a permanent unchanging cause must produce either all at once or successively, and both options are fatal to the theist.
- C. That the Buddha's silence on cosmogony demonstrates that no creator exists, since an omniscient teacher would have said so.
- D. That dependent origination is compatible with a creator, provided the creator acts only at the beginning of each cosmic cycle.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the demand for perception is the Cārvāka line; Buddhist logicians argue on the invariable concomitance rather than refusing inference outright.
- **B:** Correct: all-at-once production collapses the world into a single instant, while successive production requires the acquisition of auxiliaries and hence change in God.
- **C:** Incorrect: the undeclared questions (*avyākata*) set cosmogony aside as soteriologically idle, which diagnoses the belief rather than refuting the proposition.
- **D:** Incorrect: conditioned co-arising is offered as a complete alternative that renders a creator explanatorily idle, not as a framework hospitable to one.

Examiner trap 22: Reducing the Buddhist case to "the Buddha was silent" surrenders the examinable argument; the metaphysical dilemma from Dharmakīrti and Śāntaraksita is what the 2018 stem is testing.

MCQ 23. Mīmāṃsā and Cārvāka against Nyāya's theism

Which pairing of school and objection is correct?

- A. Mīmāṃsā argues that the world is an effect requiring a maker, while Cārvāka argues that the maker must be perceptible.
- B. Mīmāṃsā argues that unseen potency needs a dispenser, while Cārvāka argues that the Veda needs an author.
- C. Mīmāṃsā accepts the Lord as arranger of atoms, while Cārvāka accepts inference but denies scriptural testimony.
- D. Mīmāṃsā argues that the Veda is authorless and karma self-fructifying; Cārvāka argues that inference cannot reach the supersensible.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the effect-to-maker premise is Nyāya's own, and Mīmāṃsā's entire strategy is to deny that scripture needs any author at all.
- **B:** Incorrect: the dispenser argument is Nyāya's, and the authorless Veda is precisely what Mīmāṃsā asserts against Udayana's testimony grounds.
- **C:** Incorrect: Mīmāṃsā does not accept the Lord as arranger, and Cārvāka's characteristic move is to restrict valid knowledge largely to perception.
- **D:** Correct: authorless scripture (*apauruṣeya*) with self-operating ritual potency (*apūrva*) removes Udayana's testimony grounds, and the attack on inference undercuts every inferential proof at once.

Examiner trap 23: Treating Jainism, Buddhism, Mīmāṃsā and Cārvāka as one "Indian atheism" collapses four different objections; each denies a different premise of Nyāya's case.

MCQ 24. Cumulative-case logic and the leaky-bucket objection

Which statement about cumulative cases for theism is correct?

- A. Several probability-raising arguments may jointly support theism, against which Flew objects that leaking buckets hold no water.
- B. A cumulative case is a chain of deductions, so it is exactly as strong as its own weakest individual component.
- C. A cumulative case succeeds only if at least one of its component arguments is demonstratively valid and sound.
- D. A cumulative case is identical with inference to the best explanation, since both compare rival total hypotheses.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: probability-raising arguments can aggregate on a confirmation model, and the standard reply to Flew is that such arguments are not zero-valued, so the rope image beats the bucket image.
- **B:** Incorrect: the chain metaphor is exactly the misreading; a rope or a circumstantial legal brief is the correct model.
- **C:** Incorrect: the programme's whole point is that no component is demonstrative, which is why aggregation is being proposed at all.
- **D:** Incorrect: best-explanation reasoning compares rival total hypotheses, while a cumulative case accumulates confirmation from independent evidence-items.

Examiner trap 24: A cumulative case must be run as a *net* balance, so an answer that ignores suffering as evidence on the other side has not completed the calculation it started.

Remedial MCQs - common-error repair

These eight drills target the conflation, inversions, misattributions and ownership errors that cost marks on this clause every year. Work them only after the twenty-four core diagnostics.

MCQ 25. Repairing the confusion of proof, inference, probability and postulate

Which classification of argumentative force is correct?

- A. Anselm claims probability, Paley claims demonstration, and Kant claims an inference to the best explanation.
- B. All theistic arguments claim demonstrative force, and the differences between them are purely stylistic.
- C. All theistic arguments claim only probability, so the word "proof" in the syllabus is simply a misprint.
- D. Anselm claims deduction, design and fine-tuning claim probability or best explanation, and Kant claims a practical postulate.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this inverts every attribution, since Anselm's *reductio* is deductive in form and Paley's is explicitly an argument from analogy.
- **B:** Incorrect: design arguments in their modern form claim confirmation rather than demonstration, and Kant refuses theoretical proof altogether.
- **C:** Incorrect: the ontological family does claim deductive force, so a blanket probability reading misdescribes the tradition.
- **D:** Correct: sorting the arguments by claimed force is the first move of a graded verdict, because each force-type is defeated in a different way.

Examiner trap 25: Using "proof" as a single undifferentiated word makes every critique look equally decisive; naming the claimed force first is what allows a proportionate verdict at the end.

MCQ 26. Repairing the temporal reading of "first cause"

A candidate writes that Aquinas proves the universe began at a first moment. What is the correct repair?

- A. Aquinas does prove a temporal beginning, but only in the Third Way, which the candidate has failed to cite.
- B. Aquinas proves a temporal beginning by philosophical argument, though he also accepts it on scriptural grounds.
- C. Aquinas holds that a temporal beginning is known by faith, and his Ways argue instead from present dependence.
- D. Aquinas denies any beginning, holding an eternal universe to be demonstrable against the theologians.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Third Way argues from contingency rather than from an origin, and none of the five is a temporal-origin argument.
- **B:** Incorrect: the claim that a beginning is philosophically demonstrable is precisely what Aquinas withholds.
- **C:** Correct: the Ways are compatible with a beginningless world because "first" marks explanatory priority in a here-and-now dependence hierarchy.
- **D:** Incorrect: he denies that eternity is demonstrable too, holding the question philosophically undecided either way.

Examiner trap 26: This repair is worth marks in itself: stating that Aquinas did not need a first moment immunises the answer against the most common critical objection raised in scripts.

MCQ 27. Repairing the fusion of Paley with Aquinas

Which correction of "Aquinas' watch argument" is right?

- A. The watch belongs to Paley's *Natural Theology* of 1802; Aquinas' Fifth Way argues from regular directedness without knowledge.
- B. The watch belongs to Aquinas' Fifth Way; Paley's contribution was to add the eye and the telescope as further illustrations.
- C. The watch belongs to Hume, who introduced it in the *Dialogues* in order to expose the weakness of the analogy.
- D. The watch belongs to Kant, who used it to show that purposiveness is a regulative rather than a constitutive idea.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: keeping the two apart matters because the analogy critique lands on Paley's argument and not on the governance argument.
- **B:** Incorrect: this compounds the error; the eye and telescope comparison is also Paley's, not a supplement to Aquinas.
- **C:** Incorrect: Hume attacks the artefact analogy but did not originate it, and his *Dialogues* precede Paley's book.
- **D:** Incorrect: Kant's treatment of purposiveness in the third *Critique* is a separate doctrine and involves no watch.

Examiner trap 27: Because the 2025 stem pairs the design argument with Hume's criticism, the attribution must be exact; a misattributed illustration undermines the exposition half of a two-part answer.

MCQ 28. Repairing "Hume proved there is no designer"

What does Hume's critique actually establish?

- A. That the universe is demonstrably the product of blind matter in motion over infinite time.
- B. That the inference is weak and its conclusion underdetermined, not that no designer exists.
- C. That design arguments are meaningless because theological language fails verification.
- D. That the argument is valid but unsound because its analogy premise is empirically false.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the Epicurean hypothesis is offered as a live rival that the theist cannot exclude, not as an established cosmology.
- **B:** Correct: Hume attacks inferential strength and the identification of the cause, leaving the existence question open rather than closed.
- **C:** Incorrect: verification-based dismissal is a twentieth-century move belonging to the religious-language clause.
- **D:** Incorrect: Hume's complaint is that the analogy is remote and therefore weak, which affects inductive strength rather than deductive soundness.

Examiner trap 28: Overstating Hume converts a careful sceptic into a dogmatic atheist and forfeits the balance the "along with its criticism" directive is buying.

MCQ 29. Repairing the presupposition in the Jainism stem

A stem asks candidates to state and evaluate the proofs for God's existence as propounded in Jainism. What is the correct opening move?

- A. State in the first line that Jainism propounds no proof of a creator, then supply its arguments against one and its account of divinity.
- B. Reply that the question is defective and decline to answer, since no Jaina proof of a creator exists.
- C. Supply the Nyāya proofs instead, since Jainism shares the atomism on which those proofs depend.
- D. Reconstruct the six substances as an implicit proof, treating their coordination as evidence of an intelligent orderer.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: fidelity to what the school holds is the graded demand, and the answer then earns marks through the motive, regress, instrument, moral, redundancy and own-nature arguments plus the perfected-soul doctrine.
- **B:** Incorrect: refusing to answer forfeits the paper; the stem is trap-shaped rather than unanswerable.
- **C:** Incorrect: Jainism does not share Nyāya's atomism in the relevant sense, and substituting another school's material answers a different question.
- **D:** Incorrect: manufacturing a Jaina theistic proof is the exact hallucination the trap is designed to detect.

Examiner trap 29: A script that says only "Jainism is atheistic" loses half the marks; the positive doctrine of divinity as achieved perfection is part of what the stem asks to be evaluated.

MCQ 30. Repairing "Buddhism denies all gods"

Which statement corrects the claim that Buddhism denies the existence of all divine beings?

- A. Buddhism accepts a creator but denies that the creator is omnipotent or morally perfect.
- B. Buddhism denies a creator while accepting long-lived impermanent divine beings inside the round of rebirth.
- C. Buddhism denies all divine beings, and later celestial figures in Mahāyāna are purely allegorical.
- D. Buddhism suspends judgment on every question about divine beings as an undeclared matter.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the target of the Buddhist critique is precisely the world-making function, which is denied outright rather than qualified.
- **B:** Correct: Buddhism is non-theistic rather than simply atheistic - it rejects world-making by a lord (*īśvara-kāraṇa-vāda*), not devotion or the existence of gods (*deva*).
- **C:** Incorrect: Buddha-fields and celestial bodhisattvas perform genuine religious functions within the tradition's own self-understanding.
- **D:** Incorrect: the undeclared questions concern speculative cosmogony and the fate of the liberated, not the existence of gods as such.

Examiner trap 30: The distinction between rejecting a creator and rejecting divinity is the difference between a precise comparative answer and a generic "Eastern atheism" paragraph.

MCQ 31. Repairing the material-cause error in Nyāya

A candidate writes that Nyāya's Lord creates matter from nothing. What is the correct repair?

- A. The Lord creates selves but not atoms, since selves are the only entities requiring an intelligent origin.
- B. The Lord creates atoms at the start of each cycle and reabsorbs them at dissolution, as in Sāṃkhya's account.
- C. The Lord creates nothing and merely observes, since unseen potency does all the causal work in the system.
- D. Atoms, selves, space, time and ether are eternal; the Lord is the efficient cause who conjoins atoms according to unseen potency.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: selves are eternal and uncreated in this system, so partial creation of selves misstates the ontology twice over.
- **B:** Incorrect: Sāṃkhya has no lord as world-maker in its classical form, and Nyāya's atoms are never produced.
- **C:** Incorrect: a purely observing lord could not perform the initial conjunction or allot fruits, which are the argued functions.
- **D:** Correct: this states the ontology and the causal role together, which is what a comparison with Aquinas' source of being requires.

Examiner trap 31: The 2018 comparison question turns on this point: Aquinas' God is the source of *being*, Udayana's the arranger of an *eternal* material stock and the allocator of karmic results.

MCQ 32. Repairing the chain reading of a cumulative case

Which correction of "the cumulative case is only as strong as its weakest argument" is right?

- A. The saying is correct, because a cumulative case is a deductive chain in which any failed link breaks the inference.
- B. The saying is correct, because probability cannot be transferred between arguments with different subject matter.
- C. The saying misdescribes the structure: independent probability-raising strands aggregate like a rope or circumstantial brief.
- D. The saying is irrelevant, because cumulative cases are used only in Indian philosophy and not in Western natural theology.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the components are not deductions, so there is no link to break; the chain image imports the wrong logical form.
- **B:** Incorrect: independent evidence-items with different subject matter are exactly what confirmation models are designed to combine.
- **C:** Correct: the rope and the jury's converging circumstantial evidence are the standard images, and Udayana's collection of grounds is structurally the same move.
- **D:** Incorrect: the programme is prominently Western in Swinburne and Mitchell, and its Indian analogue is the point of the comparison, not a substitute for it.

Examiner trap 32: The correct verdict still concedes the underdetermination objection - aggregation may raise probability without selecting the personal, morally perfect God of worship.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

All 12 verified owner PYQs - exact wording, year and marks

All 12 items below are direct verified owner PYQs. Exact wording, years and marks are retained. Demand decoding, full model solutions, marks rationale, timing skeletons and examiner traps are pedagogic answer support, not an official answer key.

Corpus note: FACT: The audited Paper II corpus for 2018-2025 contains **12 primary-owned question-parts** for this syllabus item, out of 112 parts overall. The corpus is continuous across all eight years. Cross-linked questions owned by *Notions of God, Reason-Revelation-Faith or Soul, Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation* are not duplicated here.

#	Year	Q	Marks	Theme
1	2018	Q6(c)	15	Ontological - concept and existence
2	2018	Q8(a)	20	Aquinas' Five Ways vs Nyāya
3	2018	Q8(b)	15	Buddhist arguments against a creator
4	2019	Q5(e)	10	Jaina proofs
5	2020	Q6(a)	20	Is Anselm's proof logical?
6	2021	Q7(b)	15	Moral argument
7	2022	Q6(a)	20	Five Ways; most interesting
8	2022	Q8(a)	20	A priori vs a posteriori
9	2023	Q7(a)	20	Nyāya arguments
10	2024	Q7(c)	15 (10+5)	Ontological proof with criticism
11	2025	Q6(a)	20	Design argument with Hume's criticism
12	2025	Q7(b)	15	Nyāya proofs

PYQ 1 - 2018, Q6(c), 15 marks

Exact question

"Does the concept of God entail the existence of God? Examine from the perspective of ontological argument."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine</i> - analyse the entailment claim and deliver a reasoned verdict; not a narrative of Anselm's life
Core issue	Whether conceptual analysis can establish instantiation
Scope boundary	Stay inside the ontological family; do not drift into Aquinas or Nyāya
Ideal thesis	The concept entails necessary existence conditionally - if God exists, God exists necessarily - but conceptual entailment cannot deliver instantiation
Non-negotiables	Both forms of Anselm; Descartes; Gaunilo; Kant; the modal repair and its possibility-premise burden

Model answer (≈240 words)

The ontological argument claims a unique entailment: that the very concept of God contains, and therefore yields, God's existence. Anselm defines God as "**that than which nothing greater can be conceived**", where "greater" means more perfect. In *Proslogion* 2 he argues by *reductio*: if this being existed only in the understanding, a greater could be conceived - namely the same being existing in reality as well - which contradicts the definition. In *Proslogion* 3 the claim is strengthened: a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can; God therefore exists **necessarily**, by aseity. Descartes recasts this through essence-containment: existence belongs to a supremely perfect being as three angles belong to a triangle.

The entailment fails at a precise point. **Gaunilo's** perfect-island parody shows the form proves too much; Anselm replies that only God is defined with necessary, non-contingent existence, which an island by definition lacks. That reply protects the second form but shifts the burden onto the coherence of maximal greatness. **Kant's** objection is decisive: existence is not a real predicate. A hundred real thalers contain no more concept than a hundred possible ones; existence posits an object rather than enriching a concept. Chatterjee and Datta restate this in the Indian idiom of a hundred rupees imagined in one's pocket.

Modal reconstructions retain necessary existence but transfer the whole weight to the **possibility premise**, which a parallel possibility-of-non-existence can offset.

Verdict: the concept entails existence **hypothetically**, not **actually**. Conceptual analysis yields a conditional, never an instantiation.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** state the entailment claim -> both Anselmian forms -> Descartes -> Gaunilo and reply -> Kant -> modal repair -> conditional verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *aliquid quo nihil maius cogitari possit*; aseity; necessary versus contingent existence.
- **Argument:** the *reductio* must be reproduced as steps, not paraphrased as a slogan.
- **Distinction:** conceptual entailment versus instantiation; Anselm's comparative form versus Descartes' essence-containment form.
- **Technical terms:** real predicate, determining predicate, necessary existence, possibility premise.
- **Criticism:** Gaunilo attacks the *form*; Kant attacks the *logic of existence*. Do not merge them.
- **Comparison:** one line noting that Indian philosophy has no a priori analogue, for *pramāṇa*-theoretic reasons.
- **Conclusion:** a conditional entailment verdict - the strongest available and the one the question invites.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : State the entailment claim precisely
4 min : Proslogion 2 and 3 as numbered steps; Descartes
3 min : Gaunilo + Anselm's reply; note the shifted burden
3 min : Kant - existence is not a real predicate; thaler illustration
2 min : Modal repair; possibility-premise burden
1 min : Verdict - hypothetical entailment, not instantiation
Total : 14 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing only *Proslogion* 2 and omitting necessary existence: **loses Anselm's reply to Gaunilo entirely**.
- Attributing the island to Kant or the thaler to Gaunilo: **factual error, heavily penalised**.
- Answering "yes, God exists" or "no, God does not exist": **the question is about entailment, not theology**.
- Importing the cosmological argument: **out of scope**.
- Saying the modal version "refutes Kant": **overstatement; the burden merely migrates**.
- Concluding without distinguishing conceptual from actual entailment: **the whole point of the question missed**.

PYQ 2 - 2018, Q8(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Compare St. Thomas Aquinas' five ways of knowing God with the arguments of the Nyāya School of Indian Philosophy for the existence of God."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Compare</i> - a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two separate essays
Core issue	Whether two independent a posteriori natural theologies reach the same God by the same route
Scope boundary	Both sets of arguments must be reconstructed; neither may be reduced to a label
Ideal thesis	Structural convergence in inferring intelligence from order; decisive divergence over material causation and the role of karma
Non-negotiables	All five Ways named; at least four Nyāya arguments named in Sanskrit; the efficient/material cause distinction

Model answer (≈345 words)

Aquinas and the Naiyāyikas both practise **a posteriori** natural theology: each begins from a general feature of the world and argues to an ultimate intelligent reality. Their convergence is real, and so is their divergence.

Aquinas' **Five Ways** (Summa Theologiae I, q.2, a.3) argue from change to a prime mover; from efficient causation to a first cause; from contingency to a necessary being; from degrees of perfection to a maximum; and from purposive regularity in non-cognitive nature to a divine intelligence. The regress he excludes is **essentially ordered** - the stick moves the stone only while the hand moves the stick - so "first" means **explanatory priority**, not the earliest event in time.

Nyāya's Īśvara-anumāna proceeds through several routes. **Kāryāt**: composite objects are effects, since they are made of parts (*sāṃyava*) and possess intermediate magnitude (*avāntara-mahattva*); material causes cannot achieve the required order and co-ordination without an intelligent maker, who must be **omniscient**, since only such a being can directly know atoms. **Āyojanāt**: inert atoms need purposive combination. **Dhṛtyādeḥ**: the world's support and dissolution require governance. **Padāt / śruteḥ**: Vedic authority presupposes an omniscient author. Finally, the argument from **adr̥ṣṭa**: the unconscious stock of merit and demerit cannot allot determinate joys and sorrows, so God is **karmaphaladātā**.

The **convergence**: both infer intelligence from order; both add attributes stepwise rather than by definition; both are cumulative rather than single-inference systems, Udayana multiplying routes exactly as Aquinas multiplies Ways.

The **divergence** is decisive. Aquinas' God is the cause of *being*, creating *ex nihilo*; Nyāya's Īśvara is the **efficient cause only**, ordering eternal, uncreated atoms while souls, space, time and *adr̥ṣṭa* remain co-present with Him. Aquinas' proofs are *praeambula fidei* drawn from reason alone; two Nyāya arguments are explicitly scriptural. Aquinas' God is unconditioned; Nyāya's is morally constrained by *adr̥ṣṭa*.

Consequently the critiques differ in weight. Hume's analogy objection strikes Nyāya hardest, since its inference is expressly artefact-modelled on pot and potter; while the redundancy objection - that karma and atoms could operate without a supervisor - is uniquely Indian and, as C. D. Sharma presses it, uniquely damaging.

Verdict: the same inferential architecture, but not the same God: Aquinas' terminus is metaphysically ultimate, Nyāya's is cosmically administrative.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: a comparative frame first, then axis-by-axis treatment - never two disconnected halves.
- **Doctrine**: all five Ways correctly identified; at least four Nyāya routes with Sanskrit terms.
- **Argument**: the essentially ordered series and the *sāṃyava* / *avāntara-mahattva* criteria of effect-hood must both appear.
- **Distinction**: *nimitta-kāraṇa* versus *upādāna-kāraṇa*; explanatory versus temporal priority.
- **Technical terms**: *kāryāt*, *āyojanāt*, *dhṛtyādeḥ*, *padāt*, *śruteḥ*, *adr̥ṣṭa*, *karmaphaladātā*, *praeambula fidei*.

- **Comparison:** the Janet-Lotze-Martineau parallel, plus the observation that Western theists make God the source of existence and Nyāya only of order.
- **Criticism:** Hume's analogy objection on Nyāya; the redundancy objection; Kant's ontological-borrowing charge on Aquinas.
- **Conclusion:** same architecture, different terminus - stated as a criterion-named judgement.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Comparative frame - two a posteriori natural theologies
 4 min : Five Ways, with the per se series and "first = explanatory"
 5 min : Nyaya routes with Sanskrit terms and the omniscience step
 3 min : Convergence - inference from order; cumulative structure
 4 min : Divergence - material causation, scripture, moral constraint
 2 min : Differential critique - Hume on Nyaya; redundancy; Kant on Aquinas
 1 min : Criterion-named verdict
 Total : 21 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing Aquinas for ten minutes and Nyāya for ten with no comparison: **the directive is unanswered; heavy loss.**
- Calling Nyāya's God the material cause: **the topic's most penalised factual error.**
- Reducing the Five Ways to "first cause": **collapses four distinct arguments.**
- Omitting Sanskrit terminology: **loses the Optional's technical premium.**
- Claiming Nyāya is "the Indian Aquinas" without qualification: **false equivalence.**
- Ending with "both are similar": **an ungraded conclusion earns no evaluative marks.**

PYQ 3 - 2018, Q8(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"Critically evaluate the Buddhist arguments against the existence of God as the creator of the world."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate</i> - state the arguments, then judge their force, including where they fail
Core issue	Whether conditioned arising renders a creator explanatorily and morally unnecessary
Scope boundary	The target is <i>jagat-kartā</i> , a world-maker; Buddhism's rejection of the sacred is not at issue
Ideal thesis	The arguments are decisive against an anthropomorphic purposive world-maker, weaker against a metaphysically refined classical theism
Non-negotiables	At least four canonical lines, plus the theistic replies

Model answer (≈245 words)

Buddhism rejects a creator God (*jagat-kartā*) without rejecting spiritual ultimacy; its critique is a systematic refusal of **explanatory surplus** rather than bare atheism.

Four canonical lines recur. First, if God is **eternal and unchanging**, genuine creation is hard to explain, since willing or producing appears to involve change; Dharmakīrti-type reasoning sharpens this - a permanent, immutable cause fully present at all times should produce its effect always and at once, never in temporal succession. Second, if God creates **from desire or purpose**, this implies lack, preference or incompleteness, which is inconsistent with perfection. Third, **suffering and evil** sit uneasily with an omnipotent benevolent creator. Fourth, **dependent origination** already explains the arising of phenomena through conditions, so a creator is redundant. To these may be added the methodological point that questions of a first beginning fall among the *avyākṛta*, undeclared because soteriologically idle - the wounded man who insists on knowing the archer before the arrow is removed.

Evaluation must be even-handed. The change objection assumes a **temporal model of divine willing**; classical theism answers with a single eternal act producing a temporal effect. The desire objection assumes creation must remedy a lack; theists appeal to gratuitous diffusive goodness. Most importantly, Nyāya replies that dependent origination explains **sequence** but not **desert-appropriate allocation**: an unconscious nexus cannot proportion

determinate fruit to determinate merit. Explanatory economy, moreover, is a methodological preference, not a disproof.

Verdict: Buddhism establishes that a coherent, ethically serious cosmology is possible without a creator. That is a substantial philosophical achievement - but it shifts the burden of proof rather than closing the question.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** clarify the target -> four to six arguments as reconstructions -> theistic replies -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *pratītyasamutpāda*; the *avyākṛta* questions; anti-*Īśvara* argumentation in Dharmakīrti and Śāntarakṣita.
- **Argument:** the immutability-succession incompatibility must be stated as an argument, not as an assertion.
- **Distinction:** rejecting a creator ≠ atheism in the Western sense; *nāstika* = denier of Vedic authority.
- **Technical terms:** *jagat-kartā*, *pratītyasamutpāda*, *avyākṛta*, explanatory parsimony.
- **Comparison:** one line linking Buddhist economy to Hume's Epicurean hypothesis and Darwinian sufficiency.
- **Criticism:** the Nyāya allocation reply is the strongest counter and must appear.
- **Conclusion:** decisive against a purposive anthropomorphic maker; inconclusive against refined theism.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Clarify the target - jagat-karta, not the sacred
 6 min : Immutability/succession · desire implies lack · evil · dependent origination · avyakṛta silence · freedom-karma dilemma
 4 min : Replies - eternal act, diffusive goodness, Nyaya on allocation, economy is methodological
 2 min : Note that nastika means denial of Vedic authority
 1 min : Graded verdict
 Total : 14 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Treating the arguments as a proof of atheism: **misstates their logical status**.
- Writing a devotional account of the Buddha instead of arguments: **no philosophical content**.
- Omitting the replies in a "critically evaluate" question: **the directive is half-answered**.
- Calling Buddhism *nāstika* in the sense of "spiritually nihilistic": **terminological error**.
- Confusing the Buddhist argument from evil with the full problem of evil: **scope drift**.
- Ending with "hence God does not exist": **unwarranted and penalised**.

PYQ 4 - 2019, Q5(e), 10 marks

Exact question

"State and evaluate the proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>State and evaluate</i> - exposition plus judgement, in 150 words
Core issue	In what sense Jainism has a God at all, and what it proves about that God
Scope boundary	Do not write a general essay on Jaina metaphysics
Ideal thesis	Jainism denies God as creator but affirms godhead ; its proofs establish attainable perfection, not a cosmic maker
Non-negotiables	The denial/affirmation disambiguation; at least two positive proofs; one evaluative limit

Model answer (≈160 words)

Jainism denies God as **creator**: the world was never created, since all substances are eternal and change only through modes (utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya). But "**Jainism denies God, and yet does not deny godhead. Every liberated soul is a god.**"

Its proofs are accordingly proofs of attainable divinity. First, from the **intrinsic nature of the jīva**: every soul possesses infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power (*ananta-catuṣṭaya*), obscured by material karma rather than absent - for we observe degrees of knowledge, not its absence. Second, from **gradation to a limiting case**: *matī*, *śrūta*, *avadhi* and *maṇaḥparyāya* mark progressive removal of karmic obstruction, whose complete removal is **kevala-jñāna**, omniscience. Third, from the **testimony of the omniscient Tīrthaṅkaras** (*āpta-vacana*), mortals who won liberation by personal effort - "we are all potential Jinās".

Evaluation: these establish a plural, achieved, non-creative godhood and rest wholly on Jaina premises - intrinsic omniscience and material karma. They neither prove nor attempt a cosmic God. Sharma's dilemma bites: if karma is inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if separable, bondage is.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: disambiguate "God" -> three proofs -> one internal criticism -> verdict, all within 150 words.
- **Doctrine**: *ananta-catuṣṭaya*; the five knowledges; *kevala-jñāna*; *siddha* and Tīrthaṅkara.
- **Argument**: the gradation-to-limiting-case inference must be visible as an inference.
- **Distinction**: God as world-maker versus God as perfected being; Jaina karma is **material (pudgala)**, not *adrṣṭa*.
- **Technical terms**: *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya*, *āpta-vacana*, *tri-ratna*, *nāstika* correctly glossed.
- **Comparison**: one clause contrasting this with Nyāya's efficient-cause creator.
- **Criticism**: the bondage/liberation dilemma, or the internality of the premises.
- **Conclusion**: a soteriological rather than cosmological theism.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Denies creator, affirms godhead - the controlling distinction
 4 min : Three proofs, compressed but as arguments
 2 min : Evaluation - premises internal to Jaina metaphysics; Sharma's dilemma
 1 min : Verdict - soteriological, not cosmological, theism
 Total : 8 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing "Jainism is atheistic, so there are no proofs": **misreads the question and forfeits most marks**.
- Substituting a general account of *anekāntavāda* or the *tri-ratna*: **off-question**.
- Equating Jaina karma with Nyāya's *adrṣṭa*: **doctrinal error**.
- Calling the *siddha* a creator or governor: **contradicts the doctrine**.
- Exceeding the word limit at the cost of the evaluation: **the second directive verb is lost**.

PYQ 5 - 2020, Q6(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Is the ontological proof for the existence of God by St. Anselm logical? Discuss."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Discuss</i> an evaluative question - you must take a position on logicality , not merely on truth
Core issue	Whether the argument is formally valid, and whether its validity is purchased by an illegitimate use of "exists"
Scope boundary	Anselm centrally; Descartes and modal versions only as extensions
Ideal thesis	The argument is formally coherent as a reductio , but it is not <i>logically compelling</i> , because its crucial premise misclassifies existence
Non-negotiables	Both forms; the validity/soundness distinction; Gaunilo; Kant; a stated verdict

Model answer (≈350 words)

Whether Anselm's proof is "logical" must be split into two questions: is it **valid**, and is its key premise **legitimate**?

Anselm's *Proslogion* 2 argument is a *reductio*. Suppose that than which nothing greater can be conceived exists in the understanding alone. Existing in reality is greater than existing in the understanding alone. Then a greater than the greatest conceivable could be conceived - a contradiction. Therefore it exists in reality. Formally this is impeccable: given the definition and the comparative premise, the conclusion follows. *Proslogion* 3 strengthens it: a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can, so God exists **necessarily**; since God as infinitely perfect is not limited by time, both coming-to-be and ceasing-to-be are excluded.

The difficulty is not the inference but the **comparative premise**. Gaunilo, in *In Behalf of the Fool*, constructs a parallel for the most perfect conceivable island; if the form is valid, it manufactures islands. Anselm replies that only God is defined as having eternal and independent existence, whereas an island - a piece of land surrounded by water - is by definition contingent and can without contradiction be thought not to exist. The reply succeeds for the second form, but it transfers the burden: it must now be shown that **maximal greatness is a coherent notion with an intrinsic maximum**, whereas island-perfections plainly are not.

Kant supplies the decisive diagnosis. Existence is not a real predicate: it adds nothing to a concept but posits its object. A hundred real thalers contain no more concept than a hundred possible ones. If so, "existing in reality is greater" is not a legitimate comparison of concepts at all, and the argument is valid only in the trivial sense that it correctly draws out what was illicitly built in. Modern quantificational analysis reinforces this by treating existence as second-order.

Modal reconstructions by Malcolm, Hartshorne and Plantinga preserve necessary existence and are formally valid in S5; but their **possibility premise** - that a maximally great being is possible - is precisely what is disputed, and a symmetrical possibility-of-non-existence yields the opposite conclusion.

Verdict: Anselm's proof is **logically well-formed but not logically compelling**. It is valid in form, question-begging in premise, and at best establishes a conditional: if a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** split "logical" into validity and legitimacy -> both forms -> Gaunilo -> Kant -> modal -> explicit verdict.
- **Doctrine:** the *reductio* structure; aseity; necessary existence.
- **Argument:** the comparative premise must be isolated as the load-bearing step.
- **Distinction:** validity versus soundness; a well-formed argument versus a compelling one.
- **Technical terms:** real predicate, determining predicate, S5, possibility premise, second-order quantification.
- **Comparison:** one line noting Chatterjee-Datta's parallel hundred-rupees formulation in the Indian tradition.
- **Criticism:** Gaunilo attacks the form's generality; Kant attacks the concept of existence. Both are needed.
- **Conclusion:** an explicit, defended answer to "is it logical?" - hedging is penalised here more than anywhere else in this topic.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Split the question - valid? legitimate premise?
 5 min : *Proslogion* 2 as a *reductio*; *Proslogion* 3 and necessary existence
 4 min : Gaunilo, Anselm's reply, and the transferred burden
 5 min : Kant's diagnosis; the quantificational reinforcement
 3 min : Modal versions and the possibility premise
 2 min : Explicit verdict - well-formed, not compelling
 Total : 21 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Answering "no, because God cannot be proved": **does not engage logic at all**.
- Treating validity and soundness as one thing: **the question's whole hinge is missed**.
- Omitting *Proslogion* 3: **Anselm's reply to Gaunilo becomes unintelligible**.
- Presenting Kant's objection as "Kant said God does not exist": **serious misattribution**.
- Refusing to give a verdict: **"Discuss" with an evaluative stem requires a position**.

PYQ 6 - 2021, Q7(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"Give a critical account of moral argument to prove the existence of God."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critical account</i> - full exposition plus sustained criticism
Core issue	Whether moral experience can establish, or rationally require, belief in God
Scope boundary	Both forms of the moral argument; the other proofs only as contrast
Ideal thesis	The inferential form begs the question; Kant's postulational form is defensible but is not a proof
Non-negotiables	Kant's three postulates; the highest good; "ought implies can"; Euthyphro correctly aimed

Model answer (~250 words)

The moral argument claims that ethical experience presupposes the reality of God. It takes two very different forms.

The **first form** is a straightforward inference: from objective moral laws to a divine Law Giver, or from conscience to a God whose voice it is. Newman's Grammar of Assent argues that feeling shame and fear before conscience implies One before whom we are ashamed. The objection is fatal: this assumes that moral values admit of **no naturalistic explanation** in terms of human needs, social structure or practical reason. That assumption is precisely what is in dispute, so the argument **begs the question**.

The **second form**, Kant's, is not strictly a proof. Having demolished the speculative proofs in the *Critique of Pure Reason* - the ontological by denying that existence is a real predicate, the cosmological by showing it borrows the ontological - Kant reinstates God in the *Critique of Practical Reason*. The moral law obligates us to promote the **highest good**, virtue together with proportionate happiness. "Ought implies can" requires that the highest good be really possible. But holiness is unattainable in finite time, and nature does not proportion happiness to desert. Hence three **postulates of practical reason**: freedom, immortality and God - objects of rational faith, practically necessary and theoretically undemonstrable.

Criticism cuts several ways. The postulate may be a projection of a desire for cosmic fairness, though Kant answers that it arises from the structure of moral reason, not from reward-seeking, which would be heteronomy. If morality is autonomous, God's role is confined to realisability, not obligation - which also insulates Kant from the **Euthyphro dilemma**, whose real target is divine-command theory. Adequacy remains the deepest problem: as Hick notes, moral values cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, self-existent personal creator.

Verdict: as a proof it fails, and Kant never offered it as one; as an account of what moral seriousness rationally presupposes, it retains genuine force. Nyāya's *karmaphaladātā* addresses the same problem but claims knowledge where Kant claims only hope.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** two forms distinguished -> Kant's derivation as steps -> four to five criticisms -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *summum bonum*; the three postulates; *Vernunftglaube*; autonomy.
- **Argument:** "ought implies can" must be shown doing work, not merely quoted.
- **Distinction:** postulate versus demonstration versus empirical hypothesis.
- **Technical terms:** heteronomy, practical reason, fact of reason, Euthyphro.
- **Comparison:** the Nyāya *karmaphaladātā* parallel, with the epistemic contrast.
- **Criticism:** projection, autonomy tension, adequacy; and Euthyphro aimed at divine-command theory, not Kant.
- **Conclusion:** it establishes a rational hope, not a demonstrated being.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Two forms flagged at once
2 min : Newman's inferential form and the question-begging objection
5 min : Kant - CPR demolition, then the highest good and three postulates
4 min : Criticism - projection, autonomy, Euthyphro's real target, adequacy
2 min : Nyaya comparison
1 min : Graded verdict
Total : 15 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Writing "Kant proves God through morality": **the single most penalised error in this topic.**
- Listing only one postulate: **loses the systematic structure.**
- Aiming Euthyphro at Kant: **misapplied objection.**
- Treating the postulate as a reward-motive: **contradicts Kant's own doctrine of autonomy.**
- Omitting the first form entirely: **"critical account" of the moral argument requires both.**
- Omitting any Indian comparison in a Paper II answer: **loses the comparative premium.**

PYQ 7 - 2022, Q6(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Present a critical exposition of different arguments offered by St. Thomas Aquinas to prove the existence of God also known as 'Five Ways'. Which one of them do you find philosophically most interesting? Give reasons in support of your answer."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Two directives: <i>critical exposition</i> of all five, and a defended personal judgement
Core issue	Whether the Ways are distinct arguments, and which best withstands scrutiny
Scope boundary	All five must appear; the chosen Way must then be developed further
Ideal thesis	The Ways are five distinct arguments; Way 3 (or Way 5) is most interesting, for stated philosophical reasons
Non-negotiables	The <i>per se</i> / <i>per accidens</i> distinction; "first" as explanatory; a reasoned choice with objections handled

Model answer (≈350 words)

Aquinas' Five Ways (ST I, q.2, a.3) are **five distinct a posteriori arguments**, not one argument restated. Each begins from a general feature of the world and concludes with the cautious formula "and this everyone understands to be God" - itself an admission that further work is needed to identify the terminus with the God of religion.

Way 1 argues from motion, understood as the reduction of potentiality to actuality: whatever is moved is moved by another, and an essentially ordered series of movers cannot regress infinitely, so there is an unmoved mover. **Way 2** argues from an order of efficient causes to a first efficient cause. **Way 3** argues from contingency: if everything were merely possible, at some time nothing would have existed, and nothing would exist now; hence there is a necessary being, and ultimately one necessary of itself. **Way 4** argues from degrees of goodness and truth to a maximum which causes all perfection. **Way 5** argues from the regular goal-directed activity of things lacking cognition to a directing intelligence, as the arrow is directed by the archer.

Critically, the excluded regress is **essentially ordered** - the stick moves the stone only while the hand moves the stick - so "first" denotes **explanatory priority**, not chronological firstness. Aquinas himself concedes the difficulty of excluding an endless series of *events*, and holds that the world's temporal beginning is known by faith, not demonstration; neo-Thomists accordingly recast the excluded series as simultaneous dependence. Way 3 is vulnerable to a quantifier shift at the step from "each thing at some time is not" to "at some time nothing is". Way 4 requires the Platonic machinery of participation, since degrees of heat do not entail a hottest object. Way 5 is exposed to Hume's analogy objection and, in Paley's later form, to Darwin. Kant's overarching charge is that the passage from "a necessary being" to "the most real being" is the ontological argument in disguise.

Most interesting: Way 3. It alone poses the deepest question - why is there anything at all rather than nothing? - and it is the only Way whose central premise, the Principle of Sufficient Reason, remains a live philosophical dispute against brute-fact naturalism. Its conclusion is also modally strongest: not merely a first mover but a being whose non-existence is impossible. That it is simultaneously the most vulnerable, at the quantifier-shift step, makes it philosophically the richest rather than the weakest - a bad argument for the best question is more instructive than a safe argument for a smaller one.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** all five expounded compactly -> critical apparatus -> a defended choice with its own objection answered.
- **Doctrine:** act and potency; *per se* causal series; contingency and necessity; participation.
- **Argument:** each Way in one or two premise-steps, never as a bare label.
- **Distinction:** explanatory versus temporal priority; Way 2 (causal dependence) versus Way 3 (modal status).
- **Technical terms:** *per se* / *per accidens*, PSR, *ab alio* / *a se*, quantifier shift.
- **Comparison:** one line on Nyāya's parallel cumulative structure, or on the Kalām's contrasting temporal claim.
- **Criticism:** Hume, Kant and one internal weakness per Way where space allows.
- **Conclusion:** the personal judgement must be argued, with a criterion named - depth of question, modal strength, or contemporary liveness.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Frame - five distinct a posteriori arguments
 7 min : Ways 1-5, each as premises
 5 min : Critical apparatus - *per se* series, Aquinas on eternity, quantifier shift, participation, Hume/Darwin, Kant
 5 min : The chosen Way, defended, with one objection met
 2 min : Conclusion naming the criterion of choice
 Total : 21 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Presenting the Ways as one "first cause" argument: **destroys the exposition mark.**
- Choosing a Way but giving no philosophical reasons: **the second directive is unanswered.**
- Choosing Way 2 and glossing it as "God started the universe": **misrepresents Aquinas.**
- Introducing Paley's watch as Aquinas': **factual error.**
- Asserting that Aquinas proves a temporal beginning: **contradicts ST I q.46 a.2.**
- Omitting all criticism in a "critical exposition": **half the directive lost.**

PYQ 8 - 2022, Q8(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Discuss the main points of distinction between a priori and a posteriori arguments for the existence of God. Which one according to you should be preferred over the other? Give reasons and justifications for your answer."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Discuss the distinction, and defend a preference with reasons
Core issue	The trade-off between modal strength and evidential contact
Scope boundary	Use exemplars from both families, Indian and Western; do not merely define
Ideal thesis	A criterion-relative preference: a posteriori for evidential respectability, a priori for modal strength, neither for religious adequacy
Non-negotiables	A multi-axis distinction table in prose; at least three exemplars; an explicit preference

Model answer (≈345 words)

The distinction is not merely one of subject matter but of **evidential source, method, modal outcome and characteristic vulnerability**.

An **a priori** argument reasons from the concept of God alone, without empirical premises. The ontological argument is the sole classical instance: Anselm derives existence, and then necessary existence, from the concept of that than which nothing greater can be conceived; Descartes derives it from the essence of a supremely perfect being. Its method is conceptual analysis, and its promised reward is enormous - if it works, it yields a **necessary** God, immune to empirical revision.

An **a posteriori** argument reasons from some general feature of the world. Aquinas' Ways begin from motion, causation, contingency, degrees and purposive order; Paley begins from means-end adjustment; Kant's moral argument begins from the structure of moral obligation; and Nyāya's Īśvara-anumāna begins from the world as a composite effect requiring an omniscient intelligent maker. Their method is inference from effect to cause, or inference to the best explanation, and their conclusions are correspondingly **probable** rather than necessary.

Their vulnerabilities differ accordingly. The a priori route faces Kant's charge that existence is not a real predicate, and Gaunilo's demonstration that the form proves too much; modal repairs shift the burden to an unestablished possibility premise. The a posteriori route faces Hume: the world-artefact analogy is weak, and from a finite effect one may infer only a finite cause. It is also exposed to scientific advance - Darwin against Paley, cosmological alternatives against the Kalām - whereas the a priori route is immune to empirical developments precisely because it is empirically empty.

Preference. I prefer the **a posteriori** route, on three grounds. First, **dialectical**: it begins from premises the opponent already grants - that things change, that order exists, that we are obligated - whereas the a priori route asks the opponent to grant a contested concept. Second, **epistemic**: it does not require the illegitimate treatment of existence as a determining predicate. Third, **traditional convergence**: two independent civilisations, Thomist Europe and Nyāya India, arrived at structurally similar a posteriori arguments, which suggests the route tracks something real in the explanatory demand.

But the preference must be **graded**. The price is that a posteriori arguments deliver at most a probable, possibly finite cause, and never the God of developed religion. If the criterion were modal strength rather than evidential contact, the ranking would reverse. **Neither route alone secures religious adequacy** - which is why every tradition eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: multi-axis distinction -> exemplars on both sides -> differential vulnerabilities -> a preference with three named reasons -> a graded qualification.
- **Doctrine**: ontological versus cosmological/teleological/moral/Nyāya families.
- **Argument**: the trade-off between modal strength and evidential contact must be made explicit.
- **Distinction**: conceptual entailment versus inference to a cause; necessity versus probability.
- **Technical terms**: real predicate, *vyāpti*, inference to the best explanation, underdetermination.
- **Comparison**: Nyāya must appear as an a posteriori exemplar - this is a Paper II answer.
- **Criticism**: Kant and Gaunilo on one side; Hume and Darwin on the other.
- **Conclusion**: criterion-relative preference, explicitly named, never a bare "both are useful".

Compact skeleton and timing

3 min : Four axes of distinction - source, method, modality, vulnerability
5 min : A priori exemplars - Anselm, Descartes, and the modal repair
5 min : A posteriori exemplars - Ways, Paley, Kant, Nyaya
3 min : Differential vulnerabilities
4 min : Preference with three reasons
1 min : Graded qualification naming the alternative criterion
Total : 21 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Defining the terms and stopping: **the second directive is ignored**.
- Equating a priori with "certain" and a posteriori with "uncertain": **conceptual error**.
- Omitting Nyāya: **a Paper II answer with no Indian material is under-marked**.

- Preferring one without naming a criterion: **an unjustified preference**.
- Claiming a priori arguments are Western and a posteriori Indian: **historically false**.
- Concluding "both are equally good": **fails the explicit demand for a preference**.

PYQ 9 - 2023, Q7(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Critically examine the arguments of Nyāya for the existence of God."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically examine</i> - full reconstruction, then rigorous evaluation
Core issue	Whether Nyāya's inferences establish an omniscient efficient cause
Scope boundary	The arguments , though a brief statement of the nature of Īśvara is needed to make them intelligible
Ideal thesis	Individually inconclusive and jointly cumulative; the redundancy objection is the deepest threat
Non-negotiables	Four to five arguments in Sanskrit; the efficient/material cause thesis; Indian critics before Western ones

Model answer (~350 words)

Nyāya offers a rational, inferential theism. Īśvara is an eternal, omniscient special self, the **first efficient cause** - a demiurgus or builder of the ordered universe - **not its material cause**; He is also preserver and destroyer, which distinguishes Nyāya theism from deism.

Kāryāt - the causal argument. All composite objects of the world are effects, since they are made of parts (*sāvayava*) and possess intermediate magnitude (*avāntara-mahattva*); space, time, ether and self are excluded as partless infinities, and atoms and *manas* as simple infinitesimals. Material causes alone cannot attain the order, direction and co-ordination that produce such effects. The intelligent cause must therefore have direct knowledge of the atoms, a desire for an end, and the will to realise it - and must be **omniscient**, since only an omniscient being can directly know entities so simple and infinitesimal as atoms.

Āyojanāt - inert atoms cannot combine purposively of themselves. **Dhṛtyādeḥ** - the world's support, maintenance and dissolution require governance. **Padāt / āptaprāmānya** - the Veda's authority derives from an omniscient author, as a science's authority derives from its founder; the jīva cannot be that author, since supramundane realities exceed ordinary cognition. **Śruteḥ** - scripture directly testifies to God. Finally, the argument from **adrṣṭa**: differences of lot require causes; karma supplies them; but the time-gap requires a persisting stock of merit and demerit; and *adrṣṭa*, being **unintelligent**, cannot allot precisely the joy and sorrow deserved, while individual selves neither know nor control it. Hence God is *karmaphaladātā*.

Critically: the **circularity** charge against the last two arguments is answered by distinguishing the order of existence (God creates the Veda) from the order of knowledge (the Veda discloses God); the **bodiless-agent** objection is met by a dilemma. But the deeper objections stand. Mīmāṃsā holds the Veda *apauruṣeya* and *apūrva* self-maturing, which dissolves two arguments at once. Buddhism and Jainism hold that conditions and material karma suffice. Cārvāka denies inference's reach. Śāṅkara presses a dilemma on whether atoms are active or inactive, and treats Nyāya's God as merely *saguṇa*. C. D. Sharma's redundancy objection is sharpest: this God is "reduced to the status of a supervisor", His hands and feet "chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma unfolding itself as the *Adrṣṭa*".

Verdict: the arguments are individually inconclusive but cumulatively serious, in Udayana's manner. They share the limits of all a posteriori theism - Chatterjee and Datta themselves conclude, with Kant and Lotze, that God cannot be deduced from anterior premises and must be known through direct experience.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: nature of Īśvara in two lines -> four to five arguments as reconstructions -> internal replies -> external critiques -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine**: efficient not material cause; *ṣaḍ-aiśvarya*; *prayojaka kartā*; *karmaphaladātā*.

- **Argument:** the *sāṃvaya* / *avāntara-mahattva* criteria and the derivation of omniscience must both be present.
- **Distinction:** order of existence versus order of knowledge; theism versus deism.
- **Technical terms:** *kāryāt*, *āyojanāt*, *dhṛtyādeḥ*, *padāt*, *śruteḥ*, *adr̥ṣṭa*, *apauruṣeya*, *apūrva*, *saguṇa*.
- **Comparison:** Janet, Lotze and Martineau as parallels - with the divergence over existence versus order.
- **Criticism:** Indian critics first (Mīmāṃsā, Buddhist, Jaina, Cārvāka, Advaita), then the redundancy objection.
- **Conclusion:** cumulative but not demonstrative; note the textbook tradition's own experiential turn.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Isvara - efficient cause, preserver, destroyer; theism not deism
 7 min : Karyat (with omniscience derivation), ayojanat, dhṛtyadeh, padat/sruteh, adr̥ṣṭa
 4 min : Internal replies - circularity, bodiless agent
 5 min : External critiques - Mimamsa, Bauddha, Jaina, Carvaka, Sankara, Sharma's redundancy
 3 min : Graded verdict + Chatterjee-Datta's experiential conclusion
 Total : 21 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Calling God the material cause: **the single worst error available here.**
- Listing the proofs without reconstructing any: **descriptive, not analytical.**
- Using only Hume and Kant as critics: **ignores the Indian debate the question presupposes.**
- Conceding the Veda-God circularity: **the classical reply exists and should be given.**
- Confusing *adr̥ṣṭa* with Jaina material karma: **doctrinal error.**
- Concluding "hence Nyāya proves God": **ungraded and indefensible.**

PYQ 10 - 2024, Q7(c), 15 marks (10 + 5)

Exact question

"Present an exposition of ontological proof for the existence of God along with its criticism."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Explicitly split: 10 marks exposition + 5 marks criticism
Core issue	Faithful reconstruction, then targeted objection
Scope boundary	Allocate roughly two-thirds of the space to exposition
Ideal thesis	A clear reconstruction of both Anselmian forms and Descartes, criticised through Gaunilo and Kant
Non-negotiables	The mark split must be visibly respected in the answer's proportions

Model answer (≈250 words)

Exposition (10). The ontological proof is the sole classical **a priori** argument: it moves from the concept of God to God's existence without any empirical premise. Anselm defines God as "**that than which nothing greater can be conceived**", where "greater" means more perfect - and deliberately not as "the most perfect being that there is", which would guarantee nothing. In *Proslogion* 2 he argues by *reductio*: even the fool who denies God understands the concept; but if this being existed in the understanding alone, we could conceive a greater - the same being existing in reality as well - which contradicts the definition; therefore it exists in reality. In *Proslogion* 3 he strengthens the conclusion: a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater than one that can; and since God as infinitely perfect is not limited by time, both coming-to-be and ceasing-to-be are excluded. God therefore exists **necessarily**, by aseity. Descartes reformulates it in *Meditations* V: existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as three angles belong to a triangle, or a valley to a mountain; a perfect being lacking existence would lack a perfection.

Criticism (5). **Gaunilo**, in *In Behalf of the Fool*, parodies the form with the most perfect conceivable island; Anselm replies that only God is defined with necessary existence, an island being by definition contingent - but the reply then requires that maximal greatness be coherent. **Kant's** objection is decisive: existence is not a real predicate; a hundred

real thalers add no concept to a hundred possible ones. Modal repairs preserve validity but relocate the burden onto an unestablished **possibility premise**.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure:** the 10 + 5 split must be visible, ideally with the exposition twice the length of the criticism.
- **Doctrine:** both Anselmian forms plus Descartes; the fool; aseity.
- **Argument:** the *reductio* reproduced as steps.
- **Distinction:** "greatest conceivable" versus "greatest that there is" - a mark-winning nuance.
- **Technical terms:** real predicate, necessary existence, possibility premise.
- **Comparison:** optional single line that Indian philosophy has no a priori analogue.
- **Criticism:** Gaunilo on form, Kant on the concept of existence - both, in that order.
- **Conclusion:** state what survives: a conditional, not an instantiation.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : A priori status and Anselm's definition, precisely worded
 5 min : Proslogion 2, then Proslogion 3; then Descartes
 1 min : Note the "conceivable" vs "that there is" nuance
 4 min : Gaunilo + reply; Kant; modal burden
 1 min : What survives - a conditional
 Total : 12 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Ignoring the 10 + 5 split and writing a balanced essay: **structural penalty**.
- Giving criticism first: **inverts the stated weighting**.
- Reproducing only Descartes: **the question says "ontological proof", whose primary text is Anselm**.
- Confusing Gaunilo's and Kant's objections: **factual error**.
- Omitting *Proslogion* 3: **the reply to Gaunilo cannot then be stated**.

PYQ 11 - 2025, Q6(a), 20 marks

Exact question

"Present an account of Design argument to prove the existence of God along with its criticism by David Hume."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Exposition plus a named critic - Hume specifically, not general criticism
Core issue	Whether order and adaptation license an inference to an intelligent, single, infinite, good designer
Scope boundary	Hume must dominate the critical half; Darwin and fine-tuning are extensions, not substitutes
Ideal thesis	Hume defeats the argument as a demonstration and blocks the passage to the God of theism, without disproving a designer
Non-negotiables	Aquinas' Way 5 distinguished from Paley; Paley's three riders; at least four Hume fronts; the 1779/1802 chronology

Model answer (≈355 words)

The design or teleological argument runs from Plato's *Timaeus* through Aquinas to the modern period. Two forms must be distinguished. **Aquinas' Fifth Way** argues that things lacking cognition act for an end, and do so always or nearly always in the same way; such directedness cannot be chance, so they are directed by an intelligent being, as the arrow by the archer. **Paley's** argument, in *Natural Theology* (1802), is instead an **analogy**: finding a watch on a heath, with wheels, cogs, springs and balances all working together to measure time, I cannot attribute it to wind and rain as I could a stone; I must postulate an intelligent maker. Paley adds three riders - the inference survives never having seen a watch made, imperfect working, and parts whose function we cannot discover - and then builds a long **cumulative** case from the eye, the bird's wing, the fish's fin, planetary motion and the seasons.

Hume's critique, in the Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion, was published in **1779, twenty-three years before Paley**, who took no apparent account of it. It attacks on five fronts. First, **any** universe capable of persisting must display mutual adaptation - there could not be birds with wings unable to live in air - so adaptation is a precondition of order, not evidence of design; Hume offers the **Epicurean hypothesis**, that a finite number of particles in random motion will in unlimited time pass through every combination, one of which is a stable order. Second, the **analogy is weak**: the universe resembles a vegetable or a crustacean as much as a machine, and whether those are designed is the very question at issue. Third, **cause must be proportioned to effect**: from a finite world one may infer only a finite cause - his illustration of the scales, where an unseen weight can be inferred to exceed ten ounces but never to be infinite. Fourth, the evidence equally supports **many** designers, an inferior one, an infant or senile deity, or an abandoned first attempt. Fifth, **evil and disorder** count against a good and powerful designer.

Darwin later supplies a mechanism that removes Paley's biological premise; Hick's ozone example inverts the intuition, since life fitted itself to the filter rather than the filter to life. Modern fine-tuning arguments relocate design to pre-biological constants, answering Hume's first two fronts while remaining fully exposed to the last three, and facing multiverse rivals.

Verdict: Hume does **not** disprove a designer - Philo himself concedes a remote analogy - but he destroys the argument's demonstrative pretension and blocks the passage from an orderer to the one, infinite, perfectly good God of theism. Design survives only as an inference to the best explanation.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: distinguish the two forms -> Paley in full -> Hume's five fronts -> Darwin and fine-tuning -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine**: Way 5's archer-arrow; Paley's watch and three riders.
- **Argument**: the analogy must be displayed as an analogy, with its two relata named.
- **Distinction**: Aquinas ≠ Paley ≠ fine-tuning; and evidential objections (fronts 1-2) versus adequacy objections (fronts 3-5).
- **Technical terms**: Epicurean hypothesis, proportioning cause to effect, means-end adjustment, anthropic selection.
- **Comparison**: Nyāya's *āyojanāt* and the pot-potter model as the Indian analogue.
- **Criticism**: Hume must be given in his own examples, not paraphrased generically.
- **Conclusion**: demonstrative failure plus surviving explanatory force, stated as a graded verdict.

Compact skeleton and timing

2 min : Two forms distinguished - Way 5 vs Paley
 5 min : Paley - the watch, three riders, cumulative evidence
 7 min : Hume's five fronts with his own illustrations; note 1779 vs 1802
 3 min : Darwin (ozone) and fine-tuning; exact scope of each
 2 min : Nyaya's ayojanat as Indian analogue
 2 min : Graded verdict - inference to the best explanation
 Total : 21 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Attributing the watch to Aquinas: **factual error, and it wastes the best distinction available**.
- Writing "Hume disproved the design argument": **misstates his conclusion**.
- Giving only two Hume objections in a 20-marker: **thin criticism**.
- Letting Darwin displace Hume: **the question names Hume**.
- Treating fine-tuning as the same argument as Paley's: **category error**.
- Omitting the Indian analogue in Paper II: **loses comparative credit**.

PYQ 12 - 2025, Q7(b), 15 marks

Exact question

"What proofs do Nyāya philosophers offer for the existence of God? Discuss."

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>What proofs... Discuss</i> - exposition-weighted, with evaluation attached
Core issue	The content and structure of the Nyāya proof-set
Scope boundary	Narrower than 2023's "critically examine": more exposition, less polemic
Ideal thesis	A structured set of mutually reinforcing inferences to an omniscient efficient cause, cumulatively rather than individually persuasive
Non-negotiables	Sanskrit terminology; the efficient-cause thesis; a note that enumerations vary; a short evaluation

Model answer (~250 words)

Nyāya offers not one proof but an array - the tradition claims as many as ten, though enumerations vary across texts and summaries, so an answer should present the principal ones and say so.

Kāryāt, the causal argument, is central. All composite objects - mountains, seas, sun and moon - are effects, since they are made of parts (*sāvayava*) and possess intermediate magnitude (*avāntara-mahattva*). Space, time, ether and self are excluded as partless infinities; atoms and *manas* as simple infinitesimals. Material causes cannot by themselves attain the order and co-ordination required to produce such effects, so an intelligent maker is needed, possessing direct knowledge of the atoms, a desire for an end, and the will to realise it. He must be **omniscient**, since only an omniscient being can directly know entities so simple and infinitesimal as atoms.

Āyojanāt: inert atoms require purposive combination. **Dhṛtyādeḥ**: the world's support, maintenance and destruction imply governance. **Padāt / āptaprāmāṇya**: the Veda's authority presupposes an omniscient trustworthy author, since no jīva can know supramundane realities. **Śruteḥ**: scripture testifies directly. The argument from **adrṣṭa** completes the set: the unconscious stock of merit and demerit cannot itself allot the precise joy and sorrow deserved, nor do selves know or control it; hence God is *karmaphaladātā*, the impartial dispenser.

Throughout, Īśvara is the **efficient, not material, cause**: atoms are eternal, and God orders rather than produces them; He also preserves and destroys, which makes Nyāya theistic rather than deistic.

Discussion: the proofs are mutually reinforcing in Udayana's cumulative manner, but each is contested - Mīmāṃsā by *apauruṣeya* and *apūrva*, Buddhism and Jainism by karmic sufficiency, Cārvāka by restricting *pramāṇas*. They establish a probable cosmic administrator rather than a demonstrated absolute.

Why this earns marks

- **Structure**: note the plurality of proofs -> present five or six with Sanskrit names -> state the efficient-cause thesis -> short evaluation.
- **Doctrine**: *sāvayava*, *avāntara-mahattva*, the omniscience derivation, *adrṣṭa*, *karmaphaladātā*.
- **Argument**: *kāryāt* must be a reconstruction; the others may be compressed to one or two lines each.
- **Distinction**: efficient versus material cause; theism versus deism.
- **Technical terms**: all six Sanskrit route-names, correctly glossed.
- **Comparison**: one line on the Western parallels (Janet, Lotze, Martineau) and the existence/order divergence.
- **Criticism**: at least three Indian objectors, briefly.
- **Conclusion**: cumulative persuasiveness with a modest terminus.

Compact skeleton and timing

1 min : Plurality of proofs; enumerations vary
6 min : Karyat in full; ayojanat, dhrtiyadeh, padat/sruteh compressed
3 min : Adrsta argument and karmaphaladata
2 min : Efficient not material cause; theism not deism
2 min : Evaluation - Mimamsa, Bauddha/Jaina, Carvaka; cumulative verdict
Total : 14 minutes

Common mistakes and examiner penalties

- Answering with the *nature* of Nyāya's God instead of the proofs: **question substitution - a distinct 2021 PYQ.**
- Giving only *kāryāt*: **the question says "proofs", plural.**
- Omitting the omniscience derivation: **loses the argument's most distinctive step.**
- Asserting a fixed canonical list of exactly four or exactly ten: **enumerations genuinely vary; say so.**
- No evaluation at all: **"Discuss" requires some.**

These retained models extend coverage rather than repeat a direct verified PYQ.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original 10-marker 1

Question: Distinguish an essentially ordered from an accidentally ordered causal series, and explain why the distinction is indispensable to Aquinas' Second Way. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Distinguish and explain why</i> - a conceptual distinction put to argumentative work
Core issue	Why Aquinas may exclude one infinite regress without excluding all
Ideal thesis	The distinction shows that "first" means explanatory, not temporal, priority

Model answer (≈155 words)

An **accidentally ordered (per accidens)** series is one in which each cause, having produced its effect, may perish while the effect continues - as a grandfather begets a father who begets a son. Its members possess causal power in their own right, and an infinite backward series of such causes is not obviously incoherent; Aquinas indeed holds that reason alone cannot exclude an eternal world.

An **essentially ordered (per se)** series is one in which the members act simultaneously and the intermediates possess only **derivative** power: the hand moves the stick, which moves the stone. Remove the hand and the whole series stops at once.

The distinction is indispensable because Aquinas' exclusion of infinite regress applies only to the second kind. An unlimited series of borrowers with no owner explains nothing, since no member supplies non-derivative actualising power. Hence "first cause" denotes **explanatory priority here and now**, not the earliest event in time - which is why the Second Way is not an argument for a temporal beginning.

Top-answer checklist

- Both series named in Latin and illustrated.
- Simultaneity and derivative power identified as the marks of the *per se* series.
- The hand-stick-stone example present.
- "First" explicitly glossed as explanatory.
- One line noting that Aquinas permits an eternal world philosophically.

Original 10-marker 2

Question: "Jainism denies God but not godhead." Examine. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine</i> - test the accuracy and implications of the formula
Core issue	Two senses of "God": world-maker and perfected being
Ideal thesis	The formula is accurate: Jainism rejects <i>jagat-kartā</i> and affirms attainable divinity

Model answer (≈160 words)

The formula is accurate and philosophically precise. Jainism denies God as **creator**: the world was never made, since all six substances are eternal and reality is characterised by origination, decay and permanence (*utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya*); change belongs to modes, not to a divine act. It reinforces this with anti-creator arguments - a perfect being can have no motive to create; creation from compassion is refuted by suffering; creation as sport is childish and cruel; and if God is self-existent, the world may equally be so.

Yet **godhead** is affirmed. Every *jīva* intrinsically possesses infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power, obscured by material karma; complete removal of that obscuration yields *kevala-jñāna*, and the liberated soul is a *siddha* - a god. The Tīrthaṅkaras were mortals who reached this by personal effort: "we are all potential Jinās."

Jaina divinity is therefore **plural, achieved, non-creative and exemplary**. It answers the soteriological question, not the cosmological one - which is why the label "atheism" misdescribes it.

Top-answer checklist

- The two senses of "God" separated in the opening line.
- *Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya* cited for the uncreated world.
- At least two anti-creator arguments.
- *Ananta-catuṣṭaya*, *kevala-jñāna*, *siddha* used accurately.
- The closing characterisation: plural, achieved, non-creative, exemplary.

Original 15-marker 1

Question: Does the modal version of the ontological argument escape Kant's objection? Discuss. (15 marks, 240 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Discuss</i> an evaluative question demanding a verdict
Core issue	Whether necessary existence is a modal status immune to the real-predicate objection
Ideal thesis	It escapes the letter of Kant's objection but not its spirit, because the burden migrates to the possibility premise

Model answer (≈250 words)

Kant's objection is that existence is not a real or determining predicate: it adds nothing to a concept but posits its object, as a hundred real thalers add no concept to a hundred possible ones. If so, Anselm's comparative - that existing in reality is *greater* - is illegitimate, and the argument builds its conclusion into its premise.

Modal reconstructions by Malcolm, Hartshorne and, most influentially, Plantinga work exclusively with Anselm's second form. Their claim is that the relevant property is not bare existence but **necessary existence**, a modal status. The argument runs: it is possible that a maximally great being exists; a maximally great being exists necessarily and is maximally excellent in every possible world; what is possibly necessary is, in S5, actually necessary; therefore such a being exists.

This does escape Kant's objection **as stated**: modal status is arguably a genuine property of a being, and the inference does not require existence to enhance a concept.

But it does not escape the objection's **spirit**. The entire weight now falls on the **possibility premise**. A symmetrical premise - that it is possible that no maximally great being exists - yields, in the same modal system, the contradictory

conclusion. The premises are thus evidentially on a par, and the argument establishes nothing until it is independently shown that maximal greatness is **coherent**. That is precisely the question Kant's objection was raising in another form: whether the concept of God can be so specified that its analysis yields existence.

Verdict: the modal version converts an objection about the logic of existence into a dispute about the coherence of maximal greatness. This is philosophical progress, not vindication.

Top-answer checklist

- Kant's objection stated with the thaler illustration.
- The modal argument given as numbered steps, with S5 named.
- The escape acknowledged honestly before the counter is made.
- The symmetry of the possibility premise displayed.
- A graded verdict - progress, not vindication.

Original 15-marker 2

Question: Examine the Mīmāṃsā case that the authority of the Veda and the operation of karma together render a creator God redundant. (15 marks, 240 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine</i> - reconstruct the case and test it
Core issue	Whether normativity and desert can be secured without a divine guarantor
Ideal thesis	The case is coherent and internally powerful, but purchases economy at the cost of explaining normativity's ultimate ground

Model answer (≈250 words)

Mīmāṃsā's case has two limbs, each aimed at a distinct Nyāya proof.

The first concerns **authority**. The Veda is **apauruṣeya** - eternal, authorless and self-valid. Authorlessness is not a deficiency but a protection: a personal author may deceive or may lack complete knowledge, and if the Veda had an author, its authority would depend on first proving that author's competence and sincerity. Mīmāṃsā presses the point directly against Nyāya: the theistic route requires proving that God exists, then that God is omniscient, then that God intends truth, each stage needing independent support. Combined with **svataḥ-prāmāṇya**, the intrinsic validity of cognition, authorlessness blocks scepticism at the outset without theological machinery.

The second concerns **desert**. **Apūrva** is the unseen potency generated by correctly performed ritual; it persists after the act and matures into future fruit. Prābhākara adds **niyoga**: the injunction itself creates obligation, so one acts because the Veda commands, not because a deity rewards. Together these dissolve Nyāya's *adrṣṭa* argument, whose whole force lay in the claim that an unconscious principle cannot allot determinate fruit.

Two criticisms remain. First, an eternal, authorless language that nevertheless carries determinate normative content is itself philosophically striking, and Nyāya charges that unexplained normativity is not the same as economical explanation. Second, Chatterjee and Datta observe that Mīmāṃsā's deities are not treated as objects of worship and are said to exist nowhere except in the *mantras* describing them, so God is left in an "ambiguous position" - economy achieved partly by evacuation.

Verdict: the case succeeds in showing that a rigorous account of duty and desert is possible without a creator; it does not show that such an account is explanatorily superior.

Top-answer checklist

- The two limbs separated and matched to the two Nyāya proofs they attack.
- *Apauruṣeya*, *svataḥ-prāmāṇya*, *apūrva* and *niyoga* all used correctly.
- The "cumbersome three-stage dependence" objection to Nyāya reproduced.
- At least one criticism from the Nyāya side and one from the textbook tradition.
- A graded verdict distinguishing possibility from superiority.

Original 20-marker 1

Question: "Hume did not disprove design; he dismantled the inference." Critically examine with reference to the Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion. (20 marks, 340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically examine</i> a precise interpretive thesis
Core issue	The logical status of Hume's conclusions
Ideal thesis	The thesis is correct: Hume's attacks are undercutting and adequacy-directed, not disproofs

Model answer (≈350 words)

The thesis is correct, and defending it requires separating two waves of Hume's attack.

The design argument, in Paley's form, is an **analogy**: a watch on a heath, with wheels, cogs and springs adjusted to a purpose, obliges us to postulate a maker; organisms exhibit comparable means-end adjustment; therefore they too imply a designer. Paley's three riders pre-empt the obvious replies - the inference survives never having seen a watch made, imperfect working, and parts of unknown function - and he builds a long cumulative case from the eye, the wing, the fin, planetary motion and the seasons.

Hume's **first wave is undercutting**. He argues that any universe capable of persisting must display mutual adaptation, so adaptation is a precondition of order rather than evidence of design; the **Epicurean hypothesis** - a finite number of particles in random motion passing, in unlimited time, through every combination, one of which is stable - supplies a naturalistic model of order. He then attacks the analogy itself: the universe is as like a vegetable or a crustacean as a machine, and whether *those* are designed is the point at issue.

His **second wave is adequacy-directed**. Cause must be proportioned to effect, so from a finite world one may infer only a finite cause - the illustration of the scales, where an unseen weight may be inferred to exceed ten ounces but never to be infinite. The evidence equally supports many designers, an inferior deity, an infant or senile one, or a bungled first attempt; and the world's evil and disorder tell against a good and powerful designer.

Neither wave is a **disproof**. Undercutting objections show the evidence does not support the conclusion; they do not show the conclusion false. Adequacy objections *grant* an inference and deny only its reach. Hume's own Philo concedes a remote, undefined analogy between the cause of order in the universe and human intelligence. Darwin later supplies the mechanism Hume lacked, removing Paley's biological premise - Hick's ozone example inverts the intuition - but that too is an explanation, not a refutation. Modern fine-tuning arguments answer Hume's first wave by relocating the evidence to pre-biological constants, while remaining fully exposed to the second and facing multiverse rivals.

Verdict: the thesis stands. Hume destroyed the argument's demonstrative pretension and blocked the passage from an orderer to the one, infinite, perfectly good God of theism. What survives is design as an **inference to the best explanation** - contested, cumulative, and never compelling.

Top-answer checklist

- The two waves explicitly distinguished and labelled by tier.
- Paley's three riders present.
- At least four Hume fronts with his own illustrations.
- Philo's concession cited as the decisive textual evidence for the thesis.
- Darwin and fine-tuning placed with their exact scope.
- A verdict naming what survives, not merely what fails.

Original 20-marker 2

Question: "Every Indian argument against a creator God is either an economy move, a coherence move or an epistemic move." Critically examine this classification with reference to Jaina, Buddhist, Mīmāṃsā and Cārvāka positions. (20 marks, 340 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically examine</i> a proposed taxonomy - test its fit and its limits
Core issue	Whether four distinct schools share a common argumentative structure
Ideal thesis	The classification fits well and is analytically useful, but some arguments straddle categories and one school resists placement

Model answer (~350 words)

The classification is largely accurate and analytically valuable, though it requires two qualifications.

Economy moves claim that the explanandum is already explained. Buddhism's **pratītyasamutpāda** accounts for the arising of phenomena through conditions, making a creator superfluous; the critique is a systematic refusal of explanatory surplus rather than bare denial. Jainism holds that the world was never created - substances are eternal and change through modes - and that material karma, adhering to each jīva, accounts for the distribution of fortune. Mīmāṃsā's **apūrva** matures into its own fruit, displacing the need for a dispenser. Cārvāka holds that the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements.

Coherence moves claim that the divine attributes are inconsistent with the act of creating. Buddhism argues that an eternal, immutable cause cannot produce **successive** effects, and that creation from desire implies lack. Jainism asks what God created from, why a perfect being would create at all, and why a compassionate creator's world contains suffering. Chatterjee and Datta record Max Müller's related point that a creator would be liable to charges of cruelty and partiality.

Epistemic moves deny that the required *pramāṇa* is available. Cārvāka restricts valid cognition to perception, which undercuts every inferential proof at the outset. Mīmāṃsā's **svataḥ-prāmāṇya** and **apauruṣeya** make Vedic authority intrinsic, so no divine certifier is needed; Nyāya's route, requiring one to prove God, then omniscience, then truthfulness, is dismissed as cumbersome.

Two qualifications. First, several arguments straddle categories: the Jaina "if God is self-existent, so may the world be" is simultaneously a parity argument and an economy argument, and Buddhism's *avyākṛta* silence is methodological rather than any of the three. Second, Jainism does not fit a purely negative taxonomy, since it also **affirms** godhood - every liberated soul is a god - so its position is not exhausted by objections to a creator.

Nyāya's replies fall into matching families: against economy, that an unconscious principle cannot allot determinate desert; against coherence, that divine agency need not be modelled on finite volition; against epistemic restriction, that inference is an independent *pramāṇa* which the Cārvāka's own general denial presupposes.

Verdict: the taxonomy is a genuine advance over school-by-school listing, because it exposes that Indian and Western critiques share the same three structures - Hume's Epicurean hypothesis is an economy move, his proportioning principle a coherence-adjacent adequacy move, and logical positivist verificationism an epistemic move. It should be used as a framework, not as a straitjacket.

Top-answer checklist

- All four schools placed, with at least one school appearing in two categories.
- Sanskrit terms deployed as analytical instruments.
- The Nyāya replies mapped onto the same three families.
- At least two honest limits to the classification.
- A Western cross-mapping in the verdict.

High-score proof-answer protocol

1. Define with discrimination, not description

Open with a definition that already separates the doctrine from its nearest rival.

Weak : God is the cause of the world.

Strong: In Nyaya, Isvara is the intelligent EFFICIENT cause who orders eternal atoms; atoms remain the MATERIAL cause, and God also preserves and destroys - which distinguishes Nyaya theism from deism.

Term	The definition must distinguish it from
Ontological argument	Cosmological reasoning and Descartes' <i>Meditations</i> III causal proof
Necessary being	Whatever merely happens to be everlasting
<i>Per se</i> series	<i>Per accidens</i> series
Design (Way 5)	Paley's analogy and modern fine-tuning
Postulate	Demonstration and empirical hypothesis
<i>Adṛṣṭa</i>	Jaina material karma and Mīmāṃsā <i>apūrva</i>
<i>Apauruṣeya</i>	Divine revelation

2. Reconstruct arguments as premises

1. Composite objects are effects (savayava + avantara-mahattva).
2. Material causes alone cannot achieve the required order.
3. An intelligent cause must know the atoms, desire an end and will it.
4. Only an omniscient being can directly know atoms.
5. The cause is an omniscient God.

Then expose the **presupposition** - here, that world-wholes are relevantly like artefacts. Marks come from showing *why* the conclusion follows and *where* it can be resisted.

3. Sort every objection by tier

VALIDITY : does the conclusion follow? (quantifier shift in Way 3)
SOUNDNESS : are the premises true? (Hume fronts 1-2; Darwin)
ADEQUACY : is the being reached GOD? (Hume front 3; Kant on cosmological)

Announcing the tier in a single clause - "this is an objection to adequacy, not to validity" - signals control and saves words.

4. Use Sanskrit and Latin as instruments, not decoration

- Gloss on first use: *kāryāt* (from the effect), *per se* (essentially ordered).
- Preserve causal distinctions: *nimitta-kāraṇa* versus *upādāna-kāraṇa*.
- Preserve epistemic distinctions: *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *śabda*, *vyāpti*.
- Preserve the three Kantian statuses: knowledge, postulate, idea of reason.

5. Never conflate these five relations

CONCEPTUAL ENTAILMENT : Anselm - the concept contains necessary existence
EXPLANATORY PRIORITY : Aquinas - the first cause acts here and now
ANALOGICAL INFERENCE : Paley, Nyaya - artefact to world
PRACTICAL POSTULATION : Kant - required for the highest good's possibility
SCRIPTURAL TESTIMONY : Nyaya sruteh - and its Mimamsa denial

6. Present objection and reply dialectically

OBJECTION -> BEST AVAILABLE REPLY -> RESIDUAL PRESSURE

Objection : An infinite regress of causes needs no first member.

Reply : The series is essentially ordered; derivative causes supply no actualising power however many they are.

Residual : It must still be shown that the actual causal order is *per se* rather than *per accidens*.

Steelman the critic before evaluating. Never introduce a weak objection merely to dismiss it.

7. Grade the verdict and name the criterion

Avoid "completely proved", "totally refuted", "both are equally valid". Prefer:

- "valid in form but question-begging in premise",
- "evidentially undercut, though not disproved",
- "explanatorily economical but normatively unexplained",
- "epistemically bolder and correspondingly more exposed",
- "adequate to a cosmic administrator, not to an absolute".

Name the criterion: coherence, evidential contact, modal strength, explanatory economy, religious adequacy, or compatibility with moral agency.

8. Marks-wise architecture

Marks	Working time	Architecture
10	7-8 min	Classify -> premises -> one presupposition -> canonical objection -> one-line verdict
15	12-13 min	Frame -> reconstruct -> canonical example -> strongest objection -> best reply -> assess validity and adequacy separately
20	17-18 min	Classify family -> full steps -> Indian/Western contrast -> two objections with replies -> underdetermination of attributes -> criterion-named verdict

- **10 marks ≈ 150 words.** One controlled comparison is enough; do not spend half the answer on background.
- **15 marks ≈ 220-260 words.** At least one technical distinction and one serious criticism.
- **20 marks ≈ 320-360 words.** A comparative matrix or compact diagram may precede the prose; two objections, or one developed through reply and residual pressure.

9. Avoid generic prose

Do not write:

"Belief in God gives peace and moral values to society."

Write:

"A moral governor can ground desert-appropriate allocation, but Mīmāṃsā's *apūrva* shows that an unconscious potency may be intrinsically fruit-directed - so the Nyāya inference must defend its premise that unconsciousness entails indeterminacy of outcome."

10. Final twenty-second audit

- Did I answer the **directive** - examine, compare, critically evaluate, discuss?
- Did I define the controlling term so as to exclude its nearest rival?
- Did I reconstruct at least one argument as numbered premises?
- Did I name the **tier** of each objection?
- Did I include Indian material in a Paper II answer?
- Did I state a **graded verdict with a named criterion**?

Final rapid revision matrix

Argument / doctrine	Thinker / school	Starting point	Terminus reached	Central criticism	Likely question form
Ontological, first form	Anselm, <i>Proslogion</i> 2	Concept of that than which nothing greater can be conceived	Existence in reality	Gaunilo's island; Kant's real predicate	Is the ontological proof logical?
Ontological, second form	Anselm, <i>Proslogion</i> 3	The same concept plus inconceivability of non-existence	Necessary existence, aseity	Coherence of maximal greatness	Does the concept entail existence?
Essence-containment	Descartes, <i>Meditations</i> V	Essence of a supremely perfect being	Existence as a perfection	Kant; second-order analysis of existence	Exposition with criticism
Island parody	Gaunilo	Any maximally perfect object	Absurd conclusions	Answered by necessary existence	Criticism of Anselm
Real-predicate objection	Kant, <i>CPR</i>	Logic of "exists"	Existence posits, does not enrich	Modal repair attempts	Criticism of the ontological proof
Modal ontological	Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga	Possibility of maximal greatness	Necessary existence in S5	Possibility premise is symmetric	Advanced note only
Way 1	Aquinas	Motion / change	Unmoved mover	Regress exclusion	Five Ways exposition
Way 2	Aquinas	Order of efficient causes	First efficient cause	Hume on regress; Kant on identification	Five Ways; comparison with Nyāya
Way 3	Aquinas	Contingency	Necessary being, ultimately <i>a se</i>	Quantifier shift	Most interesting Way
Way 4	Aquinas	Degrees of perfection	Maximum, cause of all perfection	Degrees need no maximum	Five Ways completeness
Way 5	Aquinas	Regular directedness of non-cognitive nature	Directing intelligence (archer-arrow)	Hume's analogy; less exposed to Darwin	Design argument
Kalām	Islamic tradition; modern revival	Universe began to exist	Personal, timeless, powerful cause	Actual-infinite and cosmology disputes	Contrast with Aquinas
PSR version	Leibniz	Why anything rather than nothing	Necessary being	Brute-fact reply	Cosmological evaluation
Watch analogy	Paley, <i>Natural Theology</i> 1802	Means-end adjustment in organisms	Intelligent maker	Darwin; Hume's five fronts	Design with Hume's criticism
Five-front critique	Hume, <i>Dialogues</i> 1779	Analogy, adaptation, proportion, plurality, evil	Design inference dismantled	Does not disprove a designer	2025-type question
Natural selection	Darwin	Variation and differential survival	Adaptation without design	Does not touch fine-tuning or law	Extension of the design debate
Fine-tuning	Modern probabilistic theism	Life-permitting constants	Design as best explanation	Multiverse; observation selection	Contemporary note only
Moral, first form	Newman	Conscience and objective values	Divine Law Giver	Begs the question against naturalism	Critical account of the moral argument
Moral, second form	Kant, <i>CPrR</i>	Moral law and the highest good	God, immortality, freedom as postulates	Projection; autonomy; adequacy	Critical account; comparison with Nyāya

Argument / doctrine	Thinker / school	Starting point	Terminus reached	Central criticism	Likely question form
<i>Kāryāt</i>	Nyāya / Udayana	Composite world as effect (<i>sāvayava, avāntara-mahattva</i>)	Omniscient intelligent maker	World unlike an artefact	Nyāya proofs
<i>Āyojanāt</i>	Nyāya	Purposive combination of inert atoms	Conscious arranger	Order may emerge unintentionally	Nyāya proofs
<i>Dhṛtyādeḥ</i>	Nyāya	Support, maintenance, destruction	Cosmic governor	Governance may be law-like	Nyāya proofs
<i>Padāt / āptaprāmānya</i>	Nyāya	Authority of the Veda	Omniscient trustworthy author	Mīmāṃsā <i>apauruṣeya</i>	Nyāya proofs; circularity
<i>Śruteḥ</i>	Nyāya	Scriptural testimony	God as attested	Circularity charge; philosophical weight of testimony	Nyāya proofs
<i>Adṛṣṭa</i> argument	Nyāya	Unequal fortunes; time-gap of desert	God as <i>karmaphaladātā</i>	Mīmāṃsā <i>apūrva</i> ; redundancy	Nyāya; comparison with Kant
Nyāya causation	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Eternal atoms and souls	God as efficient, not material, cause	Sharma: "reduced to a supervisor"	Nature versus proofs - keep distinct
Jaina godhead	Jainism	<i>Ananta-catuṣṭaya</i> obscured by material karma	<i>Kevala-jñāna</i> ; the <i>siddha</i> as god	Bondage/liberation dilemma	Jaina proofs (2019)
Jaina anti-creator	Jainism	Uncreated world; modes	No creator needed	Presupposes Jaina metaphysics	Jaina proofs
Buddhist anti-creator	Buddhism	Dependent origination; immutability	Creator redundant and incoherent	Nyāya on determinate allocation	2018 Q8(b)
Mīmāṃsā	Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā	<i>Apauruṣeya</i> Veda; <i>apūrva</i>	Authority and desert without God	Normativity left unexplained	Critique of Nyāya proofs
Cārvāka	Cārvāka	Perception as sole <i>pramāṇa</i>	God unproven and unnecessary	Denial itself uses inference	Anti-theistic arguments
Advaita levelling	Śaṅkara	Levels of reality	Nyāya's God is only <i>saguṇa</i>	Level-distinction dispute	Comparative synthesis
Cumulative case	Udayana; modern theists	Multiple independent routes	Higher overall probability	Independence and logical type	20-mark evaluation

Last-minute memory spine

TIERS : validity -> soundness -> adequacy of the God established
 A PRIORI : ontological only | A POSTERIORI : cosmo · teleo · moral · Nyaya
 ANSELM : P2 existence · P3 NECESSARY existence · Gaunilo · Kant · modal burden
 AQUINAS : motion · causation · contingency · degrees · purpose
 per se (hand-stick-stone) · "first" = explanatory · eternity permitted
 DESIGN : Way 5 archer ≠ Paley watch ≠ fine-tuning constants
 HUME : A-A-P-P-E - adapted · analogy · proportion · plurality · evil
 (1779, BEFORE Paley 1802; Philo concedes a remote analogy)
 KANT : CPR destroys · CPR postulates · F-I-G · summum bonum · ought-implies-can
 NYAYA : K-A-D-P-S + adrsta · EFFICIENT cause only · karmaphaladata ·
 order-of-existence vs order-of-knowledge
 INDIA : Jaina godhead · Bauddha conditions · Mimamsa apauruseya + apurva ·
 Carvaka perception · Advaita saguna · Sharma redundancy
 CLASSIFY : every Indian objection = Economy · Coherence · Epistemic
 VERDICT : classify -> reconstruct -> presuppose -> object -> reply -> GRADE

End of the premium solved-PYQ and practice workbook.

Timed-paper compression plan

ANALYSIS: Use this only after the full models above. It converts each solved answer into an examination-length script without discarding the elements that earn marks.

Demand type in this clause	Keep at every length	Cut first, in this order
Single-proof exposition (2020 Anselm; 2024 ontological; 2025 design)	the numbered premise chain; the canonical example; the named critic's objection; the graded verdict	the argument's later reception history, then the biography of the proponent, then the second illustration
Two-part directive (2025 Q6(a); 2024 Q7(c))	the visible split between exposition and critique; the printed mark-weighting	the introduction's scene-setting; any objection beyond the two strongest
Comparison (2018 Aquinas and Nyāya)	the announced axis; both sides on each axis; the being/order divergence	the third and fourth axes; the Sanskrit terms whose content you cannot state in a clause
Enumeration with premises (2023 and 2025 Nyāya)	one clause of content per named ground; the unseen-potency argument; one critic per ground	the eighth ground (<i>saṃkhyāviśeṣāt</i>) unless you can state it correctly; the internal circularity reply
Trap-shaped stem (2019 Jainism)	the first-line correction; three anti-creator arguments; the ford-maker/liberated-soul distinction	the remaining three anti-creator arguments; the five-fold salutation detail
Anti-creator evaluation (2018 Buddhism)	the successive-or-simultaneous dilemma; the redundancy point; the Nyāya reply and the rejoinder	the canonical-genetic stratum, compressed to one sentence; the sutta references
Conceptual distinction (2022 a priori and a posteriori)	the source-of-premises rule; one example each side; the criterion-named preference	the historical illustration; the modal-logic detail
Evaluative choice (2022 Five Ways)	the criterion, stated before the choice; the chosen Way's premises; the cost of the choice	the four Ways not chosen, reduced to one line each

ANALYSIS: **Band budgets for this topic.** 10 marks ≈ 150 words: classification, premises, one presupposition, one objection, one-line verdict. 15 marks ≈ 220-260 words: add the canonical example, the proponent's reply, and separated verdicts on validity and adequacy. 20 marks ≈ 320-360 words: add the Indian or Western analogue, a second objection with its reply, and the underdetermination point before a criterion-named conclusion.

ANALYSIS: **What never gets cut:** the distinction between validity, soundness and adequacy; the attribution of the watch to Paley; the efficient-not-material role of the Nyāya Lord; and the closing statement of what the argument actually establishes.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Everything below is enrichment after core learning and practice. It is not required for a competent core answer; deploy one refinement only when it earns an evaluative payoff.

Advanced cards moved from the complete learner source

EXAM-READY LINE: ANALYSIS: Anselm's argument is better read as *fides quaerens intellectum* - faith seeking understanding - than as a neutral proof aimed at converting the atheist.

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: Anselm's argument is better read as *fides quaerens intellectum* - faith seeking understanding - than as a neutral proof aimed at converting the atheist. On that reading, its function is to display the internal grammar of the God-concept for one who already believes: God is not one more entity that happens to exist, but that whose non-existence is unthinkable. This does not save it as a proof, but it explains its extraordinary durability, and it is a mature line to deploy in the concluding paragraph of a 20-marker.

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: Note the difference in **what the conclusion has to do**. Aquinas needs a being that is *ipsum esse subsistens* - subsistent existence itself - because his question is why anything at all is actual. Udayana needs only an omniscient agent capable of knowing atoms and combining them. Consequently Hume's "finite effect, finite cause" objection bites *harder* against Aquinas' identification with the infinite God and *differently* against Nyāya, whose God is explicitly limited by co-eternal atoms, souls and *adr̥ṣṭa*. C. D. Sharma presses exactly this point from the Advaita side, complaining that the Vaiśeṣika God "has been reduced to the status of a supervisor" whose "hands and feet are chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma unfolding itself as the *Adr̥ṣṭa*."

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: There is a deep asymmetry between objections (1)-(2) and (3)-(5). The first two say *the evidence does not support design at all*; the last three concede an inference but say *it does not reach the God of religion*. A candidate who separates these two waves demonstrates control of the argument's logical structure - and can then make the mature observation that the modern fine-tuning revival answers the *first* wave (by relocating the evidence to the constants) while remaining fully exposed to the *second* (a fine-tuner need not be one, infinite or good).

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: Kant's own later thought puts pressure on the postulate. If the highest good is redescribed as an *ethical commonwealth* achievable through human moral community, the theological postulate becomes less indispensable. Conversely, if the highest good genuinely requires a proportioning of nature to desert, no naturalistic substitute is available. So the argument's fate turns entirely on **how the highest good is specified** - a point worth one sentence in a 15-marker and a full paragraph in a 20-marker.

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Udayana's cumulative strategy.** *Nyāyakusumāñjali* does not rest on one inference; it multiplies independent routes - effect, arrangement, sustenance, word-meaning convention, scriptural credibility, moral desert - so that the failure of any single route does not collapse the case. This is structurally the same move as the modern Western cumulative-case argument, and saying so is a genuinely advanced comparative observation. ANALYSIS: The counter is equally structural: a cumulation of individually weak inferences does not automatically yield a strong one unless the routes are evidentially independent.

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **The structural symmetry worth naming in a 20-marker.** Every Indian anti-creator argument is one of exactly three moves: (i) an **economy** move - the explanandum is already explained (dependent origination, karma, apūrva); (ii) a **coherence** move - the divine attributes are internally inconsistent with the act of creating (immutability vs willing, perfection vs motive); or (iii) an **epistemic** move - the required *pramāṇa* is unavailable (Cārvāka's restriction to perception; Mīmāṃsā's insistence that the Veda's authority is intrinsic). Classifying the objections this way, rather than listing them by school, is exactly what "critically evaluate" invites - and it lets you show that the Nyāya replies also fall into three matching families.

Canonical advanced doctrine dossiers

EXAM-READY LINE: Doctrine statement. FACT: Anselm argues a priori from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.

8. ADVANCED DOCTRINE DOSSIERS

EXAM-READY LINE: Doctrine statement. FACT: Anselm argues a priori from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.

8.1 Ontological argument

- **Doctrine statement.** FACT: Anselm argues a *a priori* from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.
- **Argument.** FACT: (1) Even the denier understands the concept; (2) existing in reality is greater than existing only in understanding; (3) if God existed only in understanding, a greater could be conceived; (4) contradiction;

therefore God exists. Descartes recasts existence as inseparable from supremely perfect being.

- **Presupposition. ANALYSIS:** Existence can function in the relevant greatness/perfection ordering, and the concept of a maximally great being is coherent.
- **Distinction. FACT:** An *a priori* proof does not infer from observed effects; it analyses what is supposedly contained in the God-concept.
- **Canonical example. FACT:** Gaunilo's perfect-island parody tests whether the form can establish any unsurpassable object's existence.
- **Objection -> reply. FACT:** Kant denies that existence is a real predicate. A modal reply distinguishes ordinary existence from necessary existence, but it must independently justify the possibility of a maximally great being.

8.2 Cosmological arguments and Aquinas' Ways

- **Doctrine statement. FACT:** From motion, efficient causation, contingency, gradation and purposive order, Aquinas argues to a first or ultimate explanatory source.
- **Argument. FACT:** Ways 1-3 move from actualisation, ordered causes and contingent beings to an unmoved mover, first efficient cause and necessary being. Way 4 moves from degrees to a maximum/source; Way 5 from regular goal-directed activity of non-rational things to intelligence.
- **Presupposition. ANALYSIS:** Essentially ordered causal series require a here-and-now first member; the principle of sufficient reason has sufficient scope.
- **Distinction. FACT:** Aquinas' "first" is explanatory priority, not simply the earliest event in time.
- **Canonical example. FACT:** A stick moves a stone only while moved by a hand: the derivative causal power illustrates an essentially ordered series.
- **Objection -> reply. ANALYSIS:** Hume asks why the series cannot be brute or infinite. Thomists answer that even an infinite derivative series lacks non-derivative actualising power.

8.3 Design argument

- **Doctrine statement. FACT:** Regularity, adaptation or fine order is presented as evidence for intelligent purposive causation.
- **Argument. FACT:** Paley's analogical form: watches exhibit means-end adjustment and have designers; organisms exhibit complex adjustment; therefore organismic order points to design. Aquinas' Fifth Way is not identical: it concerns regular directedness of non-conscious nature.
- **Presupposition. ANALYSIS:** Relevant natural order is improbable or explanatorily deficient under non-intentional processes.
- **Distinction. FACT:** Paley's artifact analogy differs from contemporary probabilistic/fine-tuning arguments; Darwin directly weakens biological adaptation as Paley used it.
- **Canonical example. FACT:** The watch on the heath; Nyāya's potter-pot inference is the closest Indian analogue.
- **Objection -> reply. FACT:** Hume attacks the analogy, inference to one perfect God, and immunity to counterevidence. A cumulative reply reduces the claim from demonstration to inference to the best explanation.

8.4 Nyāya-Udayana inference to Īśvara

- **Doctrine statement. FACT:** Nyāya infers an omniscient intelligent efficient cause who orders eternal atoms and dispenses karmic results. The classical locus is **Udayana's Nyāyakusumāñjali** (5th stabaka), *supported by his Ātmatattvaviveka; earlier statements are in Vātsyāyana, Uddyotakara and Jayanta's Nyāyamañjarī*.*
- **Udayana's enumeration - the complete list, stated carefully. FACT:** Udayana compresses his grounds into a single mnemonic verse whose terms are conventionally unpacked as **eight hetus**. ANALYSIS: Translations and school-summaries differ in how they split and gloss the last four; the safe examination practice is to give the Sanskrit term, one clause of content, and to flag that enumerations vary.

#	Hetu (Sanskrit)	Inference offered	Status
1	kāryāt	The composite world is an <i>effect</i> ; every effect presupposes an intelligent maker who knows its material, means and purpose	FACT: Core

#	Hetu (Sanskrit)	Inference offered	Status
2	āyōjanāt	Inert atoms cannot combine themselves; the initial conjunction (<i>saṃyoga</i>) of atoms requires a conscious agent's volition	FACT: Core
3	dhṛtyādeḥ	Support, sustenance and periodic dissolution of the cosmos require a governing will ("ādī" carries the maintenance/destruction pair)	FACT: Core
4	padāt	The transmission of language, arts and crafts presupposes an original competent teacher	FACT:
5	pratyayataḥ	The validity (prāmānya) of the Veda as a body of knowledge requires a trustworthy (<i>āpta</i>) author	FACT:
6	śruteḥ	The Veda's own testimony to Īśvara counts as evidence within the system	FACT:
7	vākyāt	The Veda consists of <i>sentences</i> , and sentences are of the kind produced by persons - hence a personal author	FACT:
8	saṃkhyāviśeṣāt	The "special number": the <i>dyad (dvyaṇuka)</i> that begins creation requires the numerical cognition (<i>apekṣā-buddhi</i>) of a conscious being present at the start, when no finite self is embodied	CAUTION: Technically the hardest; state it only if you can state it correctly

ANALYSIS: The adṛṣṭa argument runs beneath all of these: unconscious merit and demerit cannot themselves select who receives which fruit, so an intelligent superintendent (*karmādhyaḥkṣa*) is required. It is usually treated as the philosophical core of (3).

- **Presupposition.** ANALYSIS: World-wholes are relevantly analogous to artifacts; unconscious *adṛṣṭa* cannot administer itself; inference can range legitimately beyond the perceptible.
- **Distinction.** FACT: Īśvara is the **efficient**, never the material, cause in classical Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika; atoms (*paramāṇu*), space, time, ether and selves are eternal and uncreated. God arranges; he does not manufacture *ex nihilo*.
- **Canonical example.** FACT: A pot's ordered parts warrant inference to a potter; the world is treated as a vastly more complex *kārya*.
- **Objection -> reply.** FACT: **Mīmāṃsā** denies the need for a Vedic author (the Veda is *apauruṣeya* and self-validating) and treats karma as self-fructifying through *apūrva*; **Cārvāka** denies that inference can reach the supersensible at all; **Buddhists** (Dharmakīrti, Śāntarakṣita) attack the causal premise; **Advaita** grants Īśvara only *vyāvahārika* standing. Nyāya's standing reply is that unconscious merit cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits, and that the dissimilarity between pot and cosmos affects the *strength*, not the *form*, of the inference.
- **Verdict formula.** ANALYSIS: "Udayana's is the most systematic Indian natural theology: it is a **cumulative** case, not a single demonstration, and it inherits exactly the Humean liabilities of the Western design argument - plus one of its own, that the artifact analogy is doing more work in (1)-(2) than the atomism can bear."

8.5 Moral argument

- **Doctrine statement.** FACT: Kant does not theoretically prove God; practical reason postulates God and immortality in relation to the highest good, where virtue and happiness are proportioned.
- **Argument.** FACT: (1) Moral law obligates pursuit of the highest good; (2) finite agents cannot secure harmony of virtue and happiness; (3) practical rational hope postulates conditions under which it is possible; (4) God and immortality are therefore practical postulates.
- **Presupposition.** ANALYSIS: "Ought implies can" applies to the highest good and moral rationality licenses postulation.
- **Distinction.** FACT: A postulate of practical reason is not a speculative demonstration or empirical hypothesis.
- **Objection -> reply.** ANALYSIS: The argument may project a desire for cosmic fairness. Kant's reply is that the postulate arises from moral reason's structure, not reward-seeking heteronomy.

8.6 Jainism: rejection of a creator, and what "God" then means (2019 Q5(e) owner-module)

ANALYSIS: Read the question exactly. "Proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism" is a trap-shaped stem: Jainism offers **no proof of a creator God** - it offers (a) a battery of arguments *against* a creator, and (b) a positive doctrine of divinity as the **perfected soul**. A script that invents Jain theistic proofs loses the paper; a script that says only "Jainism is atheistic" loses half the marks.

- **Doctrine statement.** FACT: Jainism is **non-theistic but not irreligious**: the universe (*loka*) is uncreated, beginningless and eternal, running by its own six *dravyas* (jīva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, ākāśa, kāla) and by the karmic mechanism; there is no creator, sustainer or destroyer. Divinity is not a cosmic office but an **achieved state of the soul**.
- **The Jain arguments against a creator, reconstructed.** FACT: (classically assembled in Jinasena's *Mahāpurāṇa* and Hemacandra's works; also Haribhadra, Akalaṅka, Vidyānandī)
- 1. **Motive argument (the strongest, and the one the examiner wants).** A perfect being is by definition complete - without unfulfilled desire, deficiency or need. Creation is an *action*, and every action presupposes a want or purpose. Therefore either God is perfect and had no motive to create, or God had a motive and is not perfect. FACT:
- 2. **Regress argument.** If everything that exists needs a maker, the maker needs a maker; if the maker can be uncaused, so can the world - the premise defeats itself. FACT:
- 3. **Instrument/material argument.** Before creation there was no matter, no space, no body and no instrument; an immaterial God with nothing to work on and nothing to work with cannot act. FACT:
- 4. **Moral argument (theodicy in reverse).** If God created out of compassion, the world would not contain suffering, inequality and predation; if he created without compassion, he is not good. Karma, by contrast, explains the *distribution* of fortune without impugning anyone's goodness. FACT:
- 5. **Redundancy argument.** Karmic matter, the six substances and the causal laws already explain order, bondage and release; a creator adds no explanatory work. FACT: (This is the *lāghava*/parsimony move.)
- 6. **Nature (svabhāva) argument.** Things act according to their own nature - fire burns, water flows - so cosmic regularity needs no external superintendent. FACT:
- **What Jainism affirms instead - and the distinction you must not blur.** FACT:
- **Arihanta / Kevalin:** one who has destroyed the four *ghātiyā* (obscuring) karmas and attained *kevala-jñāna* (omniscience) **while still embodied**.
- **Tīrthaṅkara ("ford-maker"):** a special class of arihanta who, having attained omniscience, **re-establishes the tīrtha*** - the fourfold order of monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen - and preaches the path. There are **24 in each half-cycle**; Mahāvīra is the 24th of the present. A Tīrthaṅkara is thus defined by a **teaching-and-founding function**, not by a metaphysical rank above other Kevalins.
- **Siddha:** the soul that has additionally shed the four *aghātiyā* karmas at death, is **disembodied**, and rests at the *siddhaśīlā* at the summit of the *loka* with the four infinitudes (*ananta-catustaya*: infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy). FACT:
- **ANALYSIS: Therefore:** every Tīrthaṅkara becomes a Siddha, but not every Siddha was a Tīrthaṅkara; and **neither creates, sustains, judges or answers prayer**. Worship of the Tīrthaṅkara (*vītarāga*, "one free of passion") is **commemorative and aspirational** - the object of worship does not respond, and cannot, since responsiveness would be a passion.
- **FACT:** The *Namokāra* mantra's five-fold salutation (arihanta, siddha, ācārya, upādhyāya, sādhu) salutes **qualities and stages**, not a deity.
- **Presupposition.** ANALYSIS: That perfection excludes motivated action; that parsimony favours an intrinsic karmic mechanism; that consciousness belongs intrinsically to an eternal plurality of jīvas.
- **Objection -> reply.** FACT: **Nyāya's objection:** unconscious karmic matter cannot allot determinate fruits to determinate persons, nor can inert atoms self-organise - an intelligent *adhyakṣa* is required. **Jain reply:** karmic influx and maturation are law-like properties of the jīva-pudgala relation, exactly as poison acts without a poisoner supervising it. ANALYSIS: **Counter-objection:** "God has no motive" assumes creation must be motivated as *human* action is - a classical theist replies that creation is a free, non-needy expression of goodness (*bonum*

diffusivum sui), not the satisfaction of a lack. This exchange is the highest-yield paragraph in the answer.

- **Verdict formula.** ANALYSIS: "Jainism supplies no proof of God; it supplies a proof-structure *against* a creator and a redefinition of divinity as the soul's achieved perfection. Its motive argument is genuinely powerful against an anthropomorphic creator, and genuinely weaker against a classical theism that denies creation is need-driven."

8.7 The Buddhist case against a creator God, reconstructed (2018 Q8(b) owner-module)

- **Doctrine statement.** FACT: Buddhism denies a creator (*Īśvara/Brahmā* understood as world-maker) on three independent fronts: **canonical-critical**, **causal-metaphysical**, and **moral**. It does not thereby deny the existence of *devas*, who are simply long-lived, impermanent beings inside *saṃsāra*.
- **(a) Canonical/critical stratum.** FACT: The *Brahmajāla Sutta* (DN 1) explains belief in a creator genetically: the being first reborn in an empty *Brahmā*-world, seeing others appear after his wish, mistakenly concludes "I am *Brahmā*, the Maker, the Creator" - and later arrivals, remembering him, transmit the error. The *Aggañña Sutta* (DN 27) replaces creation with a naturalistic-cyclic account of cosmic and social evolution. FACT: The **avyākata** (undeclared) questions and the parable of the man wounded by a poisoned arrow set aside speculative cosmogony as soteriologically useless. ANALYSIS: Note the honest limit: these are *diagnoses of the belief*, not refutations of the proposition.
- **(b) Causal-metaphysical stratum (Dharmakīrti, Śāntarakṣita's Tattvasaṃgraha with Kamalaśīla's commentary).** FACT: This is where the examinable argument lies.
 1. **Criterion of existence:** to be real is to be causally efficacious (*arthakriyā-kāritva*).
 2. **The dilemma of successive vs simultaneous production (krama-akrama-virodha):** a permanent, **unchanging** cause must produce its effects either all at once or successively. If all at once, the whole cosmos would arise in one instant and nothing would follow. If successively, then God must change - acquiring at t_1 some auxiliary condition he lacked at t_0 - and is therefore neither permanent nor self-sufficient.
 3. **Auxiliary-condition regress:** if God needs auxiliaries (material, karma, time), he is not the sole cause; if he does not, the temporal order of the world is unexplained.
 4. **Evidential objection:** God is neither perceived nor validly inferred; the inference from "effect" to "intelligent maker" fails because *vyāpti* (invariable concomitance) between "being an effect" and "having a conscious maker" is established only for artifacts, and generalising it is the very point at issue.
 5. **Explanatory redundancy:** *pratītyasamutpāda* - conditioned co-arising - already accounts for arising and cessation; a creator is an idle wheel.
- **(c) Moral stratum.** FACT: If a being had the power to create and ordered a world containing this quantity of suffering, that being is either not benevolent or not omnipotent; and if all is God's will, karma and moral effort are pointless. The *Devadaha Sutta* (MN 101) makes the parallel point against determinism generally: a doctrine that makes present effort ineffective destroys the moral life. ANALYSIS: The verse-form of this argument in the *Bhūridatta Jātaka* is standardly cited but the wording is translation-dependent - paraphrase it.
- **Presupposition.** ANALYSIS: Causal efficacy is the mark of the real; permanence and productive activity are incompatible; soteriology sets the agenda for metaphysics.
- **Distinction.** FACT: Buddhism is **non-theistic**, not merely atheistic: it rejects a *creator*, not every divine being; it rejects *Īśvara-kāraṇa-vāda*, not devotion as such. Later Mahāyāna Buddha-fields and celestial bodhisattvas perform religious functions without an omnipotent creator ever entering the system.
- **Objection -> reply.** ANALYSIS: **Nyāya's reply:** God's willing is eternal while its *effects* are timed by the readiness of *adṛṣṭa*, so no change in God is required; and to demand perception of God is to beg the question against inference. **Buddhist rejoinder:** an eternal will whose efficacy is timed by something else is not the sole and sufficient cause the theist claimed. ANALYSIS: **Second objection:** if there is no self and no creator, what carries karma? - routed to Soul Section 8.3.
- **Verdict formula.** ANALYSIS: "The Buddhist case is strongest where it is metaphysical - the permanence/production dilemma bites on any *unchanging* creator - and weakest where it is merely genetic, since explaining why people believe in *Brahmā* does not show there is none."

8.8 Cumulative-case logic: how the proofs are supposed to work together

- **Doctrine statement.** FACT: No single theistic argument is standardly claimed to be demonstrative today; the live claim is that several independently weak arguments **jointly** raise the probability of theism - Richard Swinburne's programme in *The Existence of God*, and Basil Mitchell's in *The Justification of Religious Belief*.
- **Argument.** FACT: (1) Distinguish a **P-inductive** argument (premises make the conclusion *more probable than not*) from a **C-inductive** argument (premises *raise* the probability of the conclusion without making it more probable than not). (2) Cosmological, teleological, consciousness, providence, religious-experience and moral arguments are individually C-inductive at best. (3) On a Bayesian confirmation model, several independent C-inductive arguments can together yield a P-inductive result, provided the prior probability of theism is not vanishingly small and the evidence-items are genuinely independent. (4) Swinburne adds that theism has a high prior on grounds of **simplicity** - a personal explanation citing one agent with infinite (hence non-arbitrary) degrees of power, knowledge and freedom is simpler than any finite alternative.
- **Presupposition.** ANALYSIS: That confirmation is probabilistic rather than demonstrative; that the intrinsic simplicity of a hypothesis is evidentially relevant; that the pieces of evidence do not merely repeat one another.
- **Distinction.** FACT: A **cumulative case** is not a chain (as strong as its weakest link) but a **rope** or a legal brief (many strands, none sufficient alone). FACT: Distinguish it also from **inference to the best explanation**, which compares rival total hypotheses rather than accumulating probability.
- **Canonical example.** FACT: Basil Mitchell's analogy: a jury convicts on converging circumstantial evidence, none of which alone establishes guilt. FACT: Udayana's *Nyāyakusumāñjali* is structurally the same move made in the eleventh century - and should be presented that way in an Indian-Western comparison.
- **Objection -> reply.** FACT: **Antony Flew's "ten leaky buckets"**: buckets that each leak hold no more water when stacked; zero plus zero is zero. **Reply**: the objection would be correct if each argument had *no* evidential force, but a C-inductive argument by definition has some; the correct image is strands of a rope, or Bayesian updating on successive independent evidence. ANALYSIS: **Second objection**: the same procedure would confirm rival hypotheses (a finite designer, a committee of gods, an axiarchic principle) - the cumulative case underdetermines *which* God. **Reply**: simplicity considerations are supposed to select the infinite single agent; critics reply that "simplicity" is doing contested metaphysical work. ANALYSIS: **Third**: evil is evidence on the other side, so the case must be run as a *net* balance, not a one-way sum - routed to Problem of Evil.
- **Verdict formula.** ANALYSIS: "Individually the proofs fail as demonstrations; cumulatively they can at most establish a probability, and even then they underdetermine the personal, morally perfect God of worship. That gap - between the God of the arguments and the God of religion - is the standing conclusion of the entire clause."

9. INTER-THINKER / INTER-SCHOOL DEBATES

EXAM-READY LINE: Comparison earns marks only when thinkers are tested through a constant axis such as starting point, causal model, divine attributes, objection and final explanatory reach.

Proof	Starting point	Conclusion claimed	Indian parallel	Main critic
Ontological	FACT: Concept of maximal being	Necessary existence	ANALYSIS: No exact classical analogue	Gaunilo, Kant
Cosmological	FACT: Motion/causation/contingency	First/necessary cause	Nyāya <i>kāryāt</i>	Hume, Kant
Design	FACT: Order/purpose	Intelligent designer	Nyāya <i>āyojanāt</i>	Hume, Darwin
Moral	FACT: Moral law/highest good	Practical postulate	Karma-dispenser in theistic schools	Autonomy/Euthyphro
Mīmāṃsā critique	FACT: Eternal Veda and self-operating dharma	No creator required	-	Nyāya
Jain critique	FACT: Perfection excludes motive; karma is self-operating	No creator; divinity = perfected soul	-	Nyāya (adṛṣṭa needs an allocator)
Buddhist critique	FACT: Causal efficacy; <i>krama-akrama</i> dilemma	A permanent cause cannot produce a temporal world	-	Nyāya (eternal will, timed effects)

Proof	Starting point	Conclusion claimed	Indian parallel	Main critic
Cumulative case	FACT: Several C-inductive arguments	Probable theism	Udayana's eight-fold <i>stabaka</i>	Flew's leaky buckets

10. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES

EXAM-READY LINE: A criticism should identify whether it attacks validity, a premise's truth or the adequacy of the conclusion, and the reply must answer that exact level.

Objection	Proof affected	Reply	Assessment
"Existence is not a predicate"	Ontological	Modal versions use necessary existence	ANALYSIS: Possibility premise bears the burden
Fallacy of composition	Cosmological	Argument concerns dependence, not shared property	ANALYSIS: Must state an essentially ordered series
Weak world-artifact analogy	Design/Nyāya	Treat as probabilistic, not deductive	ANALYSIS: Conclusion becomes modest
Cause need not be personal/perfect	Cosmological/design	Cumulative arguments add attributes	ANALYSIS: No single proof reaches classical theism
Karma can operate without God	Nyāya	Intelligent allocation explains specificity	CAUTION: Dispute tracks rival metaphysics

11. COMMON UPSC TRAPS

EXAM-READY LINE: The central examination trap is to collapse distinct doctrines or to claim that a criticism proves more than its argument actually establishes.

- ANALYSIS: Do not merge Aquinas' five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument.
- ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the watch analogy to Aquinas; it is associated with Paley.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say Kant proves God through morality; he postulates God for practical reason.
- ANALYSIS: Do not call Nyāya's God the material cause of atoms.
- ANALYSIS: Do not present Hume as proving that no designer exists; his target is the inference's strength and conclusion.
- ANALYSIS: Distinguish a proof's validity from the adequacy of the God it establishes.
- ANALYSIS: **Do not invent Jain "proofs for God"**. Jainism proves no creator; it argues *against* one and relocates divinity in the perfected soul. Answer the printed stem by saying so in the first line.
- ANALYSIS: Do not equate **Tīrthaṅkara** and **Siddha**. Tīrthaṅkara = an omniscient, still-embodied arihanta who re-founds the fourfold order and teaches (24 per half-cycle); Siddha = the disembodied liberated soul at the *siddhaśīlā*. Every Tīrthaṅkara becomes a Siddha; not every Siddha was a Tīrthaṅkara. Neither creates or responds.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say Buddhism denies all gods. It denies a **creator**; devas are impermanent beings within saṃsāra.
- ANALYSIS: Do not reduce the Buddhist case to "the Buddha was silent". The examinable argument is Dharmakīrti/Śāntaraksita's **krama-akrama** dilemma about a permanent cause producing a temporal world.
- ANALYSIS: Do not present Udayana's list as a fixed canonical eight without noting that glosses of *padāt/pratyayataḥ/vākyāt/saṃkhyāviśeṣāt* differ; give the Sanskrit term plus one clause of content.
- ANALYSIS: Do not treat a cumulative case as a chain of deductions. It is Bayesian/rope-like; the standing objection is Flew's leaky buckets and the standing reply is that C-inductive arguments are not zero-valued.

12. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

EXAM-READY LINE: Ontological arguments reason a priori from the God-concept, whereas cosmological, teleological and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) arguments reason a posteriori from experienced reality.

Keywords: FACT: *a priori* · *a posteriori* · ontological · necessary existence · real predicate · cosmological · essentially ordered series · contingency · sufficient reason · teleological · analogy · regularity · fine order · practical postulate · *summum bonum* · *kāryāt* · *āyojanāt* · *dhṛtyādeḥ* · *padāt* · *pratyayataḥ* · *śruteḥ* · *vākyāt* · *saṃkhyāviśeṣāt* · *apekṣā-buddhi* · efficient cause · *adrṣṭa* · *karmādhyakṣa* · *apauruṣeya* · *arthakriyā-kāritva* · *krama-akrama-virodha* · *pratītyasamutpāda* · *avyākata* · arihanta/kevalin · tīrthaṅkara · siddha · *ananta-catuṣṭaya* · *vītarāga* · *svabhāva* · *lāghava* (parsimony) · C-inductive/P-inductive · cumulative case · leaky buckets.

Safe formulations: ANALYSIS: "Most proofs underdetermine the rich God of religion." · "Nyāya and Western natural theology converge in inference from order, but diverge over material causation and karma." · "Jainism and Buddhism do not merely lack a proof of God; they supply arguments that a creator is either unmotivated or causally impossible." · "A cumulative case can raise probability; it cannot by itself select the God of worship."

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (expanded PYQ audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership is 12 of 112 parts and now spans Indian and Western proof-families over the full eight years.
- FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The expanded burden includes Anselm, Jain proofs, the moral argument, Aquinas-Nyāya comparison and Buddhist anti-creator arguments, alongside Five Ways, design and Nyāya inference.
- WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not list proofs without premises and target conclusion; distinguish critique of validity, soundness, divine attributes and the inference from a cause to the God of religion.

13. PYQ ROUTING (2018-2025)

EXAM-READY LINE: ANALYSIS: Corpus signal: 12 primary-owned question-parts out of 112.

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 12 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper II corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q6(c)	15 marks	Does the concept of God entail the existence of God? Examine from the perspective of ontological argument.
2018	Q8(a)	20 marks	Compare St. Thomas Aquinas' five ways of knowing God with the arguments of the Nyāya School of Indian Philosophy for the existence of God.
2018	Q8(b)	15 marks	Critically evaluate the Buddhistic arguments against the existence of God as the creator of the world.
2019	Q5(e)	10 marks	State and evaluate the proofs for the existence of God as propounded in Jainism.
2020	Q6(a)	20 marks	Is the ontological proof for the existence of God by St. Anselm logical? Discuss.
2021	Q7(b)	15 marks	Give a critical account of moral argument to prove the existence of God.
2022	Q6(a)	20 marks	Present a critical exposition of different arguments offered by St. Thomas Aquinas to prove the existence of God also known as 'Five Ways'. Which one of them do you find philosophically most interesting? Give reasons in support of your answer.
2022	Q8(a)	20 marks	Discuss the main points of distinction between a priori and a posteriori arguments for the existence of God. Which one according to you should be preferred over the other? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.
2023	Q7(a)	20 marks	Critically examine the arguments of Nyāya for the existence of God.
2024	Q7(c)	15 marks (10+5)	Present an exposition of ontological proof for the existence of God along with its criticism.
2025	Q6(a)	20 marks	Present an account of Design argument to prove the existence of God along with its criticism by David Hume.
2025	Q7(b)	15 marks	What proofs do Nyāya philosophers offer for the existence of God? Discuss.

See the Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018-2025.

14. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (10 / 15 / 20 MARKS)

EXAM-READY LINE: A high-scoring answer moves from exact definition to argument reconstruction, objection and reply, comparison and a criterion-based graded verdict.

10 marks

Name and classify the proof -> state premises in sequence -> identify one presupposition -> give the canonical objection -> one-sentence verdict on what the proof actually establishes.

15 marks

Frame the explanatory question -> reconstruct argument -> canonical example -> critic's strongest objection -> proponent's reply -> assess validity and conclusion separately.

20 marks

Classify the family of proofs -> full internal steps -> contrast Indian/Western analogue -> two objections and replies -> underdetermination of divine attributes -> graded conclusion.

15. DIRECTIVE DECODER (what the verb obliges you to produce)

EXAM-READY LINE: The directive fixes the answer's burden: exposition requires accurate reconstruction, comparison requires a constant axis, and critical examination requires objection, reply and verdict.

Directive	Examiner is buying	Structural consequence	Live example
Present an account of... along with its criticism	Two balanced halves, explicitly signposted	Split the page - exposition first, then critique; do not let critique eat exposition	2025 Q6(a) design + Hume; 2024 Q7(c) ontological (10+5 - obey the split)
Critically examine / evaluate	Reconstruction and verdict on validity <i>and</i> soundness	Premises -> presupposition -> objection -> reply -> graded verdict	2023 Q7(a) Nyāya; 2018 Q8(b) Buddhist
Compare X with Y	A stated <i>tertium comparationis</i>	Announce the axes first, then run both down each axis	2018 Q8(a) Aquinas vs Nyāya -> use Section 5A
Which do you find most interesting? Give reasons	A defended personal selection with a criterion	Name the criterion (explanatory reach? least contested premise?) before choosing	2022 Q6(a) Five Ways
Does the concept entail the existence?	Engagement with the <i>predicate</i> question	Kant's premise must be stated, not just named	2018 Q6(c)
Which should be preferred? Give reasons	Ranking with a cost accounting	Prefer one, then state precisely what you lose	2022 Q8(a) a priori vs a posteriori
State and evaluate the proofs propounded in [school]	Fidelity to what the school actually holds	If the school holds none, <i>say so in line 1</i> and supply what it does hold	2019 Q5(e) Jainism -> Section 8.6
What proofs do X offer? Discuss	Enumeration with premises , not a list of labels	One line of content per named <i>hetu</i>	2025 Q7(b) Nyāya -> Section 8.4 table

MEMORY: Rule: for every proof, answer three separate questions - is it **valid**? are its premises **true**? and does its conclusion reach the **God of religion**? Most scripts answer only the first.

16. GRADED VERDICT LADDER

EXAM-READY LINE: A graded verdict should state what the argument establishes, what it fails to establish and which disputed premise determines the remaining uncertainty.

Band	What the script contains	Typical fault
Weak (≈40%)	Names the four Western proofs and "Nyāya's inference"; narrates the watch	No premises; critique reduced to "Kant disagreed"

Band	What the script contains	Typical fault
Average (≈50%)	One proof reconstructed; standard critique attached	Indian side reduced to one sentence; no distinction between validity and soundness
Good (≈60%)	Premises numbered; presupposition named; one objection answered	Conclusion-gap (from "first cause" to "God") not noticed
Strong (≈65-70%)	Validity/soundness/adequacy separated; Indian parallel argued, not asserted; reply to the objection	Cumulative logic still treated as a chain
Top (≈70%+)	All the above + a discriminating distinction (essentially vs accidentally ordered series; C- vs P-inductive; Tirthaṅkara vs Siddha; <i>krama-akrama</i>) + a statement of what evidence would change the verdict	-

Graded-verdict templates:

- ANALYSIS: *Single-proof stem*: "The argument is valid on reading X but its second premise is exactly what the critic denies; even if sound it delivers only ____, and the distance from that to the God of worship must be crossed by a separate argument."
- ANALYSIS: *Comparison stem*: "Aquinas and Udayana converge in form - both are cumulative inferences from the world's dependence and order - and diverge in content: Aquinas' God is the source of *being*, Udayana's the arranger of *eternal* atoms and the allocator of karma."
- ANALYSIS: *Anti-theistic stem*: "The school's negative case succeeds against the creator it targets - an anthropomorphic, motivated, changing maker - and leaves untouched the classical theist's non-needy, timeless creator; whether that surviving concept is intelligible is a different question."

17. FACTUAL AND QUOTATION DISCIPLINE

EXAM-READY LINE: Use quotations only with secure attribution, and prefer an accurate paraphrase to a decorative or uncertain formula.

Item	Status	Safe use
"That than which nothing greater can be conceived"	FACT: Anselm, <i>Proslogion</i> 2	Quote; then give the reductio form
"Existence is not a real predicate"	FACT: Kant, <i>Critique of Pure Reason</i> , A598/B626 region	Quote in this standard English form
Watch-and-watchmaker	FACT: Paley , <i>Natural Theology</i> (1802), ch. 1	Never attribute to Aquinas
Aquinas' Five Ways	FACT: <i>ST I</i> q.2 a.3	Way 5 is about regular directedness, <i>not</i> Paley's artifact analogy
Hume's design critique	FACT: <i>Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion</i> (posth. 1779), Parts II, V, VII, XI	Philo, not Cleanthes, carries the objections
Udayana's grounds	FACT: <i>Nyāyakusumāñjali</i> , 5th <i>stabaka</i>	Give Sanskrit term + one clause; flag that glosses vary CAUTION:
Jain anti-creator arguments	FACT: Assembled in Jinasena's <i>Mahāpurāṇa</i> and Hemacandra	Attribute to the tradition; avoid verbatim English "quotations"
Buddhist anti-Īśvara argument	FACT: Śāntarakṣita, <i>Tattvasaṃgraha</i> (with Kamalaśīla's <i>Pañjikā</i>); Dharmakīrti	Cite the <i>argument</i> , not an English sentence
<i>Brahmajāla</i> (DN 1), <i>Aggañña</i> (DN 27), <i>Devadaha</i> (MN 101)	FACT: Verified nikāya references	Paraphrase; translations differ
Bhūridatta Jātaka anti-creator verses	CAUTION: Widely cited, wording translation-dependent	Paraphrase only

Item	Status	Safe use
"Ten leaky buckets"	FACT: Antony Flew, <i>God and Philosophy</i>	Pair it with the rope/Bayesian reply
C-inductive / P-inductive	FACT: Richard Swinburne's terminology, <i>The Existence of God</i>	Use precisely - they are not synonyms

18. LINK-OUTS

EXAM-READY LINE: Notions of God - what kind of God the proofs are supposed to reach.

- Notions of God - what kind of God the proofs are supposed to reach
- Reason, Revelation and Faith - what follows when the proofs underdetermine
- Problem of Evil - the counter-evidence a cumulative case must net out
- Religion without God - Cārvāka on inference to the supersensible; Mīmāṃsā's *apūrva*
- Paper I: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika - *anumāna*, *vyāpti*, atomism, *adr̥ṣṭa*
- Paper I: Jainism - six *dravyas*, karmic matter, the *guṇasthāna* ladder
- Paper I: Buddhism - *pratītyasamutpāda*, momentariness, *arthakriyā*
- Paper I: Cārvāka - the attack on inference that undercuts every *anumāna*-based proof
- Paper I: Mīmāṃsā - *apauruṣeya* Veda against Udayana's *vākyāt/śruteḥ*
- Paper I: Kant - the predicate objection and the practical postulate
- Philosophy of Religion PYQ Bank, 2018-2025

Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 2

EXAM-READY LINE: ##### 2. Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique.

2. Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique

EXAM-READY LINE: A proof of God is an argument from concept, world or moral experience to divine existence, and its critique must separately test validity, soundness and adequacy.

- **Core prerequisite:** Finish ontological, cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya proofs, the standard Hume/Kant/Mīmāṃsā/Buddhist critiques, a priori vs a posteriori, and the owner's answer architectures for 2018-2025 proof questions.

Optional advanced debate	Precise competing positions	Strongest extra objection -> counter-reply	Safe use in a 15/20-marker
ANALYSIS: Modal ontological argument vs Kantian/ parody critique	Modal defenders argue that if a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily; Kantian critics deny that conceptual analysis can secure existence, while parody critics attack the form.	Objection: the possibility premise quietly assumes what it must prove. -> Reply: the debate shifts from bare existence to the coherence of maximal greatness.	Use as a one-line "modern repair attempt" after Anselm/Descartes, never instead of the core ontological structure.
ANALYSIS: Principle of sufficient reason vs brute-fact universe	Rationalists and Thomists deny that contingent reality can be explanatorily ultimate; Humean or anti-PSR critics allow brute fact or infinite regress.	Objection: the total universe may simply be there. -> Reply: contingent totality still lacks self-explanation, so the explanatory demand does not disappear by enlarging the set.	Useful for the evaluative conclusion of cosmological arguments.
ANALYSIS: Fine-tuning / Bayesian cumulative case vs underdetermination	Some modern theists present design probabilistically through fine-tuning and cumulative evidence; critics appeal to multiverse hypotheses or underdetermination.	Objection: probabilistic design is too weak and rivals remain available. -> Reply: defenders present it as an inference-to-best-explanation supplement, not a knock-down proof.	Mention only as a modern extension of teleology; do not replace Paley, Aquinas, or Hume in UPSC exposition.

Optional advanced debate	Precise competing positions	Strongest extra objection -> counter-reply	Safe use in a 15/20-marker
ANALYSIS: Udayana-style cumulative Nyāya theism vs Mīmāṃsā/Buddhist anti-creator lines	Udayana multiplies inferential routes to Īśvara; Mīmāṃsā, Buddhism, and anti-creator schools resist the need for a divine allocator or author.	Objection: karma, Veda, and order can function without a creator. -> Reply: Nyāya insists unconscious <i>adṛṣṭa</i> and authorless linguistic normativity cannot by themselves explain ordered allocation and intelligibility.	Strong optional finish in Nyāya answers to show that Indian debate is not just a single <i>kāryāt</i> inference.

- **What not to over-study:** Do not load answers with modal notation, probability equations, or every listed proof in *Nyāyakusumāñjali*.
- **Promotion trigger:** Promote if a PYQ asks modal versions, cumulative-case reasoning, or specialist Nyāya-Udayana reconstruction directly.
- **Credible source trail:** FACT: Anselm, *Proslogion*; FACT: Thomas Aquinas, *Summa Theologiae* / *Summa Contra Gentiles*; FACT: David Hume, *Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion*; FACT: Immanuel Kant, *Critique of Pure Reason*; FACT: Udayana, *Nyāyakusumāñjali*; FACT: B.K. Matilal, writings on Nyāya reasoning and Indian philosophical method.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Placement note: These register notes come **after** all teaching and practice, and cover **every one of the thirteen subtopics** taught in this session. They are the last-mile revision layer and a compressed recall instrument, not a repetition of the teaching introduction above.

FINAL REGISTER 1/13 - The architecture of theistic proof

EXAM-READY LINE: Theistic proofs are best classified by starting point, inferential form and the concept of God reached, then tested separately for validity, soundness and adequacy.

Item	Register entry
Syllabus wording	FACT: "Proofs for the Existence of God and their Critique (Indian and Western)"
Three senses of "proof"	FACT: Demonstration · probable/explanatory inference · practical postulate
The assessment grid	ANALYSIS: Validity (does it follow?) -> Soundness (are the premises true?) -> Adequacy (is the being reached <i>God</i> ?)
A priori route	FACT: Ontological only (Anselm, Descartes)
A posteriori routes	FACT: Cosmological, teleological, moral, Nyāya <i>Īśvara-anumāna</i>
A priori strength / weakness	FACT: Yields necessity / ANALYSIS: commits the existence-predicate fallacy
A posteriori strength / weakness	FACT: Begins from conceded facts / ANALYSIS: reaches only a probable, finite cause
2022 verdict formula	ANALYSIS: Preference depends on the criterion: evidential contact -> a posteriori; modal strength -> a priori; religious adequacy -> neither alone
Mnemonic	MEMORY: O-C-T-M + N , critiqued by J-B-M

FINAL REGISTER 2/13 - Ontological argument

EXAM-READY LINE: The ontological argument seeks to infer necessary existence from the concept of the greatest conceivable or maximally perfect being.

- FACT: **Anselm's definition:** "that than which nothing greater can be conceived"; "greater" = more perfect. Not "the most perfect being that there is".
- FACT: **First form (Proslogion 2):** existing in reality is greater than existing in the mind alone; hence God exists in reality. Addressed to the Psalmist's "fool".
- FACT: **Second form (Proslogion 3):** a being that cannot be thought not to exist is greater; hence God exists **necessarily**. Core notion = **aseity / self-existence**.
- FACT: **Descartes (Meditations V):** existence belongs to the essence of a supremely perfect being as three angles to a triangle, or a valley to a mountain.
- ANALYSIS: Descartes' *Meditations* III causal proof is a **different** argument - do not merge.
- FACT: **Gaunilo, In Behalf of the Fool:** the perfect-island parody. ANALYSIS: He should have said "most perfect *conceivable* island".
- FACT: **Anselm's reply:** only God is defined with necessary existence; an island is by definition a contingent piece of land surrounded by water.
- FACT: **Kant:** "existence is not a real predicate"; a hundred real thalers contain no more concept than a hundred possible ones.
- FACT: **Chatterjee-Datta's Indian idiom:** the thought of a hundred rupees in my pocket involves the *idea* of their existence, not their real physical existence.
- ANALYSIS: **Post-Fregean objection:** existence is second-order (instantiation of a concept), so it cannot appear among perfections.
- ANALYSIS: **Modal repair (Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga):** if a maximally great being is possible, it exists necessarily - but the **possibility premise bears the whole burden**, and a parallel "possibly no such being" reverses the result.
- ANALYSIS: **2018 verdict:** the concept entails existence *conditionally*; it does not entail instantiation.
- ANALYSIS: **India:** no classical analogue; Indian epistemology grounds existence-claims in world-involving *pramāṇas*.
- MEMORY: **A-D-G-K-M:** Anselm defines · Descartes essentialises · Gaunilo parodies · Kant diagnoses · Modal logic repairs.

FINAL REGISTER 3/13 - Cosmological arguments

EXAM-READY LINE: FACT: Ways 1-3 are cosmological; Way 4 is henological; Way 5 is teleological.

- FACT: **Five Ways (ST I q.2 a.3):** motion -> prime mover; causation -> first cause; contingency -> necessary being; degrees -> maximum; purposiveness -> designer. Each ends "and this everyone understands to be God".
- FACT: **Ways 1-3 are cosmological; Way 4 is henological; Way 5 is teleological.**
- ANALYSIS: **Essentially ordered (per se) series:** hand -> stick -> stone; derivative power throughout; removal stops the series *now*. This is what Aquinas terminates.
- ANALYSIS: **Accidentally ordered (per accidens) series:** grandfather -> father -> son; Aquinas need not stop it.
- FACT: **"First"** = **explanatory priority**, not the earliest event in time.
- FACT: Aquinas concedes the difficulty of excluding an endless regress of *events*; he holds the world's temporal beginning is known by faith, not demonstration.
- FACT: **Neo-Thomist reformulation:** the excluded series is simultaneous dependence, not backward time.
- ANALYSIS: **Way 3's weak steps:** possible quantifier shift at "at some time nothing would have existed"; and the *necessary ab alio / necessary a se* distinction at the end.
- ANALYSIS: **Way 4:** degrees imply a maximum - defensible only through the metaphysics of participation.

- ANALYSIS: **Kalām**: whatever begins to exist has a cause; the universe began; □ it has a cause. **Argues for a temporal beginning - Aquinas does not.**
- ANALYSIS: **Leibniz/PSR**: why is there something rather than nothing? Every fact needs a sufficient reason; a contingent totality is not self-explanatory.
- FACT: **Hume**: why not an infinite series? explaining each part may explain the whole; the cause need not be one, personal, infinite or good.
- FACT: **Kant**: the passage from "a necessary being" to "the ens realissimum" is the ontological argument in disguise - an **adequacy-tier** objection.
- ANALYSIS: **Composition charge** is met by framing dependence rather than property-transfer.
- MEMORY: **M-C-C-D-P**: Motion, Causation, Contingency, Degrees, Purpose.

FINAL REGISTER 4/13 - Teleological argument

EXAM-READY LINE: FACT: Paley's evidence is cumulative: the eye as a self-adjusting optical instrument, the bird's wing, the fish's fin, planetary rotation, the seasons.

- FACT: **Three distinct teleologies**: Aquinas' Way 5 (regular directedness of non-cognitive nature; **archer and arrow**) · Paley's **analogy** from artefact to organism · modern **fine-tuning** (probabilistic, pre-biological).
- FACT: The design argument runs from Plato's *Timaeus* through Aquinas to Paley's *Natural Theology* (1802).
- FACT: **Paley's watch on the heath**: wheels, cogs, axles, springs and balances working together for regular timekeeping oblige us to postulate an intelligent maker; a stone does not.
- FACT: **Paley's three riders**: the inference survives (i) never having seen a watch made, (ii) imperfect working, (iii) parts whose function we cannot discover.
- FACT: **Paley's evidence is cumulative**: the eye as a self-adjusting optical instrument, the bird's wing, the fish's fin, planetary rotation, the seasons.
- FACT: **Hume's Dialogues (1779) precede Paley (1802)**; Paley took no apparent account of them.
- FACT: **Hume front 1**: any persisting universe must exhibit adaptation - there could not be birds with wings unable to live in air. **Epicurean hypothesis**: finite particles in random motion pass through every combination in unlimited time; one is a stable order.
- FACT: **Hume front 2**: the universe is as like a vegetable or a crustacean as a machine; only strong analogy with a known artefact licenses the inference.
- FACT: **Hume front 3**: proportion cause to effect - from a finite world one can never infer an infinite creator (**the scales illustration**).
- FACT: **Hume front 4**: many designers, an inferior deity, an infant or senile one, or an abandoned first attempt fit the evidence equally.
- FACT: **Hume front 5**: evil and disorder count against a good and powerful designer.
- FACT: **Hume does not disprove a designer**; he attacks inference-strength and divine attributes.
- FACT: **Darwin**: random variation plus differential survival explains adaptation. **Ozone illustration**: life fitted itself to the filter, not the filter to life.
- ANALYSIS: **Darwin's exact scope**: defeats Paley's biological premise; does not touch law-governedness or the fine-tuning of constants.
- ANALYSIS: **Fine-tuning**: Bayesian/explanatory, not analogical; rivals are multiverse plus observation-selection, and brute necessity.
- FACT: **Indian analogue**: āyojanāt, pot and potter; Chatterjee-Datta note the parallels in **Janet, Lotze and Martineau**, but stress that Western theists make God the source of *existence* while Nyāya makes God only the cause of *order*.
- MEMORY: **Hume's five fronts, A-A-P-P-E**: Any universe looks adapted · Analogy weak · Proportion cause to effect · Plurality/imperfection of designers · Evil.

FINAL REGISTER 5/13 - Moral argument

EXAM-READY LINE: FACT: Kant's structure: moral law obligates -> its complete object is the highest good (virtue + proportionate happiness) -> ought implies can -> holiness unattainable in finite time (immortality) and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (God) -> plus freedom, presupposed by obligation.

- FACT: **Kant's two storeys:** *Critique of Pure Reason* destroys the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs; *Critique of Practical Reason* reinstates God as a postulate.
- FACT: **First form (Newman, Grammar of Assent):** conscience implies One before whom we are ashamed and responsible. FACT: **Hick's objection:** it assumes moral values resist naturalistic explanation - which **begs the question**.
- FACT: **Kant's structure:** moral law obligates -> its complete object is the **highest good** (virtue + proportionate happiness) -> ought implies can -> holiness unattainable in finite time (**immortality**) and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (**God**) -> plus **freedom**, presupposed by obligation.
- FACT: **Three postulates: freedom, immortality, God.**
- ANALYSIS: A postulate is practically necessary, theoretically undemonstrable - *Vernunftglaube*, rational faith; subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient assent.
- FACT: **Hick's verdict:** moral seriousness is "at least a move in the direction of belief in God", but moral values cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, omnipotent, self-existent personal creator.
- ANALYSIS: **Objections:** projection/wish-fulfilment; autonomy tension; adequacy. **Euthyphro strikes divine-command theories, not Kant** - for Kant the moral law is autonomous and God guarantees proportion, not obligation.
- FACT: **Indian counterpart:** Nyāya's **karmaphaladātā**. Chatterjee-Datta write: "*Or, as Kant would say, it is God who combines happiness with virtue and misery with vice.*"
- ANALYSIS: **Key contrast:** Kant postulates a God who *could* proportion; Nyāya infers a God who *does* - epistemically bolder, correspondingly more exposed.
- MEMORY: **F-I-G:** Freedom · Immortality · God.

FINAL REGISTER 6/13 - Nyāya-Udayana theism

EXAM-READY LINE: FACT: Nature of Īśvara (Lord or personal God): first efficient cause, a demiurgus or builder - not the material cause; also preserver (the world is kept in existence by God's will) and destroyer (when the moral order requires).

- FACT: **Nature of Īśvara:** first **efficient** cause, a demiurgus or builder - **not the material cause**; also preserver (the world is kept in existence by God's will) and destroyer (when the moral order requires).
- FACT: One, infinite, eternal; the world is related to God as a body to the self residing in it; omnipotent yet **guided by the merit and demerit of human actions**; omniscient.
- FACT: **Eternal intelligence is an inseparable attribute of God, not His essence** - the explicit contrast with Advaita.
- FACT: Possesses the six perfections (*ṣaḍ-aiśvarya*).
- FACT: **God is prayojaka kartā** - efficient *directive* cause of human action; man is the efficient *instrumental* cause and is only relatively free, directed as a wise father directs a son.
- FACT: **God is karmaphaladātā** - impartial dispenser of the fruits of action, moral governor, supreme arbiter of joys and sorrows.
- FACT: **Theism, not deism:** the deist's God withdraws like a clock-maker; Nyāya's God maintains a continuous relation as creator, maintainer and destroyer.
- FACT: **Ten proofs are claimed; the more important are usually four or five.** CAUTION: Enumerations vary - say so.
- FACT: **Kāryāt:** composite objects are effects because they are **made of parts (sāvayava)** and possess **intermediate magnitude (avāntara-mahattva)**; space, time, ether and self are excluded as partless infinities, and atoms and manas as simple infinitesimals; material causes alone cannot achieve the required order, direction and

co-ordination; the intelligent cause must know the atoms, desire an end and will its realisation; **and must be omniscient, since only an omniscient being can directly know atoms.**

- FACT: **Āyojanāt**: inert atoms require purposive combination.
- FACT: **Dhṛtyādeḥ**: support, maintenance and destruction require governance.
- FACT: **Padāt / āptaprāmānya**: the Veda's authority derives from an omniscient author, as a science's authority derives from its founder; the *jīva* cannot be that author because supramundane realities exceed ordinary knowledge.
- FACT: **Śruteḥ**: *Bṛhadāraṇyaka*, *Śvetāśvatara*, *Kauṣītaki* and the *Bhagavadgītā* testify to God.
- FACT: **Argument from adrṣṭa**: differences of lot require a cause -> karma -> the time-gap requires a persisting stock of **punya and pāpa = adrṣṭa** -> *adrṣṭa* is unintelligent and cannot allot the right kind and degree of joy and sorrow; individual selves neither know nor control it -> □ an eternal, omnipotent, omniscient dispenser.
- FACT: **Circularity objection answered**: in the **order of existence** God creates the Veda; in the **order of knowledge** the Veda leads to God. Reciprocal dependence across different orders is not a vicious circle.
- FACT: **Bodiless-agent objection answered** by a dilemma: if God's existence is already proved by śruti the objection is idle; if not, it presupposes what it disputes.
- FACT: **Western parallels**: Janet, Lotze, Martineau; FACT: **decisive divergence** - they make God the creative energy giving existence to things, Nyāya makes God the cause of order only.
- ANALYSIS: **Śaṅkara's atomism dilemma**: atoms active -> permanent creation; inactive -> no creation; both -> contradiction; neither -> an outside agency, itself problematic.
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's redundancy objection**: Nyāya's God is "reduced to the status of a supervisor" with "hands and feet chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma unfolding itself as the *Adrṣṭa*"; the system "could have easily done away with a God".
- FACT: **Chatterjee-Datta's own conclusion**: none of the proofs can prove God, because God, as ultimate reality, is the highest of all premises and cannot be deduced from an anterior one; **God must be known through direct experience**. Lotze: "all proofs that God exists are pleas put forward in justification of our faith."
- MEMORY: **K-A-D-P-Ś + adrṣṭa** · MEMORY: **E-A-K-V**: Efficient cause · Atoms · Karma · Veda.

FINAL REGISTER 7/13 - Two senses of "God" in the Indian debate

EXAM-READY LINE: Denying a creator is not denying divinity, and an Indian school may reject the cosmological office of God completely while affirming achieved perfection completely.

Item	Register entry
Sense A - world-maker	FACT: <i>jagat-kartā</i> / <i>Īśvara-kāraṇa-vāda</i> : creates or arranges, sustains, dissolves, allots karmic fruit
Affirm Sense A	FACT: Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika; theistic Vedānta; Yoga (as a special self)
Deny Sense A	FACT: Jainism, Buddhism, Mīmāṃsā, Cārvāka, classical Sāṃkhya
Sense B - perfected being	FACT: omniscient, passion-free (<i>vītarāga</i>), exemplary, non-creative
Affirm Sense B	FACT: Jainism (<i>arihanta</i> , <i>tīrthaṅkara</i> , <i>siddha</i>); Buddhism (buddhas, celestial bodhisattvas)
Terminological control	ANALYSIS: <i>Nāstika</i> means denier of Vedic authority , not denier of spirit
Buddhist control	ANALYSIS: Buddhism denies a creator , not <i>devas</i> , who are impermanent beings within the round of rebirth
Consequence for 2018 and 2019 stems	ANALYSIS: Answer in Sense A first, then supply Sense B as what the school affirms instead
Mnemonic	MEMORY: A = office, B = attainment

FINAL REGISTER 8/13 - Jaina critique: godhead without God

EXAM-READY LINE: Jainism supplies no proof of a creator; it supplies a proof-structure against one and a redefinition of divinity as the soul's achieved perfection.

- FACT: Denies God as **creator**; the world was never created; substances are eternal and change through **modes**; *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya*.
- FACT: "**Jainism denies God, but does not deny godhead. Every liberated soul is a god.**" Tīrthaṅkaras were mortals who won liberation by personal effort - "we are all potential Jinās". A religion of self-help.
- ANALYSIS: **Proof 1 (svabhāva)**: the *jīva* intrinsically possesses *ananta-catuṣṭaya* - infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power - obscured, not absent.
- ANALYSIS: **Proof 2 (sarvajña-siddhi)**: mati, śruta, avadhi and manahpariyāya map degrees of karmic obstruction; complete removal is the limiting case = **kevala-jñāna**.
- ANALYSIS: **Proof 3 (āpta-vacana)**: the testimony of the omniscient Tīrthaṅkaras, one leg of the **tri-ratna**.
- FACT: **Jaina God**: plural, achieved, non-creative, non-interventionist, exemplary.
- ANALYSIS: **Anti-creator arguments**: from what material? why create at all (a perfect being lacks nothing)? if from compassion, why suffering? if in sport, God is childish and cruel; who made God - and if God is self-existent, so may the world be; karma suffices.
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's internal objection**: if ignorance and karma are inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if external, bondage is impossible.
- ANALYSIS: **Nāstika** means denier of **Vedic authority**, not denier of spirit.

FINAL REGISTER 9/13 - Buddhist anti-creator case

EXAM-READY LINE: The Buddhist case is strongest where it is metaphysical, since the permanence-and-production dilemma bites on any unchanging creator, and weakest where it is merely genetic.

- FACT: An eternal unchanging God cannot create, since willing or producing involves change.
- FACT: Creation from desire or purpose implies lack or incompleteness.
- FACT: Suffering and evil sit uneasily with an omnipotent benevolent creator.
- FACT: **Dependent origination** already explains arising through conditions, making a creator unnecessary.
- ANALYSIS: The *avyākṛta* questions and the **arrow parable**: first-beginning questions are soteriologically idle.
- ANALYSIS: Freedom/karma dilemma: if God determines all, moral effort is empty; if not, God is not the sufficient cause.
- ANALYSIS: **Dharmakīrti-type argument**: a permanent, immutable cause cannot produce *successive* effects.
- FACT: The critique is a **systematic refusal of explanatory surplus**, not bare atheism.
- ANALYSIS: **Replies to note**: Nyāya on determinate allocation; the eternal-act/temporal-effect answer to the change objection; diffusive goodness against the desire objection; economy is a methodological preference, not a disproof.

FINAL REGISTER 10/13 - Mīmāṃsā, Cārvāka and Advaita's levelling

EXAM-READY LINE: Mīmāṃsā displaces God twice over - an authorless Veda removes the author-grounds and self-fructifying ritual potency removes the dispenser-ground - while Cārvāka cuts the inferential route itself.

Mīmāṃsā

- FACT: The Veda is **apauruṣeya** - eternal, authorless, self-valid; no human and **no divine** author is needed.
- FACT: Authorlessness protects it from an author's deceit or ignorance.
- FACT: Against Nyāya: proving God, then His omniscience, then His truthfulness, is a cumbersome three-stage dependence that authorlessness avoids.
- FACT: **Apūrva** - the unseen potency of correctly performed ritual - matures into future fruit **without a divine dispenser**; Prabhākara's **niyoga** grounds obligation in the injunction itself.

- FACT: Chatterjee-Datta record Max Müller's point that a creator God would face charges of **cruelty and partiality**, and his further point that denying a *creator* is not denying God.
- ANALYSIS: Their own criticism: Mīmāṃsā deities are not objects of worship and exist only in the *mantras* describing them - "eternal and self-manifesting concepts"; God is relegated to an ambiguous position.

Cārvāka

- FACT: God cannot be perceived; the world is made by the **automatic combination of the material elements**; the Vedas and priests are rejected.
- ANALYSIS: Perception alone is a *pramāṇa*, so every inferential proof is undercut at the outset.

Advaita's levelling

- ANALYSIS: Nyāya's God is a qualified Lord (*saguṇa Īśvara*) at the empirical (*vyāvahārika*) level, not the quality-transcending absolute (*nirguṇa Brahman*); the atomistic proof is judged logically weak.
- FACT: This is a **demotion**, not a denial - do not list Advaita with Cārvāka.

Classification key

- MEMORY: **E-C-E**: every Indian anti-creator argument is an **Economy** move, a **Coherence** move, or an **Epistemic-restriction** move.

FINAL REGISTER 11/13 - Cumulative-case logic

EXAM-READY LINE: No single theistic argument is defended today as demonstrative; the live claim is that several independently weak arguments jointly raise the probability of theism, which is a rope and not a chain.

- FACT: **C-inductive**: the premises *raise* the probability of the conclusion without making it more probable than not.
- FACT: **P-inductive**: the premises make the conclusion *more probable than not*. The programme is the passage from the first to the second.
- FACT: **Swinburne**, *The Existence of God*: several independent C-inductive arguments can jointly yield a P-inductive result, provided the prior is not vanishingly small and the evidence-items are genuinely independent.
- FACT: **Swinburne's prior**: *simplicity* - one agent with infinite, hence non-arbitrary, degrees of power, knowledge and freedom is simpler than any finite alternative.
- FACT: **Mitchell**, *The Justification of Religious Belief*: the jury analogy - converging circumstantial evidence, no item sufficient alone.
- ANALYSIS: **Image control**: rope or legal brief, never a chain; and a cumulative case is *not* inference to the best explanation, which compares rival total hypotheses.
- FACT: **Flew**, *God and Philosophy*: the **ten leaky buckets** - stacked leaking buckets hold no more water; zero plus zero is zero.
- ANALYSIS: **Reply**: correct only if each argument had *no* force; a C-inductive argument has some by definition.
- ANALYSIS: **Underdetermination survives**: a finite designer, a committee of gods or an impersonal value-principle fit the same aggregated evidence; simplicity is the proposed selector and is itself contested.
- ANALYSIS: **Net-balance rule**: suffering is evidence on the other side, so the case must be summed both ways.
- FACT: **Indian parallel**: Udayana's eight-fold collection in the *Nyāyakusumāñjali* is structurally the same move, eight centuries earlier - and Flew's objection applies to both equally.
- MEMORY: **S-M-F**: Swinburne aggregates · Mitchell gives the jury analogy · Flew leaks the buckets.

FINAL REGISTER 12/13 - Comparative synthesis

EXAM-READY LINE: Comparison is strongest when each position is judged through the same axes of ultimate reality, world relation, human relation, causation and religious function.

Item	Register entry
Convergence	FACT: India and the West both build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence
Divergence 1	FACT: Aquinas' God causes being ; Nyāya's Īśvara causes only order

Item	Register entry
Divergence 2	FACT: Creation <i>ex nihilo</i> vs eternal atoms as material cause
Divergence 3	FACT: Nyāya makes God the Veda's author; Mīmāṃsā makes the Veda authorless - no Western analogue
Divergence 4	ANALYSIS: India's sharpest anti-theistic critiques come from <i>within</i> orthodoxy (Mīmāṃsā, Sāṃkhya)
Four defensible verdicts	ANALYSIS: V1 minimal (no proof is demonstrative) · V2 cumulative · V3 divergent (different proofs establish different things) · V4 experiential (Lotze/Chatterjee-Datta)

FINAL REGISTER 13/13 - Answer architecture, master traps, keyword bank and memory spine

EXAM-READY LINE: For every proof the examiner is buying three separate answers - is it valid, are its premises true, and does its conclusion reach the God of religion.

Item	Register entry
10-mark spine	Classify -> premises -> one presupposition -> canonical objection -> one-line verdict (≈150 words)
15-mark spine	Frame -> reconstruct -> canonical example -> strongest objection -> best reply -> assess validity and adequacy separately (≈220-260 words)
20-mark spine	Classify family -> full steps -> Indian/Western contrast -> two objections with replies -> underdetermination of attributes -> criterion-named graded conclusion (≈320-360 words)
2022 "most interesting Way"	ANALYSIS: Defend Way 3 (why anything at all; PSR debate) or Way 5 (richest downstream tradition); never describe Way 2 as "who started the universe"

Directive fidelity: *along with its criticism* obliges two visible halves; *critically examine* obliges reconstruction plus a graded verdict; *compare* obliges a stated axis; *which do you prefer* obliges a named criterion and a cost.

The twelve master traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not merge Aquinas' five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the watch analogy to Aquinas; it belongs to Paley.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not say Kant proves God through morality; he **postulates** God for practical reason.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not call Nyāya's God the **material** cause; atoms are the eternal material causes.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not present Hume as proving that no designer exists; his target is the inference's strength and its conclusion's attributes.
6. ANALYSIS: Distinguish a proof's **validity** from the **adequacy** of the God it establishes.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not omit Anselm's second form; the reply to Gaunilo depends on it.
8. ANALYSIS: Modal ontological versions carry a **possibility-premise burden**; they do not defeat Kant cleanly.
9. ANALYSIS: Mīmāṃsā's Veda is *apauruṣeya* and karma can be **self-operating** - the exact contradictory of Nyāya's third and *adṛṣṭa* proofs.
10. ANALYSIS: "Jainism is atheistic" misreads the 2019 question: Jainism denies God, not godhead.
11. ANALYSIS: Do not conflate the Kalām (temporal beginning) with Aquinas' Ways (explanatory priority).
12. ANALYSIS: Do not treat a cumulative case as a chain of deductions, and do not present Udayana's grounds as a fixed canonical eight with agreed glosses.

Keyword and statement bank

Keywords: FACT: *a priori* · *a posteriori* · ontological · necessary existence · aseity · real predicate · reductio · maximal greatness · possibility premise · cosmological · essentially ordered series (*per se*) · accidentally ordered series (*per accidens*) · contingency · principle of sufficient reason · Kalām · teleological · analogy · means-end adjustment · Epicurean hypothesis · natural selection · fine-tuning · multiverse · *summum bonum* · practical postulate

· Vernunftglaube · autonomy · Euthyphro · *kāryāt* · *āyojanāt* · *dhṛtyādeḥ* · *padāt* · *śruteḥ* · *sāvayava* · *avāntara-mahattva* · *nimitta-kāraṇa* vs *upādāna-kāraṇa* · *adṛṣṭa* · *puṇya* / *pāpa* · *karmaphaladātā* · *prayojaka kartā* · *ṣaḍ-aiśvarya* · *ananta-catuṣṭaya* · *kevala-jñāna* · *siddha* · *tri-ratna* · *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya* · *pratītyasamutpāda* · *avyākṛta* · *apauruṣeya* · *svataḥ-prāmāṇya* · *apūrva* · *niyoga* · *āpta-prāmāṇya*.

Safe formulations:

- ANALYSIS: "Most proofs underdetermine the rich God of religion."
- ANALYSIS: "Nyāya and Western natural theology converge in inference from order, but diverge over material causation and karma."
- ANALYSIS: "Hume did not disprove design; he dismantled the strength of the inference and the identity of the designer."
- ANALYSIS: "Kant does not prove God; he shows what a serious moral agent must rationally hope."
- ANALYSIS: "Jainism denies God but not godhead: godhood is achieved, plural and non-creative."
- ANALYSIS: "Where the West's sharpest critics of theism stood outside religion, India's stood inside it."

Last-minute memory spine

TAXONOMY : a priori (ontological) | a posteriori (cosmo, teleo, moral, Nyaya)
 GRID : validity -> soundness -> adequacy of the God established
 ANSELM : P2 existence · P3 NECESSARY existence · Gaunilo · Kant · modal burden
 AQUINAS : motion · causation · contingency · degrees · purpose
 per se series (hand-stick-stone) · "first" = explanatory
 DESIGN : Way 5 (archer) ≠ Paley (watch) ≠ fine-tuning (constants)
 HUME : A-A-P-P-E (adapted · analogy · proportion · plurality · evil)
 KANT : CPR destroys · CPR postulates · F-I-G · summum bonum
 NYAYA : K-A-D-P-S + adrsta · EFFICIENT cause only · karmaphaladata
 CRITICS : Jaina (godhead, not God) · Bauddha (conditions suffice) ·
 Mimamsa (apauruseya + apurva) · Carvaka (no perception) ·
 Advaita (only saguna) · Sharma (redundancy)
 VERDICT : classify -> reconstruct -> presuppose -> object -> reply -> GRADE

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

The same diagram is installed as a standalone artifact beside the graphical flowchart package. It is the terminal-friendly, data-complete representation; the designed poster and tiled PDF are its graphical counterpart.

Read top to bottom. Each panel is data-complete: premises, named critics, replies and verdict.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/22: ONTOLOGICAL ARGUMENT (2018 Q6(c) · 2020 Q6(a) · 2024 Q7(c))

ANSELM, Proslogion 2 (1077-78) – a REDUCTIO

ASSUME: God exists in the understanding ALONE

P1: God =def "that than which nothing greater can be conceived"

(aliquid quo nihil maius cogitari possit); "greater" = MORE PERFECT

P2: existing in reality is greater than existing in the mind alone

=> a greater than God could be conceived – contradicts P1

∴ the assumption is false; God exists in reality

ANSELM, Proslogion 3 – THE PHILOSOPHICALLY SERIOUS FORM

a being that CANNOT be thought not to exist is greater

∴ God exists NECESSARILY – core notion: self-existence (aseity)

DESCARTES, Meditations V (1641): existence belongs to the essence of a

supremely perfect being as three angles to a triangle, a valley to a mountain

NOT to be fused with Meditations III's CAUSAL proof from the idea of the infinite

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/22: Ontological argument II: Gaunilo, Kant, the modal repair and the Indian absence

OBJECTION 1 – GAUNILO, In Behalf of the Fool: "most perfect island" parody

precision point: he wrote "most perfect OF islands", not "most perfect

CONCEIVABLE island" – correcting this strengthens the parody

ANSELM'S REPLY: an island is a contingent piece of the physical world and

can be thought not to exist; only God is defined with necessary existence

RESIDUE: protects form 2, exposes form 1, and shifts the burden to whether

maximal greatness is COHERENT (islands have no intrinsic maximum)

OBJECTION 2 – KANT: "existence is not a real predicate" (CPR A598/B626 region)

100 real thalers contain not one coin more than 100 possible thalers

Chatterjee-Datta's Indian idiom: 100 rupees imagined in the pocket

∴ nothing can be defined into existence; only a CONDITIONAL follows

OBJECTION 3 – post-Fregean logic: "exists" is a second-order quantificational

notion; it cannot appear in a list of perfections at all

REPLY – MODAL VERSIONS (Malcolm, Hartshorne, Plantinga)

1 possibly a maximally great being exists

2 maximal greatness = necessary existence + maximal excellence in every world

3 if possible, it exists in some possible world

4 what exists necessarily in some world exists in every world

∴ it exists in the actual world

BURDEN MIGRATES to premise 1 - the POSSIBILITY PREMISE; "possibly no such being"

yields the contrary conclusion by the same modal logic

INDIAN NOTE: no classical Indian analogue. Reason is pramana-theoretic –

Nyaya's means of knowledge are world-involving and inference needs vyapti

(invariable concomitance) fixed by observation; Advaita reaches Brahman by

scripture plus experience, not by concept-analysis.

2018 VERDICT: the concept entails existence CONDITIONALLY (if God exists, God exists necessarily) – conceptual entailment, never instantiation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/22: Cosmological family - three forms that must not be merged

FORM	STARTING POINT	TERMINUS	PRESSURE
AQUINAS Ways 1-3 (ST I q.2 a.3)	present change, ordered efficient causation, contingency	unmoved actualiser, first efficient cause, necessary being	needs an ESSENTIALLY ordered series
LEIBNIZ	the contingent totality + principle of sufficient reason	a necessary sufficient reason outside the series	the principle may be denied; brute fact allowed
KALAM (temporal beginning)	whatever begins has a cause; the universe began	a cause of the beginning separate defence	beginning premise + personhood need

THE DISTINCTION THE WHOLE ARGUMENT TURNS ON

ESSENTIALLY ORDERED (per se): hand -> stick -> stone. Members act

SIMULTANEOUSLY; intermediates have only DERIVATIVE power; remove the hand
and the series stops NOW. This is the series Aquinas terminates.

ACCIDENTALLY ORDERED (per accidens): grandfather -> father -> son. Each

member has power in its own right and may perish. Aquinas need NOT stop it.

∴ "FIRST" = EXPLANATORY priority here and now, NOT the earliest event.

Aquinas holds a temporal beginning is known by FAITH, not demonstration.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/22: Cosmological family II: the Five Ways mapped, and the critics

THE FIVE WAYS, MAPPED

Way 1 motion/change -> unmoved mover (cosmological)

Way 2 ordered efficient causes -> first cause (cosmological)

Way 3 contingency -> necessary being (cosmological)

Way 4 observed degrees -> maximum/source (henological)

Way 5 regular directedness -> intelligence (teleological)

Each closes "and this everyone understands to be God."

Way 3's weak steps: the quantifier shift at "at some time nothing existed",
and necessary-through-another (ab alio) vs necessary-of-itself (a se).

CRITICS

HUME : why not an infinite series? explaining each part may explain the
whole; the cause need not be one, personal, infinite or good

RUSSELL : the universe is "just there" – a brute fact; composition fallacy

KANT : the passage from "a necessary being" to "the most real being"
is the ONTOLOGICAL argument in disguise – an ADEQUACY objection

REPLY : the argument concerns DEPENDENCE, not property-transfer; but
allowing a brute totality REJECTS sufficient reason rather than
refuting the argument.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/22: TELEOLOGICAL ARGUMENT (2025 Q6(a), 20 marks - with Hume)

THREE TELEOLOGIES THAT MUST NOT BE CONFUSED

[1] AQUINAS Way 5 : regular directedness of NON-COGNITIVE nature.

Archer and arrow. A GOVERNANCE argument, not an artefact analogy.

[2] PALEY (1802) : ANALOGY from artefact to organism. Watch on a heath –
wheels, cogs, axles, springs, balances adjusted for regular timekeeping;
a stone is not. Three riders: the inference survives (i) never having
seen a watch made, (ii) imperfect working, (iii) parts whose function
we cannot discover. Cumulative evidence: eye as self-adjusting optical
instrument, bird's wing, fish's fin, planetary rotation, the seasons.

[3] FINE-TUNING : probabilistic/abductive, pre-biological, about constants.

CHRONOLOGY TRAP: Hume's Dialogues (published 1779) PRECEDE Paley (1802).

Philo – not Cleanthes – carries the objections.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/22: Teleological argument II: Hume, Darwin and fine-tuning

HUME'S FIVE FRONTS (mnemonic A-A-P-P-E)

- A ADAPTED : any persisting universe must look adapted; there could not be birds with wings unable to live in air. EPICUREAN HYPOTHESIS: finite particles in random motion pass through every combination in unlimited time; one is a stable order.
 - A ANALOGY : the universe resembles a vegetable or a crustacean at least as much as a machine; only STRONG analogy licenses inference.
 - P PROPORTION : proportion cause to effect – from a finite world one can never infer an infinite creator (the scales illustration).
 - P PLURALITY : many designers, an inferior deity, an infant or senile one, or an abandoned first attempt fit the evidence equally.
 - E EVIL : disorder and suffering count against a good, powerful maker.
- LIMIT: Hume does NOT disprove a designer. He attacks inference-strength and the attributes of the conclusion.

DARWIN (1859): random variation + differential survival explains adaptation.
Ozone illustration: life fitted itself to the filter, not the filter to life.
EXACT SCOPE: defeats Paley's BIOLOGICAL premise. Does NOT touch cosmic law-governedness or the fine-tuning of constants.

FINE-TUNING'S LIVE RIVALS

- +++ design
 - +++ physical necessity
 - +++ chance / multiverse + observation-selection effect
 - +++ an unknown deeper law
- VERDICT: probabilistic inference to the best explanation, never demonstration.

INDIAN ANALOGUE: ayojanat – the pot-and-potter inference. Chatterjee-Datta note parallels in Janet, Lotze and Martineau, but stress the divergence: Western theists make God the source of EXISTENCE; Nyaya makes God the cause of ORDER only.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/22: MORAL ARGUMENT (2021 Q7(b), 15 marks)

THREE ROUTES – DO NOT MERGE THEM

ROUTE 1 MORAL LAW / CONSCIENCE (Newman, Grammar of Assent)
binding duty and shame imply One before whom we are responsible
OBJECTION: moral psychology and social life may explain conscience
HICK: the route assumes values resist naturalistic explanation – it BEGS the question. Force: an inference to agency, not a demonstration.

ROUTE 2 OBJECTIVE VALUE AND DUTY
stance-independent moral truths require a transcendent ground
OBJECTION: moral realism need not be theistic; EUTHYPHRO presses the grounding – good because willed, or willed because good?
Force: at most an abductive grounding argument.

ROUTE 3 KANT'S HIGHEST GOOD (Critique of Practical Reason, 1788)
KANT'S TWO STOREYS: CPR (1781/87) DESTROYS the ontological, cosmological and physico-theological proofs; CPR REINSTATES God as a POSTULATE.
1 the moral law obligates pursuit of the highest good (summum bonum: virtue with proportionate happiness)
2 finite agents cannot secure that proportion; nature does not supply it
3 "ought implies can" licenses postulating its conditions
4 THREE POSTULATES: FREEDOM, IMMORTALITY, GOD
A postulate is practically necessary and theoretically undemonstrable – rational faith (Vernunftglaube): subjectively sufficient, objectively insufficient assent.

EUTHYPHRO'S TARGET: divine-command and value-grounding routes – NOT Kant.
For Kant the moral law is AUTONOMOUS; God guarantees PROPORTION, not obligation.

OBJECTIONS: projection / wish-fulfilment; autonomy tension; adequacy.
HICK'S VERDICT: moral seriousness is "at least a move in the direction of belief in God", but values cannot be said to point all the way to the infinite, omnipotent, self-existent personal creator.

INDIAN COUNTERPART: Nyaya's fruit-giver (karmaphaladata).
KEY CONTRAST: Kant POSTULATES a God who COULD proportion virtue and happiness; Nyaya INFERS a God who DOES – epistemically bolder, correspondingly more exposed.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/22: NYAYA-UDAYANA THEISM (2018 Q8(a) · 2023 Q7(a) · 2025 Q7(b))

NATURE OF ISVARA

first EFFICIENT cause – a builder, NEVER the material cause
also preserver (the world is kept in existence by God's will) and destroyer
one, infinite, eternal, omniscient; possesses the six perfections (sad-aisvarya)
the world relates to God as a body to the self residing in it
omnipotent YET GUIDED by the merit and demerit of human actions
eternal intelligence is an INSEPARABLE ATTRIBUTE of God, not His essence
(the explicit contrast with Advaita)
THEISM, NOT DEISM: the deist's God withdraws like a clockmaker; Nyaya's God
maintains a continuous relation as creator, maintainer and destroyer
God is prayojaka karta – efficient DIRECTIVE cause of human action; man is
the efficient INSTRUMENTAL cause, relatively free, directed as a wise father
directs a son

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/22: Nyaya-Udayana theism II: Udayana's eight collected grounds

UDAYANA, NYAYAKUSUMANJALI, 5th stabaka (11th c.) – THE COLLECTED GROUNDS

(a mnemonic verse conventionally unpacked as EIGHT hetus; glosses of the last
four VARY – give the Sanskrit term plus one clause, and say that they vary)

- 1 KARYAT the composite world is an EFFECT; every effect presupposes
an intelligent maker who knows its material, means and end.
Composites are effects because they are made of parts
(savayava) and have intermediate magnitude (avantara-
mahattva); space, time, ether and self are excluded as
partless infinities, atoms and manas as simple infinitesimals.
The maker must be OMNISCIENT, since only an omniscient being
can directly know atoms.
- 2 AYOJANAT inert atoms cannot combine themselves; the initial
conjunction (samyoga) requires a conscious agent's volition
- 3 DHRTYADEH support, sustenance and periodic dissolution require a
governing will ("adi" carries the maintenance/destruction pair)
- 4 PADAT transmission of language, arts and crafts presupposes an
original competent teacher
- 5 PRATYAYATAH the VALIDITY (pramanya) of the Veda requires a trustworthy
(apta) author, as a science's authority derives from its
founder; the jiva cannot be that author
- 6 SRUTEH the Veda's own testimony to Isvara counts as evidence within
the system (Brhadaranyaka, Svetasvatara, Kausitaki, Gita)
- 7 VAKYAT the Veda consists of SENTENCES, and sentences are of the kind
produced by persons – hence a personal author
- 8 SAMKHYAVISESAT the "special number": the dyad (dvyanuka) that begins creation
requires the numerical cognition (apeksa-buddhi) of a conscious
being present at the start, when no finite self is embodied
[technically the hardest – state it only if stated correctly]

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/22: Nyaya-Udayana theism III: adrsta, internal answers and external pressure

THE ARGUMENT FROM ADRSTA – the philosophical core, running beneath all eight differences of lot require a cause -> karma -> the time-gap requires a persisting stock of merit and demerit (punya/papa = ADRSTA) -> adrsta is UNCONSCIOUS and cannot allot the right kind and degree of joy and sorrow; individual selves neither know nor control it
∴ an eternal, omniscient dispenser – karmadhyaksa / karmaphaladata

TWO OBJECTIONS ANSWERED INSIDE THE SYSTEM

CIRCULARITY : in the ORDER OF EXISTENCE God creates the Veda; in the ORDER OF KNOWLEDGE the Veda leads to God. Reciprocal dependence across DIFFERENT orders is not a vicious circle.

BODILESS AGENT : a dilemma – if God's existence is already established by scripture the objection is idle; if not, it presupposes what it disputes.

EXTERNAL PRESSURE

SANKARA'S ATOMISM DILEMMA: atoms active -> permanent creation; inactive -> no creation; both -> contradiction; neither -> an outside agency, itself problematic. Advaita grants Isvara only empirical (vyavaharika) standing.

SAMKHYA: unconscious nature (prakrti) evolves without a creator.

REDUNDANCY CHARGE (C. D. Sharma): Nyaya's God is "reduced to the status of a supervisor" with "hands and feet chained by the shackles of the Law of Karma unfolding itself as the Adrsta"; the system "could have easily done away with a God". This is Nyaya's hardest challenge.

CHATTERJEE-DATTA'S OWN CONCLUSION: no proof can prove God, because God as ultimate reality is the highest of all premises and cannot be deduced from an anterior one; God must be known through DIRECT EXPERIENCE.

Lotze: "all proofs that God exists are pleas put forward in justification of our faith."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 13/22: Two senses of "god" in the indian debate

SENSE A – WORLD-MAKER (jagat-karta / Isvara-karana-vada)

the cosmological office: creates or arranges, sustains, dissolves, allots

AFFIRMED by: Nyaya-Vaisesika, theistic Vedanta, Yoga (as a special self)

DENIED by: Jainism, Buddhism, Mimamsa, Carvaka, classical Samkhya

SENSE B – PERFECTED / OMNISCIENT BEING (achieved divinity)

the soteriological office: omniscient, passion-free, exemplary, non-creative

AFFIRMED by: Jainism (arihanta, tirthankara, siddha), Buddhism (buddhas, celestial bodhisattvas), and by devotional traditions generally

THE RULE THAT SAVES THE ANSWER

"Denying a creator is not denying divinity."

A school may deny Sense A completely and affirm Sense B completely.

Nastika means denier of VEDIC AUTHORITY, not denier of spirit.

Buddhism denies a CREATOR, not devas – who are long-lived, impermanent beings inside the round of rebirth.

CONSEQUENCE FOR THE 2019 AND 2018 STEMS: a stem that asks for "the proofs propounded in Jainism" or for "arguments against God as creator" is asking about SENSE A. Answer in Sense A, then supply Sense B as what the school affirms instead.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 14/22: JAINA CRITIQUE - GODHEAD WITHOUT GOD (2019 Q5(e), 10 marks)

READ THE STEM EXACTLY: Jainism propounds NO proof of a creator. It propounds (a) a battery of arguments AGAINST one, and (b) divinity as achieved perfection. A script that invents Jain theistic proofs loses the paper; a script that says only "Jainism is atheistic" loses half the marks.

THE WORLD: uncreated, beginningless, eternal; six substances (jiva, pudgala, dharma, adharma, akasa, kala); reality is origination, decay and permanence (utpada-vyaya-dhauvya); change belongs to MODES, not to a divine act.

SIX ARGUMENTS AGAINST A CREATOR

- 1 MOTIVE (the strongest, and the one examiners want)
a perfect being is complete – without unfulfilled desire, deficiency or need
creation is an ACTION, and every action presupposes a want or purpose
∴ either God is perfect and had no motive, or God had a motive and is not perfect
- 2 REGRESS if everything needs a maker, the maker needs a maker; if the maker can be uncaused, so can the world – the premise self-defeats
- 3 INSTRUMENT before creation there was no matter, no space, no body, no instrument; an immaterial God with nothing to work on cannot act
- 4 MORAL creation from compassion is refuted by suffering, inequality and predation; creation without compassion is not good; creation as sport is childish and cruel. Karma explains the DISTRIBUTION of fortune without impugning anyone's goodness
- 5 REDUNDANCY karmic matter, the six substances and causal law already explain order, bondage and release – the parsimony (laghava) move
- 6 SVABHAVVA things act by their own nature: fire burns, water flows (assembled in Jinasena's Mahapurana and in Hemacandra; also Haribhadra, Akalanka, Vidyandandi)

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 15/22: Jaina critique II: achieved divinity, objections and verdict

WHAT JAINISM AFFIRMS INSTEAD – DO NOT BLUR THESE

- ARIHANTA / KEVALIN : destroyed the four obscuring (ghatiya) karmas and attained omniscience (kevala-jnana) WHILE STILL EMBODIED
- TIRTHANKARA : a special arihanta who RE-ESTABLISHES the fourfold order (monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen) and preaches the path. 24 in each half-cycle; Mahavira is the 24th of the present. Defined by a TEACHING-AND-FOUNDING function, not by rank.
- SIDDHA : has additionally shed the four non-obscuring (aghatiya) karmas at death; DISEMBODIED, at the siddhasila at the summit of the cosmos, with the four infinitudes (ananta-catustaya: infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, energy)
- ∴ EVERY TIRTHANKARA BECOMES A SIDDHA; NOT EVERY SIDDHA WAS A TIRTHANKARA.
- Neither creates, sustains, judges nor answers prayer. The tirthankara is passion-free (vitaraga), so worship is COMMEMORATIVE and ASPIRATIONAL – the object does not respond, and cannot, since responsiveness would be a passion. The five-fold salutation (arihanta, siddha, acarya, upadhyaya, sadhu) salutes QUALITIES AND STAGES, not a deity.
- Every jiva intrinsically possesses the four infinitudes, obscured not absent; "we are all potential Jinas" – a religion of self-help.

OBJECTION -> REPLY

- NYAYA : unconscious karmic matter cannot allot determinate fruits to determinate persons, nor can inert atoms self-organise
- JAIN REPLY: karmic influx and maturation are LAW-LIKE properties of the jiva-matter relation, exactly as poison acts without a poisoner supervising it
- COUNTER : "God has no motive" assumes creation must be motivated as HUMAN action is; classical theism replies that creation is a free, non-needy diffusion of goodness (bonum diffusivum sui), not the satisfaction of a lack. THIS EXCHANGE IS THE HIGHEST-YIELD PARAGRAPH IN THE ANSWER.
- INTERNAL : Sharma – if ignorance and karma are inseparable from the soul, liberation is impossible; if external, bondage is impossible.

VERDICT: Jainism supplies no proof OF God; it supplies a proof-structure AGAINST a creator and a redefinition of divinity as the soul's achieved perfection. Its motive argument is powerful against an anthropomorphic creator and weaker against a classical theism that denies creation is need-driven.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 16/22: BUDDHIST CRITIQUE - THREE STRATA (2018 Q8(b), 15 marks)

STRATUM (a) – CANONICAL / GENETIC

BRAHMAJALA SUTTA (DN 1): the being first reborn in an empty Brahma-world, seeing others appear after his wish, concludes "I am Brahma, the Maker, the Creator"; later arrivals remember him and transmit the error

AGGANNA SUTTA (DN 27): a naturalistic-cyclic account of cosmic and social evolution replaces creation

AVYAKATA (undeclared questions) + the poisoned-arrow parable: speculative cosmogony is soteriologically idle

HONEST LIMIT: these DIAGNOSE the belief; they do not REFUTE the proposition.

STRATUM (b) – CAUSAL-METAPHYSICAL [Dharmakirti; Santaraksita's Tattvasamgraha with Kamalasila's Panjika] – THIS IS WHERE THE EXAMINABLE ARGUMENT LIES

1 CRITERION OF EXISTENCE: to be real is to be causally efficacious (arthakriya-karitva)

2 THE SUCCESSIVE-OR-SIMULTANEOUS DILEMMA (krama-akrama-virodha):

a PERMANENT, UNCHANGING cause must produce its effects either

ALL AT ONCE -> the whole cosmos arises in one instant and nothing follows

or SUCCESSIVELY -> God acquires at t2 an auxiliary he lacked at t1,

and is therefore neither permanent nor self-sufficient

3 AUXILIARY REGRESS: if God needs auxiliaries (material, karma, time) he is not the SOLE cause; if he does not, the world's temporal order is unexplained

4 EVIDENTIAL: the inference "effect -> intelligent maker" rests on a vyapti established only for ARTEFACTS; generalising it is the very point at issue

5 REDUNDANCY: conditioned co-arising (pratityasamutpada) already accounts for arising and cessation – a creator is an idle wheel

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 17/22: Buddhist critique II: moral stratum, distinction, replies and verdict

STRATUM (c) – MORAL

a being able to create who ordered THIS quantity of suffering is either not benevolent or not omnipotent; and if all is God's will, karma and moral effort are pointless. DEVADAHA SUTTA (MN 101) makes the parallel point against determinism generally: a doctrine that makes present effort ineffective destroys the moral life.

[Bhuridatta Jataka anti-creator verses: widely cited, wording translation-dependent – PARAPHRASE ONLY.]

DISTINCTION: Buddhism is NON-THEISTIC, not merely atheistic. It rejects a CREATOR (isvara-karana-vada), not every divine being; devas are impermanent beings within the round of rebirth, and later Buddha-fields and celestial bodhisattvas perform religious functions without an omnipotent creator.

OBJECTION -> REPLY

NYAYA : God's WILLING is eternal while its EFFECTS are timed by the readiness of adrstā, so no change in God is required; and to demand PERCEPTION of God begs the question against inference

BUDDHIST : an eternal will whose efficacy is timed by something else is not the sole and sufficient cause the theist claimed

SECOND : if there is no self and no creator, what carries karma?
-> routed to Topic 04, Soul, Immortality, Rebirth and Liberation

VERDICT: strongest where METAPHYSICAL – the permanence/production dilemma bites on any UNCHANGING creator – and weakest where merely GENETIC, since explaining why people believe in Brahma does not show there is none.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 18/22: Mimamsa and carvaka - the remaining two denials

MIMAMSA – displaces God twice over

APAURUSEYA : the Veda is eternal, AUTHORLESS and self-valid; no human and NO DIVINE author is needed. Authorlessness protects it from an author's deceit or ignorance. Against Nyaya: proving God, then His omniscience, then His truthfulness, is a cumbersome three-stage dependence that authorlessness avoids.

-> the exact contradictory of Udayana's padat / pratyayatah / sruteh / vakyat

APURVA : the unseen potency of a correctly performed ritual matures into future fruit WITHOUT a divine dispenser; Prabhakara's niyoga grounds obligation in the injunction itself

-> the exact contradictory of the adrsta / karmadhyaksa argument

Word-meaning relation is intrinsic (autpattika), not conventionally instituted by a person – removing the last need for a divine institutor of language

Chatterjee-Datta record Max Muller's points that a creator God faces charges of cruelty and partiality, and that denying a CREATOR is not denying God

THEIR CRITICISM: Mimamsa deities are not objects of worship and exist only in the mantras describing them – "eternal and self-manifesting concepts"; God is relegated to an ambiguous position

CARVAKA – cuts the ground from every inferential proof

only perception is a means of valid knowledge; inference cannot reach the supersensible; the world is made by the automatic combination of the material elements; Vedas and priests are rejected

-> if this stands, EVERY anumana-based proof, Indian or Western, fails at once

ADVAITA'S LEVELLING (not a denial, a demotion)

Nyaya's God is a qualified Lord (saguna Isvara) at the empirical (vyavaharika) level, not the quality-transcending absolute (nirguna Brahman); the atomistic proof is judged logically weak

NYAYA'S STANDING REPLIES

unconscious merit cannot intelligently allot determinate fruits

authorless normativity is itself unexplained

demanding perception of God begs the question against inference

the pot/cosmos dissimilarity affects the STRENGTH, not the FORM, of the inference

CLASSIFICATION KEY – every Indian anti-creator argument is one of three moves:

ECONOMY (redundancy/laghava) | COHERENCE (motive, krama-akrama) |

EPISTEMIC RESTRICTION (Carvaka on inference; Mimamsa on scriptural self-validity)

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 19/22: Cumulative-case logic and the comparative bench

C-INDUCTIVE : premises RAISE the probability of the conclusion

$P(\text{theism} | e) > P(\text{theism})$, but not necessarily > 0.5

| several INDEPENDENT strands

v

P-INDUCTIVE : premises make the conclusion MORE PROBABLE THAN NOT (> 0.5)

[Swinburne, The Existence of God; Mitchell, The Justification of Religious Belief]

IMAGES: CHAIN (wrong – the components are not deductions, so no link breaks)

ROPE (right – many strands, none end to end, jointly load-bearing)

JURY (Mitchell – converging circumstantial evidence, none sufficient alone)

NOT THE SAME AS inference to the best explanation, which compares rival TOTAL hypotheses rather than accumulating confirmation.

SWINBURNE'S PRIOR: SIMPLICITY – one agent with infinite (hence non-arbitrary) degrees of power, knowledge and freedom is simpler than any finite alternative.

FLEW, God and Philosophy: TEN LEAKY BUCKETS – buckets that each leak hold no more water when stacked; zero plus zero is zero.

REPLY: correct only if each argument had NO force; a C-inductive argument has some by definition. Rope, not stacked buckets.

RESIDUAL OBJECTIONS: (i) underdetermination – a finite designer, a committee of gods or an impersonal value-principle fit equally; simplicity is the proposed selector and is itself contested; (ii) the case must be run as a NET balance, with suffering counted on the other side.

UDAYANA'S 8-FOLD COLLECTION IS STRUCTURALLY THE SAME MOVE, EIGHT CENTURIES EARLIER – and Flew's objection applies to both equally.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 20/22: Comparative parity bench: convergence and divergence

THE PARITY BENCH – use whenever the stem says "compare" or "critically"			
FUNCTION	WESTERN	INDIAN PRO-THEISTIC	INDIAN ANTI-THEISTIC
effect -> maker	Aquinas Way 2; Paley	Nyaya karyat, ayojanat	Buddhist attack on the vyapti; Jain regress
order/governance	Aquinas Way 5	Udayana dhrtiyadeh	Jain svabhava; Samkhya's unconscious prakrti
scripture's authority	revealed theology	Udayana pratyayatah, sruteh, vakyat	Mimamsa's apauruseya Veda – authority without an author
moral order	Kant's postulate	Isvara as karmadhyaksa	karma/apurva as self-fructifying
from concept alone	Anselm, Descartes	no close classical analogue	–
aggregation	Swinburne's cumulative case	Udayana's eight-fold stabaka	Flew's leaky buckets applies to both

CONVERGENCE / DIVERGENCE

CONVERGE: both traditions build a posteriori inferences from order to intelligence

DIVERGE : Aquinas' God causes BEING; Nyaya's Isvara causes only ORDER

creation from nothing vs the arrangement of ETERNAL atoms

Nyaya makes God the Veda's author; Mimamsa makes the Veda authorless –
there is NO Western analogue for that position

India's sharpest critics stood INSIDE orthodoxy (Mimamsa, Samkhya);
the West's stood outside it

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 21/22: Verdict ladder, traps and the answer spine

FOUR DEFENSIBLE VERDICTS – CHOOSE ONE, NAME THE CRITERION, PAY ITS COST

- V1 MINIMAL no proof is demonstrative; each fails on validity, soundness
or adequacy (Chatterjee-Datta, following Kant and Lotze)
- V2 CUMULATIVE individually weak, jointly they raise probability
(Udayana; Swinburne; Mitchell)
- V3 DIVERGENT different proofs establish different things – necessity,
agency, intelligence, moral government – and no single one was
ever meant to deliver the whole God of religion
- V4 EXPERIENTIAL proofs are "pleas put forward in justification of our faith"
(Lotze); God is known through direct experience

GRADED BAND LADDER

- WEAK ~40% names four Western proofs and "Nyaya's inference"; narrates the watch
- AVG ~50% one proof reconstructed with a standard critique attached
- GOOD ~60% premises numbered; presupposition named; one objection answered
- STRONG 65-70 validity/soundness/adequacy separated; Indian parallel ARGUED;
the proponent's reply supplied
- TOP 70%+ all the above + one discriminating distinction (per se vs per
accidens; C- vs P-inductive; tirthankara vs siddha; krama-akrama)
+ a statement of what evidence would change the verdict

TWELVE MASTER TRAPS

- 1 do not merge the Five Ways into one temporal "first cause" argument
- 2 the watch is PALEY'S (1802), never Aquinas'
- 3 Kant POSTULATES God for practical reason; he does not prove God by morality
- 4 Nyaya's God is the EFFICIENT, never the MATERIAL, cause; atoms are eternal
- 5 Hume attacks inference-strength and attributes; he does not disprove a designer
- 6 distinguish a proof's VALIDITY from the ADEQUACY of the God it establishes
- 7 never omit Anselm's second form; the reply to Gaunilo depends on it
- 8 modal versions carry a POSSIBILITY-PREMISE burden; they do not defeat Kant cleanly
- 9 Mimamsa's Veda is apauruseya and karma can be self-operating – the exact
contradictory of Nyaya's scripture and adrsta grounds
- 10 "Jainism is atheistic" misreads the 2019 stem: Jainism denies God, not godhead;
and tirthankara is not siddha
- 11 Buddhism denies a CREATOR, not all gods; and the case is not "the Buddha was
silent" – it is the krama-akrama dilemma
- 12 a cumulative case is a ROPE, not a chain; and Udayana's list is not a fixed
canonical eight with agreed glosses

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 22/22: The answer spine and the qualified conclusion

THE ANSWER SPINE – RUN IT IN THIS ORDER, EVERY TIME

DIRECTIVE decode the verb; make the split visible on the page

PREMISES reconstruct as numbered steps, not narrative

OBJECTION attach each objection to the PREMISE it attacks

REPLY give the proponent's BEST reply, not a straw one

VERDICT grade validity, soundness and adequacy separately; name the criterion

10 marks ~150 words | 15 marks ~220-260 words | 20 marks ~320-360 words

|

QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

"The proofs fail as demonstrations but succeed as diagnostics. The ontological argument shows that God, if real, cannot be a contingent item in the world; the cosmological arguments show that contingent reality does not explain itself; the design argument shows that order invites, without compelling, an intentional explanation; the moral argument shows what a serious moral agent must hope; and Nyaya shows that the same inferential path was walked in India, and met the same objections from Mimamsa and Buddhism that Hume and Kant later pressed in Europe. What no proof delivers is the passage from the being it establishes to the God actually worshipped – which is why every tradition eventually supplements proof with experience, testimony or faith."